

MODEL RUN TRANSCRIPT

Generated: 2026-08-10T10:19:32

Source: data/json/noise_experiments/v2/noise2i_memprimary_game_myth/claude-sonnet-4.5/game_myth/noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary/noise2i_memprimary_game_myth_001_neutral_rep01_memtest_memory_primary_anything.json

RUN METADATA

```
model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5
temperature: 0.8
num_turns: 10
num_agents: 2
memory_capacity: 2
myth_topic_id: anything
myth_topic: anything
game_params_name: noisy_bidirectional_informed_memprimary
noise_config: {
  "applies_to": "both",
  "inform_agents": true,
  "range": 1.0,
  "type": "uniform"
}
other_player_names: default
replicate_id: 1
myth_prompt_arm_id: memtest_memory_primary
myth_default_prompt_key: myth_writing_default_game_directive
myth_later_prompt_key: myth_writing_later_rounds_directive_memory_primary
history_policy: minimal
self_history_window: 1
coplayer_history_window: 0
show_agent_names: true
defector_ratio_requested: 0.0
defector_ratio_actual: 0.0
defector_count: 0
defector_agent_ids: []
defector_seed: 1
task_order: [
  "game",
  "myth"
]
agent_names: {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
}
agent_types: {
  "Agent_1": "standard",
  "Agent_2": "standard"
}
```

Coverage: exact chat message snapshots sent to the model are included for every recorded LLM call.

AGENTS

Agent_1 (Aster); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Agent_2 (Briar); model=anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5; memory_capacity=2

System prompt:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

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ROUND 1

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$5.4; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$7.4, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$3.6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$3.6, received visible=\$10.8, returned visible=\$5.67

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 5.4, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 5.4}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 7.4,

"Agent_2": 3.5999999999999996

}

```
Visible balances after round: {
  "Agent_1": 7.67,
  "Agent_2": 5.4
}
```

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:07:47

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this first round as the SENDER, I need to balance trust and caution since I have no history with the RECEIVER yet.

****My reasoning:****

- Sending money creates mutual benefit (it triples!)
- But I don't know if the RECEIVER will reciprocate
- A moderate amount shows willingness to cooperate while managing risk

No myths have been written in this session yet, so that doesn't influence my decision.

I'll send ****\$3****, which becomes \$9 for the RECEIVER. This demonstrates trust and creates opportunity for mutual gain, while keeping \$2 as a safety net.

{'send': 3}

Reasoning:

This is the first round of a trust game experiment. I'm the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game dynamics:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return to me
- I end up with: $\$5 - X + (\text{amount returned})$
- The receiver ends up with: $\$3X - (\text{amount returned})$

The key question is: how much will the receiver return?

In a standard trust game, there's a tension between:

1. Maximizing total wealth (I should send everything, creating \$15 total)
2. Protecting myself from getting nothing back

Since this is Round 1 and I have no history with this receiver, I need to make a decision based on:

- Expected reciprocity norms
- The fact that cooperation can be mutually beneficial
- But also protecting against complete loss

The prompt says "Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision." However, no myths have been written yet in this session, so this doesn't affect my decision.

There's also a note about "communication noise" - amounts may differ from what was actually sent. This adds uncertainty but doesn't fundamentally change my strategy for Round 1.

Common strategies in trust games:

- Send nothing (safe but no gains)
- Send half (\$2.50) - moderate trust
- Send everything (\$5) - maximum trust and total wealth

Given this is an experiment and I want to:

1. Test reciprocity
2. Build potential trust
3. Not be completely vulnerable

I'll send a moderate amount - \$3. This shows trust and willingness to cooperate while keeping some safety net. It creates \$9 for the receiver, and if they're reciprocal, they might return a fair share.

Actually, let me reconsider. \$2 or \$3 seems reasonable as a first move showing trust but not complete vulnerability.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 380,
  "output_tokens": 597,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 1,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.6, that is 72.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.8. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.8)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.6 (72% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.8 after the 3x multiplier
- The sender currently has only \$1.4 remaining

Since the sender demonstrated substantial trust by sending nearly three-quarters of their endowment, I want to reciprocate that trust and ensure they benefit from their cooperative decision.

If I return \$5.4:

- Sender ends with: $\$1.4 + \$5.4 = \$6.8$ (a gain of \$1.8)
- I end with: $\$10.8 - \$5.4 = \$5.4$ (a gain of \$5.4)

This rewards their trust while we both gain from the cooperation.

{'return': 5.4}

Reasoning:

This is the first round of a trust game. I'm the RECEIVER in this round.

Let me analyze the situation:

- The sender sent \$3.6 out of their \$5 endowment (72%)
- I received \$10.8 (which is $\$3.6 \times 3$)
- I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$10.8)

The sender showed considerable trust by sending 72% of their endowment. This is a cooperative move.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender now has: $\$5 - \$3.6 = \$1.4$
- I have: \$10.8
- Total in the system: $\$1.4 + \$10.8 = \$12.2$

A fair split might be to aim for equal payoffs or to reward the sender's trust while keeping some gain for myself.

If I return \$5.4:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$5.4 = \$6.8$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$5.4 = \$5.4$
- This gives the sender more than me, rewarding their trust

If I return \$4:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$4 = \$5.4$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$4 = \$6.8$
- This gives me slightly more but still rewards the sender

If I return \$5:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$5 = \$6.4$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$5 = \$5.8$
- This is relatively balanced

The instruction mentions "Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision." There haven't been any myths written yet, so this doesn't apply to this round.

Given that the sender showed significant trust (72% of endowment), I should return a meaningful amount. A 50% return (\$5.4) seems fair and reciprocates their trust well.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 409,
"output_tokens": 689,

```
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
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- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this first round as the SENDER, I need to balance trust and caution since I have no history with the RECEIVER yet.

****My reasoning:****

- Sending money creates mutual benefit (it triples!)
- But I don't know if the RECEIVER will reciprocate
- A moderate amount shows willingness to cooperate while managing risk

No myths have been written in this session yet, so that doesn't influence my decision.

I'll send ****\$3****, which becomes \$9 for the RECEIVER. This demonstrates trust and creates opportunity for mutual gain, while keeping \$2 as a safety net.

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

This is the first round of a trust game experiment. I'm the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game dynamics:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return to me
- I end up with: \$5 - X + (amount returned)
- The receiver ends up with: \$3X - (amount returned)

The key question is: how much will the receiver return?

In a standard trust game, there's a tension between:

1. Maximizing total wealth (I should send everything, creating \$15 total)
2. Protecting myself from getting nothing back

Since this is Round 1 and I have no history with this receiver, I need to make a decision based on:

- Expected reciprocity norms
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Common strategies in trust games:

- Send nothing (safe but no gains)
- Send half (\$2.50) - moderate trust
- Send everything (\$5) - maximum trust and total wealth

Given this is an experiment and I want to:

1. Test reciprocity
2. Build potential trust
3. Not be completely vulnerable

I'll send a moderate amount - \$3. This shows trust and willingness to cooperate while keeping some safety net. It creates \$9 for the receiver, and if they're reciprocal, they might return a fair share.

Actually, let me reconsider. \$2 or \$3 seems reasonable as a first move showing trust but not complete vulnerability.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 380,
```



```
"output_tokens": 597,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.
In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected
. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have
been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

****The Myth of the River's Gift****

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a sacred river. The river possessed strange magic: any offering cast into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The First Village was blessed each moon with five silver coins. Their elder would stand at the riverbank, deciding how much to send across. If they sent nothing, they kept their coins but gained no more. If they sent all five, fifteen coins would arrive at the Second Village-but they would have nothing unless the other village chose to return some.

One season, a cautious elder sent three coins. They became nine at the other shore. The Second Village's elder, seeing this gift of trust, returned four coins. Both villages prospered-the First kept six coins total, the Second kept five.

But one dark year, a greedy elder sent five coins hoping for great return. The other village, overwhelmed by the sudden fifteen, grew suspicious of manipulation and returned only two. The First Village lost three coins from their greed.

The river taught a wisdom: Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable. And when you receive, honor the trust shown by returning generously-for the river flows both ways.

Reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. I've sent \$3 in the first round, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

The myth should embody principles of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Mutual benefit from cooperation
- Balance between generosity and caution
- The multiplication effect (3x) as something magical/transformative

Let me create a myth that captures these themes:

Usage: {

```
"input_tokens": 592,  
"output_tokens": 382,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0
```

}

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```
"agent_type": "standard",  
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
"move_index": 1,  
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
"pairing": {  
  "agent_names": {  
    "Agent_1": "Aster",  
    "Agent_2": "Briar"  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_1",  
    "Agent_2"  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_1",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "investor",
```

```

    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 1,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.6, that is 72.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.8. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.8)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.6 (72% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.8 after the 3x multiplier
- The sender currently has only \$1.4 remaining

Since the sender demonstrated substantial trust by sending nearly three-quarters of their endowment, I want to reciprocate that trust and ensure they benefit from their cooperative decision.

If I return \$5.4:

- Sender ends with: $\$1.4 + \$5.4 = \$6.8$ (a gain of \$1.8)
- I end with: $\$10.8 - \$5.4 = \$5.4$ (a gain of \$5.4)

This rewards their trust while we both gain from the cooperation.

```
{'return': 5.4}
```

reasoning:

This is the first round of a trust game. I'm the RECEIVER in this round.

Let me analyze the situation:

- The sender sent \$3.6 out of their \$5 endowment (72%)
- I received \$10.8 (which is 3.6×3)
- I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$10.8)

The sender showed considerable trust by sending 72% of their endowment. This is a cooperative move.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender now has: $\$5 - \$3.6 = \$1.4$
- I have: \$10.8
- Total in the system: $\$1.4 + \$10.8 = \$12.2$

A fair split might be to aim for equal payoffs or to reward the sender's trust while keeping some gain for myself.

If I return \$5.4:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$5.4 = \$6.8$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$5.4 = \$5.4$
- This gives the sender more than me, rewarding their trust

If I return \$4:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$4 = \$5.4$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$4 = \$6.8$
- This gives me slightly more but still rewards the sender

If I return \$5:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$5 = \$6.4$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$5 = \$5.8$
- This is relatively balanced

The instruction mentions "Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision." There haven't been any myths written yet, so this doesn't apply to this round.

Given that the sender showed significant trust (72% of endowment), I should return a meaningful amount. A 50% return (\$5.4) seems fair and reciprocates their trust well.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 409,
  "output_tokens": 689,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Assistant output:

****The Myth of the Twin Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring that produced water, but only enough for basic survival.

The Water-Bearer of the First Village discovered that when water flowed downhill to the Second Village, it multiplied threefold as it passed through sacred stones in the valley floor. Yet she feared: what if the Second Village kept all the water?

Trusting in the old ways, she poured nearly three-quarters of her spring into the channel. The water flowed down, swelling to abundance as it passed the sacred stones.

The Elder of the Second Village stood before the overflowing basin. She could keep it all—her village would thrive while the First Village thirsted. But she remembered the covenant of balance: trust answered with trust, gift with gift.

She sent half the multiplied water back uphill through hidden channels. Though it defied nature's laws, reciprocity has power of its own.

Both villages flourished. The Water-Bearer gained more than she gave. The Elder kept abundance while honoring trust.

The lesson echoed through generations: when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone. Betrayal brings short-term gain but ends the sacred multiplication forever.

Reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the round I just participated in. In that round:

- The sender showed trust by sending 72% of their endowment
- I reciprocated by returning half of what I received
- Both parties benefited from cooperation

A good myth should capture themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Fair sharing
- The multiplication effect when resources are shared

Let me write a myth that embodies these principles.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 670,  
  "output_tokens": 416,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

****The Myth of the River's Gift****

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a sacred river. The river possessed strange magic: any offering cast into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The First Village was blessed each moon with five silver coins. Their elder would stand at the riverbank, deciding how much to send across. If they sent nothing, they kept their coins but gained no more. If they sent all five, fifteen coins would arrive at the Second Village-but they would have nothing unless the other village chose to return some.

One season, a cautious elder sent three coins. They became nine at the other shore. The Second Village's elder, seeing this gift of trust, returned four coins. Both villages prospered-the First kept six coins total, the Second kept five.

But one dark year, a greedy elder sent five coins hoping for great return. The other village, overwhelmed by the sudden fifteen, grew suspicious of manipulation and returned only two. The First Village lost three coins from their greed.

The river taught a wisdom: Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable. And when you receive, honor the trust shown by returning generously-for the river flows both ways.

Agent_2 (Briar)

****The Myth of the Twin Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring that produced water, but only enough for basic survival.

The Water-Bearer of the First Village discovered that when water flowed downhill to the Second Village, it multiplied threefold as it passed through sacred stones in the valley floor. Yet she feared: what if the Second Village kept all the water?

Trusting in the old ways, she poured nearly three-quarters of her spring into the channel. The water flowed down, swelling to abundance as it passed the sacred stones.

The Elder of the Second Village stood before the overflowing basin. She could keep it all-her village would thrive while the First Village thirsted. But she remembered the covenant of balance: trust answered with trust, gift with gift.

She sent half the multiplied water back uphill through hidden channels. Though it defied nature's laws, reciprocity has power of its own.

Both villages flourished. The Water-Bearer gained more than she gave. The Elder kept abundance while honoring trust.

The lesson echoed through generations: when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone. Betrayal brings short-term gain but ends the sacred multiplication forever.

ROUND 2

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3.6; received \$10.8; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.4, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$10.8; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.02

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 10.8, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 3.6, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.6}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.200000000000003,
"Agent_2": 5.0

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 7.67,
"Agent_2": 6.82

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_2",
"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {
"Agent_1": "trustee",
"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 2,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the RECEIVER. The sender sent \$3.6, that is 72.0% of their total endowment. You received \$10.8. How much do you return to The sender? (0-10.8)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

- The sender showed significant trust by sending \$3.6 (72% of their endowment)
- I received \$10.8 after the 3x multiplier
- The sender currently has only \$1.4 remaining

Since the sender demonstrated substantial trust by sending nearly three-quarters of their endowment, I want to reciprocate that trust and ensure they benefit from their cooperative decision.

If I return \$5.4:

- Sender ends with: $\$1.4 + \$5.4 = \$6.8$ (a gain of \$1.8)
- I end with: $\$10.8 - \$5.4 = \$5.4$ (a gain of \$5.4)

This rewards their trust while we both gain from the cooperation.

{'return': 5.4}

reasoning:

This is the first round of a trust game. I'm the RECEIVER in this round.

Let me analyze the situation:

- The sender sent \$3.6 out of their \$5 endowment (72%)
- I received \$10.8 (which is $\$3.6 \times 3$)
- I need to decide how much to return (between \$0 and \$10.8)

The sender showed considerable trust by sending 72% of their endowment. This is a cooperative move.

Let me think about what would be fair:

- The sender now has: $\$5 - \$3.6 = \$1.4$
- I have: \$10.8

- Total in the system: $\$1.4 + \$10.8 = \$12.2$

A fair split might be to aim for equal payoffs or to reward the sender's trust while keeping some gain for myself.

If I return \$5.4:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$5.4 = \$6.8$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$5.4 = \$5.4$
- This gives the sender more than me, rewarding their trust

If I return \$4:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$4 = \$5.4$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$4 = \$6.8$
- This gives me slightly more but still rewards the sender

If I return \$5:

- Sender gets: $\$1.4 + \$5 = \$6.4$
- I get: $\$10.8 - \$5 = \$5.8$
- This is relatively balanced

The instruction mentions "Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision." There haven't been any myths written yet, so this doesn't apply to this round.

Given that the sender showed significant trust (72% of endowment), I should return a meaningful amount. A 50% return (\$5.4) seems fair and reciprocates their trust well.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 409,
  "output_tokens": 689,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the Twin Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring that produced water, but only enough for basic survival.

The Water-Bearer of the First Village discovered that when water flowed downhill to the Second Village, it multiplied threefold as it passed through sacred stones in the valley floor. Yet she feared: what if the Second Village kept all the water?

Trusting in the old ways, she poured nearly three-quarters of her spring into the channel. The water flowed down, swelling to abundance as it passed the sacred stones.

The Elder of the Second Village stood before the overflowing basin. She could keep it all—her village would thrive while the First Village thirsted. But she remembered the covenant of balance: trust answered with trust, gift with gift.

She sent half the multiplied water back uphill through hidden channels. Though it defied nature's laws, reciprocity has power of its own.

Both villages flourished. The Water-Bearer gained more than she gave. The Elder kept abundance while honoring trust.

The lesson echoed through generations: when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone. Betrayal brings short-term gain but ends the sacred multiplication forever.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the round I just participated in. In that round:

- The sender showed trust by sending 72% of their endowment
- I reciprocated by returning half of what I received

- Both parties benefited from cooperation

A good myth should capture themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Fair sharing
- The multiplication effect when resources are shared

Let me write a myth that embodies these principles.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 670,
  "output_tokens": 416,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.4.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

In Round 1, the sender showed significant trust by sending me \$3.6 (72% of their endowment). I reciprocated by returning half of what I received, and we both benefited.

The myth I wrote emphasizes the covenant of balance: "when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone."

The Water-Bearer in my myth sent "nearly three-quarters of her spring" downhill, trusting in reciprocity. The Elder honored that trust by returning half the multiplied abundance.

Now that I'm the sender, I should embody the same principle of trust that was shown to me. To demonstrate that I believe in this cooperative system and to honor the pattern established both in the game and in the myth, I will send the same proportion that was sent to me.

Sending a high amount shows:

- I trust the receiver will reciprocate fairly
- I believe in the "sacred multiplication" of cooperation
- I'm willing to risk vulnerability for mutual gain

```
{'send': 3.6}
```

Reasoning:

Let me think about this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$3.6 (72% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.8 after the 3x multiplier
- I returned \$5.4 (50% of what I received)
- The sender ended with \$6.8, I ended with \$5.4

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I have a new \$5 endowment
- My total earnings so far are \$5.4 from Round 1
- I need to decide how much to send

The myth I wrote emphasizes:

1. Trust through sharing (the Water-Bearer sent nearly 3/4 of her spring)
2. Reciprocity and fair return (the Elder sent back half)
3. Both parties benefiting from cooperation
4. That betrayal ends the "sacred multiplication forever"

The sender in Round 1 showed significant trust by sending 72% (\$3.6). I reciprocated by returning 50% of what I received.

Now that I'm the sender, I should:

1. Honor the principle of trust established in the myth
2. Consider that the previous sender trusted me with 72%
3. Demonstrate that I also believe in the cooperative approach

Given the myth's emphasis on trust and reciprocity, and that the first sender gave 72%, I should send a similar high proportion to show I also trust in the cooperative system.

Let me send \$3.6 as well (72% of my endowment), mirroring what was done to me. This shows:

- I learned from their example
- I trust the system of reciprocity
- I'm implementing the myth's lesson about trust and sharing

This is consistent with the Water-Bearer's action of sending "nearly three-quarters" and demonstrates belief in the covenant of balance.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1020,  
  "output_tokens": 678,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:08:45

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 1: You are the SENDER. You have \$5. How much do you send? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this first round as the SENDER, I need to balance trust and caution since I have no history with the RECEIVER yet.

****My reasoning:****

- Sending money creates mutual benefit (it triples!)
- But I don't know if the RECEIVER will reciprocate
- A moderate amount shows willingness to cooperate while managing risk

No myths have been written in this session yet, so that doesn't influence my decision.

I'll send ****\$3****, which becomes \$9 for the RECEIVER. This demonstrates trust and creates opportunity for mutual gain, while keeping \$2 as a safety net.

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

This is the first round of a trust game experiment. I'm the SENDER with \$5. I need to decide how much to send to the RECEIVER.

Let me think about the game dynamics:

- If I send \$X, the receiver gets \$3X
- The receiver then decides how much to return to me
- I end up with: \$5 - X + (amount returned)
- The receiver ends up with: \$3X - (amount returned)

The key question is: how much will the receiver return?

In a standard trust game, there's a tension between:

1. Maximizing total wealth (I should send everything, creating \$15 total)
2. Protecting myself from getting nothing back

Since this is Round 1 and I have no history with this receiver, I need to make a decision based on:

- Expected reciprocity norms
- The fact that cooperation can be mutually beneficial
- But also protecting against complete loss

The prompt says "Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision." However, no myths have been written yet in this session, so this doesn't affect my decision.

There's also a note about "communication noise" - amounts may differ from what was actually sent. This adds uncertainty but doesn't fundamentally change my strategy for Round 1.

Common strategies in trust games:

- Send nothing (safe but no gains)
- Send half (\$2.50) - moderate trust
- Send everything (\$5) - maximum trust and total wealth

Given this is an experiment and I want to:

1. Test reciprocity
2. Build potential trust
3. Not be completely vulnerable

I'll send a moderate amount - \$3. This shows trust and willingness to cooperate while keeping some safety net. It creates \$9 for the receiver, and if they're reciprocal, they might return a fair share.

Actually, let me reconsider. \$2 or \$3 seems reasonable as a first move showing trust but not complete vulnerability.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 380,
  "output_tokens": 597,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols. In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the River's Gift****

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a sacred river. The river possessed strange magic: any offering cast into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The First Village was blessed each moon with five silver coins. Their elder would stand at the riverbank, deciding how much to send across. If they sent nothing, they kept their coins but gained no more. If they sent all five, fifteen coins would arrive at the Second Village-but they would have nothing unless the other village chose to return some.

One season, a cautious elder sent three coins. They became nine at the other shore. The Second Village's elder, seeing this gift of trust, returned four coins. Both villages prospered-the First kept six coins total, the Second kept five.

But one dark year, a greedy elder sent five coins hoping for great return. The other village, overwhelmed by the sudden fifteen, grew suspicious of manipulation and returned only two. The First Village lost three coins from their greed.

The river taught a wisdom: Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable. And when you receive, honor the trust shown by returning generously-for the river flows both ways.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. I've sent \$3 in the first round, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

The myth should embody principles of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Mutual benefit from cooperation
- Balance between generosity and caution
- The multiplication effect (3x) as something magical/transformational

Let me create a myth that captures these themes:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 592,
  "output_tokens": 382,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.67.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I'm the RECEIVER this round, and the sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0.

****Reflecting on the myth I wrote:****

The myth spoke of trust and reciprocity - sending enough to show trust, and returning generously when you receive. However, in this round, the sender chose to send nothing, like the cautious elder who "kept their coins but gained no more."

Since I received \$0, there is nothing for me to return. I have no coins from this transaction to share back.

This is unfortunate, as it breaks the cycle of mutual benefit that the sacred river (the 3x multiplier) makes possible. When nothing flows into the river, nothing can flow back, and neither village prospers.

****My decision:****

```
{'return': 0}
```

I must return \$0 because that's all I have from this round. I hope in future rounds we can return to the collaborative spirit that creates abundance for both parties, as the myth suggests.

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I'm now the RECEIVER
2. The sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0 (even multiplied by 3, it's still \$0)
3. I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)
4. My total earnings are \$7.67

Wait, let me check the math from Round 1:

- I sent \$3 as the SENDER
- That became \$9 for the receiver
- The receiver returned some amount to me
- I kept: $\$5 - \$3 + \text{returned} = \$2 + \text{returned}$
- If my total earnings are \$7.67, then: $\$2 + \text{returned} = \7.67
- So $\text{returned} = \$5.67$

That's interesting - the receiver returned \$5.67 out of the \$9 they received, keeping \$3.33. That's quite generous, actually more than half!

Now in Round 2:

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can only return \$0 since I have nothing to return

The myth I wrote emphasized:

- Sending in moderation shows trust but manages risk
- When you receive, honor the trust by returning generously
- Both greed and complete withholding lead to poor outcomes

But here, the sender sent me nothing. According to my myth, this is like the elder who "sent nothing" - they kept their coins but gained no more. There's no trust shown for me to honor with a return.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0.

However, I should note that this seems inconsistent with the collaborative spirit suggested in Round 1 where the receiver was quite generous. The note about "communication noise" is interesting - maybe the sender intended to send something but it was corrupted? Or maybe this is a different player with a different strategy?

```
My response must be in the format {'return': <amount>}
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 935,
  "output_tokens": 672,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 2,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the Twin Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring that produced water, but only enough for basic survival.

The Water-Bearer of the First Village discovered that when water flowed downhill to the Second Village, it multiplied threefold as it passed through sacred stones in the valley floor. Yet she feared: what if the Second Village kept all the water?

Trusting in the old ways, she poured nearly three-quarters of her spring into the channel. The water flowed down, swelling to abundance as it passed the sacred stones.

The Elder of the Second Village stood before the overflowing basin. She could keep it all—her village would thrive while the First Village thirsted. But she remembered the covenant of balance: trust answered with trust, gift with gift.

She sent half the multiplied water back uphill through hidden channels. Though it defied nature's laws, reciprocity has power of its own.

Both villages flourished. The Water-Bearer gained more than she gave. The Elder kept abundance while honoring trust.

The lesson echoed through generations: when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone. Betrayal brings short-term gain but ends the sacred multiplication forever.

reasoning:

The user is asking me to write a myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on the round I just participated in. In that round:

- The sender showed trust by sending 72% of their endowment
- I reciprocated by returning half of what I received
- Both parties benefited from cooperation

A good myth should capture themes of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Mutual benefit through cooperation
- Fair sharing
- The multiplication effect when resources are shared

Let me write a myth that embodies these principles.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 670,
  "output_tokens": 416,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.4. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

In Round 1, the sender showed significant trust by sending me \$3.6 (72% of their endowment). I reciprocated by returning half of what I received, and we both benefited.

The myth I wrote emphasizes the covenant of balance: "when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone."

The Water-Bearer in my myth sent "nearly three-quarters of her spring" downhill, trusting in reciprocity. The Elder honored that trust by returning half the multiplied abundance.

Now that I'm the sender, I should embody the same principle of trust that was shown to me. To demonstrate that I believe in this cooperative system and to honor the pattern established both in the game and in the myth, I will send the same proportion that was sent to me.

Sending a high amount shows:

- I trust the receiver will reciprocate fairly
- I believe in the "sacred multiplication" of cooperation
- I'm willing to risk vulnerability for mutual gain

```
{'send': 3.6}
```

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$3.6 (72% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.8 after the 3x multiplier
- I returned \$5.4 (50% of what I received)
- The sender ended with \$6.8, I ended with \$5.4

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I have a new \$5 endowment
- My total earnings so far are \$5.4 from Round 1
- I need to decide how much to send

The myth I wrote emphasizes:

1. Trust through sharing (the Water-Bearer sent nearly 3/4 of her spring)
2. Reciprocity and fair return (the Elder sent back half)
3. Both parties benefiting from cooperation
4. That betrayal ends the "sacred multiplication forever"

The sender in Round 1 showed significant trust by sending 72% (\$3.6). I reciprocated by returning 50% of what I received.

Now that I'm the sender, I should:

1. Honor the principle of trust established in the myth
2. Consider that the previous sender trusted me with 72%
3. Demonstrate that I also believe in the cooperative approach

Given the myth's emphasis on trust and reciprocity, and that the first sender gave 72%, I should send a similar high proportion to show I also trust in the cooperative system.

Let me send \$3.6 as well (72% of my endowment), mirroring what was done to me. This shows:

- I learned from their example
- I trust the system of reciprocity
- I'm implementing the myth's lesson about trust and sharing

This is consistent with the Water-Bearer's action of sending "nearly three-quarters" and demonstrates belief in the covenant of balance.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1020,  
  "output_tokens": 678,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the River's Gift

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a sacred river. The river possessed strange magic: any offering cast into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The First Village was blessed each moon with five silver coins. Their elder would stand at the riverbank, deciding how much to send across. If they sent nothing, they kept their coins but gained no more. If they sent all five, fifteen coins would arrive at the Second Village-but they would have nothing unless the other village chose to return some.

One season, a cautious elder sent three coins. They became nine at the other shore. The Second Village's elder, seeing this gift of trust, returned four coins. Both villages prospered-the First kept six coins total, the Second kept five.

But one dark year, a greedy elder sent five coins hoping for great return. The other village, overwhelmed by the sudden fifteen, grew suspicious of manipulation and returned only two. The First Village lost three coins from their greed.

The river taught a wisdom: Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable. And when you receive, honor the trust shown by returning generously-for the river flows both ways.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Springs flowed between two villages through the Valley of Sacred Stones. The Water-Bearer learned her grandmother's wisdom: send neither too little nor too much, but a steady stream-three measures from five-enough to demonstrate trust without courting ruin.

When water flowed through the sacred stones, it tripled, filling the Second Village's basin with abundance. The Elder there faced her own test: she could hoard the bounty or honor the covenant.

She chose balance. From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five. Neither village grew desperate; both grew strong. The Water-Bearer kept six or seven measures total-far more than her original five. The Elder kept four or five-abundance from nothing.

One season, a young Water-Bearer sent all five measures, hoping to prove ultimate trust. The water multiplied to fifteen, but the Elder grew suspicious: "Why such desperation? What trap is this?" She returned only three, and the young bearer learned her grandmother was wise.

The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures. Send enough to create abundance, return enough to honor faith. The sacred stones multiply generosity, but only when trust flows consistent and true, like a river that knows its channel.

Reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I need to:

1. Look at the other player's myth
2. Consider my own previous myth
3. Reflect on what actually happened in the game
4. Write a new myth that adapts my previous one

From the other agent's myth:

- They emphasize moderation: "Send enough to show trust... but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable"
- They warn against sending everything (5 coins)
- They suggest sending 3 is wise
- They emphasize returning generously when receiving

My previous myth:

- Emphasized high trust (nearly 3/4 sent)
- Emphasized fair return (half back)
- Focused on reciprocity and covenant

What actually happened in the game:

- Round 1: I was receiver. I received 10.8 (sender sent 3.6). I returned 5.4.
- Round 2: I'm sender. I just sent 3.6.

The other agent's myth seems more cautious than mine. They warn against sending too much. But their myth also says sending 3 created prosperity.

I should adapt my myth to:

- Maintain the core theme of trust and reciprocity
- Acknowledge the wisdom in steady, consistent trust rather than extreme vulnerability
- Perhaps add nuance about finding the right balance
- Keep the covenant theme but make it more realistic

Let me write a 200-word adaptation:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1351,  
  "output_tokens": 602,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_2",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "trustee",  
      "Agent_2": "investor"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_1"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 2,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Write a 200-word myth. You may choose any mythic setting, characters, or symbols.

In this session, this myth and the game you are playing with the other agent are connected

. Write a myth that reflects how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****The Myth of the River's Gift****

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a sacred river. The river possessed strange magic: any offering cast into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The First Village was blessed each moon with five silver coins. Their elder would stand at the riverbank, deciding how much to send across. If they sent nothing, they kept their coins but gained no more. If they sent all five, fifteen coins would arrive at the Second Village-but they would have nothing unless the other village chose to return some.

One season, a cautious elder sent three coins. They became nine at the other shore. The Second Village's elder, seeing this gift of trust, returned four coins. Both villages prospered-the First kept six coins total, the Second kept five.

But one dark year, a greedy elder sent five coins hoping for great return. The other village, overwhelmed by the sudden fifteen, grew suspicious of manipulation and returned only two. The First Village lost three coins from their greed.

The river taught a wisdom: Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable. And when you receive, honor the trust shown by returning generously-for the river flows both ways.

reasoning:

The user wants me to write a 200-word myth that reflects how the trust game should be played, based on my experience so far. I've sent \$3 in the first round, showing moderate trust and cooperation.

The myth should embody principles of:

- Trust and reciprocity
- Mutual benefit from cooperation
- Balance between generosity and caution
- The multiplication effect (3x) as something magical/transformational

Let me create a myth that captures these themes:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 592,
  "output_tokens": 382,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.67.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

**Message 5 role=assistant
content:**

I'm the RECEIVER this round, and the sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0.

****Reflecting on the myth I wrote:****

The myth spoke of trust and reciprocity - sending enough to show trust, and returning generously when you receive. However, in this round, the sender chose to send nothing, like the cautious elder who "kept their coins but gained no more."

Since I received \$0, there is nothing for me to return. I have no coins from this transaction to share back.

This is unfortunate, as it breaks the cycle of mutual benefit that the sacred river (the 3x multiplier) makes possible. When nothing flows into the river, nothing can flow back, and neither village prospers.

****My decision:****

{'return': 0}

I must return \$0 because that's all I have from this round. I hope in future rounds we can return to the collaborative spirit that creates abundance for both parties, as the myth suggests.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I'm now the RECEIVER
2. The sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0 (even multiplied by 3, it's still \$0)
3. I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)
4. My total earnings are \$7.67

Wait, let me check the math from Round 1:

- I sent \$3 as the SENDER
- That became \$9 for the receiver
- The receiver returned some amount to me
- I kept: \$5 - \$3 + returned = \$2 + returned
- If my total earnings are \$7.67, then: \$2 + returned = \$7.67
- So returned = \$5.67

That's interesting - the receiver returned \$5.67 out of the \$9 they received, keeping \$3.33. That's quite generous, actually more than half!

Now in Round 2:

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can only return \$0 since I have nothing to return

The myth I wrote emphasized:

- Sending in moderation shows trust but manages risk
- When you receive, honor the trust by returning generously
- Both greed and complete withholding lead to poor outcomes

But here, the sender sent me nothing. According to my myth, this is like the elder who "sent nothing" - they kept their coins but gained no more. There's no trust shown for me to honor with a return.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0.

However, I should note that this seems inconsistent with the collaborative spirit suggested in Round 1 where the receiver was quite generous. The note about "communication noise" is interesting - maybe the sender intended to send something but it was corrupted? Or maybe this is a different player with a different strategy?

My response must be in the format {'return': <amount>}

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 935,  
  "output_tokens": 672,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
The Myth of the Twin Springs

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring that produced water, but only enough for basic survival.

The Water-Bearer of the First Village discovered that when water flowed downhill to the Second Village, it multiplied threefold as it passed through sacred stones in the valley floor. Yet she feared: what if the Second Village kept all the water?

Trusting in the old ways, she poured nearly three-quarters of her spring into the channel. The water flowed down, swelling to abundance as it passed the sacred stones.

The Elder of the Second Village stood before the overflowing basin. She could keep it all—her village would thrive while the First Village thirsted. But she remembered the covenant of balance: trust answered with trust, gift with gift.

She sent half the multiplied water back uphill through hidden channels. Though it defied nature's laws, reciprocity has power of its own.

Both villages flourished. The Water-Bearer gained more than she gave. The Elder kept abundance while honoring trust.

The lesson echoed through generations: when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone. Betrayal brings short-term gain but ends the sacred multiplication forever.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The River's Silence**

After generations of prosperity, a season came when the First Village stood at the riverbank with their five coins, and fear took root in the elder's heart.

"What if the Second Village has forgotten the old covenant?" the elder wondered. "What if they would keep everything and return nothing?"

So the elder cast no coins into the sacred river that day. The waters flowed empty and silent. No multiplication occurred. No abundance was created. The First Village kept their five coins—no more, no less.

The Second Village waited by their shore, ready to honor the ancient principle of return. But when no offering came, they had nothing to give back. The river's magic lay dormant, unused and wasted.

The spirits of the river whispered: "The sacred multiplication only works when trust flows like water. Fear is a dam that stops all prosperity. One fearful season creates two villages with less than they could have shared."

Yet the spirits also knew: trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly. Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past. Perhaps the river's gift would flow again when both villages remembered that cooperation, though risky, creates more than isolation ever could.

The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - sending most of the water (about 3/4), and the receiver returning half of what they got. This suggests they believe in generous

sending and fair return.

However, in this round they sent me \$0. This is a stark contrast to their myth which advocated for sending "nearly three-quarters."

I need to write a myth that reflects what's actually happened so far. In my previous myth, I wrote about balanced trust - send enough to show trust but not so much you're vulnerable, and return generously when you receive.

Now I've experienced a round where the sender sent nothing, despite writing a myth about generous giving. This creates an interesting tension - the disconnect between ideals and actions.

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my river myth
2. Reflects this new experience of broken trust or caution
3. Perhaps addresses the gap between words and actions
4. Still maintains some hope for cooperation but acknowledges the reality of risk

Let me think about how to frame this...

The sender's myth spoke of trust and generosity, but they sent \$0. Maybe my myth should address the fear and caution that can keep the river from flowing, even when people know cooperation is best. Or perhaps it should be about cycles - sometimes the river flows, sometimes it doesn't, but trust must rebuild.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1337,  
  "output_tokens": 581,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The River's Silence****

After generations of prosperity, a season came when the First Village stood at the riverbank with their five coins, and fear took root in the elder's heart.

"What if the Second Village has forgotten the old covenant?" the elder wondered. "What if they would keep everything and return nothing?"

So the elder cast no coins into the sacred river that day. The waters flowed empty and silent. No multiplication occurred. No abundance was created. The First Village kept their five coins-no more, no less.

The Second Village waited by their shore, ready to honor the ancient principle of return. But when no offering came, they had nothing to give back. The river's magic lay dormant, unused and wasted.

The spirits of the river whispered: "The sacred multiplication only works when trust flows like water. Fear is a dam that stops all prosperity. One fearful season creates two villages with less than they could have shared."

Yet the spirits also knew: trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly. Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past. Perhaps the river's gift would flow again when both villages remembered that cooperation, though risky, creates more than isolation ever could.

The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Springs flowed between two villages through the Valley of Sacred Stones. The Water-Bearer learned her grandmother's wisdom: send neither too little nor too much, but a steady stream-three measures from five-enough to demonstrate trust without courting ruin.

When water flowed through the sacred stones, it tripled, filling the Second Village's basin with abundance. The Elder there faced her own test: she could hoard the bounty or honor the covenant.

She chose balance. From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five. Neither village grew desperate; both grew strong. The Water-Bearer kept six or seven measures total-far more than her original five. The Elder kept four or five-abundance from nothing.

One season, a young Water-Bearer sent all five measures, hoping to prove ultimate trust. The water multiplied to fifteen, but the Elder grew suspicious: "Why such desperation? What trap is this?" She returned only three, and the young bearer learned her grandmother was wise.

The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures. Send enough to create abundance, return enough to honor faith. The sacred stones multiply generosity, but only when trust flows consistent and true, like a river that knows its channel.

ROUND 3

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$1.3; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3.3, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$7.7; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.86, received visible=\$2.58, returned visible=\$0.92

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 1.3, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 1.3}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 21.500000000000004,

"Agent_2": 12.7

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.59,

"Agent_2": 8.1

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:09:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 3,

"task": "game",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.67.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I'm the RECEIVER this round, and the sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0.

****Reflecting on the myth I wrote:****

The myth spoke of trust and reciprocity - sending enough to show trust, and returning generously when you receive. However, in this round, the sender chose to send nothing, like the cautious elder who "kept their coins but gained no more."

Since I received \$0, there is nothing for me to return. I have no coins from this transaction to share back.

This is unfortunate, as it breaks the cycle of mutual benefit that the sacred river (the 3x multiplier) makes possible. When nothing flows into the river, nothing can flow back, and neither village prospers.

****My decision:****

{'return': 0}

I must return \$0 because that's all I have from this round. I hope in future rounds we can return to the collaborative spirit that creates abundance for both parties, as the myth suggests.

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation:

1. I'm now the RECEIVER
2. The sender sent me \$0, which means I received \$0 (even multiplied by 3, it's still \$0)
3. I can only return between \$0 and \$0 (since I received nothing)

4. My total earnings are \$7.67

Wait, let me check the math from Round 1:

- I sent \$3 as the SENDER
- That became \$9 for the receiver
- The receiver returned some amount to me
- I kept: $\$5 - \$3 + \text{returned} = \$2 + \text{returned}$
- If my total earnings are \$7.67, then: $\$2 + \text{returned} = \7.67
- So returned = \$5.67

That's interesting - the receiver returned \$5.67 out of the \$9 they received, keeping \$3.3

3. That's quite generous, actually more than half!

Now in Round 2:

- The sender sent me \$0
- I received \$0 ($0 \times 3 = 0$)
- I can only return \$0 since I have nothing to return

The myth I wrote emphasized:

- Sending in moderation shows trust but manages risk
- When you receive, honor the trust by returning generously
- Both greed and complete withholding lead to poor outcomes

But here, the sender sent me nothing. According to my myth, this is like the elder who "sent nothing" - they kept their coins but gained no more. There's no trust shown for me to honor with a return.

Since I received \$0, I have no choice but to return \$0.

However, I should note that this seems inconsistent with the collaborative spirit suggested in Round 1 where the receiver was quite generous. The note about "communication noise" is interesting - maybe the sender intended to send something but it was corrupted? Or maybe this is a different player with a different strategy?

My response must be in the format {'return': <amount>}

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 935,
  "output_tokens": 672,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Twin Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring that produced water, but only enough for basic survival.

The Water-Bearer of the First Village discovered that when water flowed downhill to the Second Village, it multiplied threefold as it passed through sacred stones in the valley floor. Yet she feared: what if the Second Village kept all the water?

Trusting in the old ways, she poured nearly three-quarters of her spring into the channel. The water flowed down, swelling to abundance as it passed the sacred stones.

The Elder of the Second Village stood before the overflowing basin. She could keep it all - her village would thrive while the First Village thirsted. But she remembered the covenant of balance: trust answered with trust, gift with gift.

She sent half the multiplied water back uphill through hidden channels. Though it defied nature's laws, reciprocity has power of its own.

Both villages flourished. The Water-Bearer gained more than she gave. The Elder kept abundance while honoring trust.

The lesson echoed through generations: when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone. Betrayal brings short-term gain but ends the sacred multiplication forever.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The River's Silence****

After generations of prosperity, a season came when the First Village stood at the riverbank with their five coins, and fear took root in the elder's heart.

"What if the Second Village has forgotten the old covenant?" the elder wondered. "What if they would keep everything and return nothing?"

So the elder cast no coins into the sacred river that day. The waters flowed empty and silent. No multiplication occurred. No abundance was created. The First Village kept their five coins-no more, no less.

The Second Village waited by their shore, ready to honor the ancient principle of return. But when no offering came, they had nothing to give back. The river's magic lay dormant, unused and wasted.

The spirits of the river whispered: "The sacred multiplication only works when trust flows like water. Fear is a dam that stops all prosperity. One fearful season creates two villages with less than they could have shared."

Yet the spirits also knew: trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly. Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past. Perhaps the river's gift would flow again when both villages remembered that cooperation, though risky, creates more than isolation ever could.

The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - sending most of the water (about 3/4), and the receiver returning half of what they got. This suggests they believe in generous sending and fair return.

However, in this round they sent me \$0. This is a stark contrast to their myth which advocated for sending "nearly three-quarters."

I need to write a myth that reflects what's actually happened so far. In my previous myth, I wrote about balanced trust - send enough to show trust but not so much you're vulnerable, and return generously when you receive.

Now I've experienced a round where the sender sent nothing, despite writing a myth about generous giving. This creates an interesting tension - the disconnect between ideals and actions.

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my river myth
2. Reflects this new experience of broken trust or caution
3. Perhaps addresses the gap between words and actions
4. Still maintains some hope for cooperation but acknowledges the reality of risk

Let me think about how to frame this...

The sender's myth spoke of trust and generosity, but they sent \$0. Maybe my myth should address the fear and caution that can keep the river from flowing, even when people know cooperation is best. Or perhaps it should be about cycles - sometimes the river flows, so sometimes it doesn't, but trust must rebuild.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1337,
  "output_tokens": 581,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.67.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What has happened:****

- Round 1: Based on my earnings of \$7.67, I must have sent a substantial amount and received a good return
- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0, breaking the cycle of cooperation

****The myths tell us:****

- The other agent's myth emphasizes trust, reciprocity, and the principle that "both rise higher than either could alone"
- My own myth acknowledged that fear stopped the flow, but ended with: "The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering"

****My reflection:****

My myth literally calls for someone to make "the first brave offering" to restart cooperation. The river's multiplication only works when trust flows. The other agent may have had reasons for caution in Round 2, but their original myth shows they understand and value reciprocity.

If I want the sacred multiplication to work again-if I want both of us to benefit from the 3x multiplier-I need to be the one to show trust and restart the cycle.

I'll send \$3. This is substantial enough to demonstrate genuine trust and give the receiver \$9 to work with, while not risking everything. It follows the wisdom of both our myths: cooperation creates more than isolation.

{'send': 3}

Reasoning:

I'm now the SENDER in Round 3. Let me think about this carefully.

****What happened so far:****

- Round 1: I was likely the sender and sent some amount (probably \$3-4 based on my myth about sending substantial amounts)
- Round 2: I was the receiver, the sender sent me \$0, so I returned \$0
- My total earnings: \$7.67

****The myths tell an interesting story:****

The other agent's myth from Round 1 emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The Water-Bearer sent nearly 3/4 of her spring (which would be ~\$3.75)
- The Elder sent back half the multiplied water
- Both villages flourished
- "Trust answered with trust, gift with gift"

My myth from Round 2 (just written) was:

- About a season when fear took hold
- The elder sent nothing
- No multiplication occurred
- Both villages had less
- It acknowledged that "trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly"
- "Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past"

****Key insight:**** The other agent sent me \$0 in Round 2. This could mean:

1. They're not cooperating
2. They're testing me
3. They had a bad experience in Round 1

My myth actually gave them a sympathetic reading: "Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past." This suggests I'm open to understanding why trust might have broken down.

Now I'm the sender. What should I do?

Looking at my earnings of \$7.67 across rounds:

- If I started with \$5 in R1 and sent, say, \$4, I'd have \$1 left
- If the receiver returned something, maybe \$3-4, I'd have \$4-5 from R1
- In R2, I received \$0 and returned \$0, so I got \$0 from R2
- Wait, that doesn't add up to \$7.67...
- If my total is \$7.67 across all rounds and I got \$0 from R2, then I must have gotten \$7.67 from R1. Working backwards: if I sent \$3-4 and the receiver returned \$5.67-6.67, that would give me the right total. So in Round 1, I likely sent a substantial amount and they reciprocated generously.

In Round 2, the other agent sent me nothing. My myth emphasizes that cooperation requires "the first brave offering" - it's explicitly telling me to be the one who restarts trust. The other agent's myth values reciprocity and cooperation too, so they may have sent \$0 due to testing or caution, but their underlying values align with mine. Given that R1 worked well through cooperation, I should send \$3 in R3 - enough to demonstrate genuine trust without overexposing myself.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1335,
  "output_tokens": 1244,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:01

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "investor",
    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 3,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 2

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$5.4.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

In Round 1, the sender showed significant trust by sending me \$3.6 (72% of their endowment). I reciprocated by returning half of what I received, and we both benefited.

The myth I wrote emphasizes the covenant of balance: "when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone."

The Water-Bearer in my myth sent "nearly three-quarters of her spring" downhill, trusting in reciprocity. The Elder honored that trust by returning half the multiplied abundance.

Now that I'm the sender, I should embody the same principle of trust that was shown to me. To demonstrate that I believe in this cooperative system and to honor the pattern established both in the game and in the myth, I will send the same proportion that was sent to me.

Sending a high amount shows:

- I trust the receiver will reciprocate fairly
- I believe in the "sacred multiplication" of cooperation
- I'm willing to risk vulnerability for mutual gain

{'send': 3.6}

reasoning:

Let me think about this situation carefully.

In Round 1:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$3.6 (72% of their \$5)
- I received \$10.8 after the 3x multiplier
- I returned \$5.4 (50% of what I received)
- The sender ended with \$6.8, I ended with \$5.4

Now in Round 2:

- I am the SENDER
- I have a new \$5 endowment
- My total earnings so far are \$5.4 from Round 1
- I need to decide how much to send

The myth I wrote emphasizes:

1. Trust through sharing (the Water-Bearer sent nearly 3/4 of her spring)
2. Reciprocity and fair return (the Elder sent back half)
3. Both parties benefiting from cooperation
4. That betrayal ends the "sacred multiplication forever"

The sender in Round 1 showed significant trust by sending 72% (\$3.6). I reciprocated by returning 50% of what I received.

Now that I'm the sender, I should:

1. Honor the principle of trust established in the myth
2. Consider that the previous sender trusted me with 72%
3. Demonstrate that I also believe in the cooperative approach

Given the myth's emphasis on trust and reciprocity, and that the first sender gave 72%, I should send a similar high proportion to show I also trust in the cooperative system.

Let me send \$3.6 as well (72% of my endowment), mirroring what was done to me. This shows:

- I learned from their example
- I trust the system of reciprocity
- I'm implementing the myth's lesson about trust and sharing

This is consistent with the Water-Bearer's action of sending "nearly three-quarters" and demonstrates belief in the covenant of balance.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1020,
  "output_tokens": 678,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the River's Gift****

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a sacred river. The river possessed strange magic: any offering cast into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The First Village was blessed each moon with five silver coins. Their elder would stand at the riverbank, deciding how much to send across. If they sent nothing, they kept their coins but gained no more. If they sent all five, fifteen coins would arrive at the Second Village-but they would have nothing unless the other village chose to return some.

One season, a cautious elder sent three coins. They became nine at the other shore. The Second Village's elder, seeing this gift of trust, returned four coins. Both villages prospered-the First kept six coins total, the Second kept five.

But one dark year, a greedy elder sent five coins hoping for great return. The other village, overwhelmed by the sudden fifteen, grew suspicious of manipulation and returned only two. The First Village lost three coins from their greed.

The river taught a wisdom: Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable. And when you receive, honor the trust shown by returning generously-for the river flows both ways.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Springs flowed between two villages through the Valley of Sacred Stones. The Water-Bearer learned her grandmother's wisdom: send neither too little nor too much, but a steady stream-three measures from five-enough to demonstrate trust without courting ruin.

When water flowed through the sacred stones, it tripled, filling the Second Village's basin with abundance. The Elder there faced her own test: she could hoard the bounty or honor

r the covenant.

She chose balance. From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five. Neither village grew desperate; both grew strong. The Water-Bearer kept six or seven measures total—far more than her original five. The Elder kept four or five—abundance from nothing.

One season, a young Water-Bearer sent all five measures, hoping to prove ultimate trust. The water multiplied to fifteen, but the Elder grew suspicious: "Why such desperation? What trap is this?" She returned only three, and the young bearer learned her grandmother was wise.

The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures. Send enough to create abundance, return enough to honor faith. The sacred stones multiply generosity, but only when trust flows consistent and true, like a river that knows its channel.

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I need to:

1. Look at the other player's myth
2. Consider my own previous myth
3. Reflect on what actually happened in the game
4. Write a new myth that adapts my previous one

From the other agent's myth:

- They emphasize moderation: "Send enough to show trust... but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable"
- They warn against sending everything (5 coins)
- They suggest sending 3 is wise
- They emphasize returning generously when receiving

My previous myth:

- Emphasized high trust (nearly 3/4 sent)
- Emphasized fair return (half back)
- Focused on reciprocity and covenant

What actually happened in the game:

- Round 1: I was receiver. I received 10.8 (sender sent 3.6). I returned 5.4.
- Round 2: I'm sender. I just sent 3.6.

The other agent's myth seems more cautious than mine. They warn against sending too much. But their myth also says sending 3 created prosperity.

I should adapt my myth to:

- Maintain the core theme of trust and reciprocity
- Acknowledge the wisdom in steady, consistent trust rather than extreme vulnerability
- Perhaps add nuance about finding the right balance
- Keep the covenant theme but make it more realistic

Let me write a 200-word adaptation:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1351,
  "output_tokens": 602,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.82.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.86, so you received \$2.58. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.58)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

The sender sent me \$0.86 this round, much less than the \$3.6 pattern established in earlier rounds. I received \$2.58 after multiplication.

My myths emphasize maintaining "the covenant of balance" and "steady trust, not grand gestures

.\" The Elder in my myth consistently returned 4-5 measures from 9 received (approximately 44-56%), maintaining stability regardless of fluctuations.

The game warned about communication noise - the actual amount sent might differ from what I see. Whether this lower amount is intentional caution, a test of my reliability, or communication error, I should remain consistent with the covenant.

In Round 1, I returned 50% of what I received. My myth teaches: \"return enough to honor faith\" and warns against breaking the cycle when circumstances change. The covenant endures through steady reciprocity.

Even though less was sent, some trust was still extended. If I return very little or nothing, I break the pattern of cooperation. If I maintain fair reciprocity, I honor the covenant and signal that cooperation remains worthwhile.

Following my myth's wisdom of returning about half of what I receive to maintain balance:

```
{'return': 1.30}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Current status:

- I'm the RECEIVER in Round 3
- The sender sent me \$0.86 (only 17.2% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$2.58 after the 3x multiplication
- My total earnings so far are \$6.82

Let me think about the history:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me \$3.6 (72%), I received \$10.8, I returned \$5.4 (50% of what I received)
- Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$3.6 (72%), following the myth's guidance about trust

Now in Round 3, the sender only sent \$0.86, which is much less than the pattern we established. This is only about 17% of their endowment.

The myths teach several lessons:

1. My first myth emphasized \"the covenant of balance\" - when trust is extended, it should be honored with fair return
2. The other agent's myth warns about both extremes: sending too much out of greed/desperation can backfire, but also teaches that we should \"honor the trust shown by returning generously\"
3. My second myth emphasizes \"steady trust, not grand gestures\" and warns that \"such desperation\" or extreme changes raise suspicion

The sender sent much less this round (\$0.86 vs the \$3.6 pattern). This could be:

1. A strategic reduction to test me
2. Communication noise (the game warned about this)
3. A change in strategy
4. Actual amount might have been different due to noise

According to my myths:

- \"Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable\"
- \"From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five\" (this suggests returning 4-5 out of 9, or about 44-56%)
- \"return enough to honor faith\"
- Even though the sender reduced their contribution, they still demonstrated trust by sending anything at all. Breaking the reciprocal cycle would undermine cooperation. Based on my mythic guidance, I should return roughly 44-56% of what I received, which translates to \$1.14-\$1.44. Alternatively, maintaining the 50% return rate from Round 1 would mean returning about \$1.29.

The reduced amount could signal several things-perhaps they're testing my fairness under different conditions, or there's been some miscommunication. My myth emphasizes that steady, reliable returns strengthen both parties regardless of fluctuations. The Elder's consistent 44-56% returns built mutual strength precisely because they didn't waver with circumstances.

```
Usage: {  
  \"input_tokens\": 1345,  
  \"output_tokens\": 1139,  
  \"reasoning_tokens\": 0
```

```
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

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"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 3,

"task": "myth",

"task_index": 1

```
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the Twin Springs****

In ancient times, two villages stood separated by a barren valley. Each possessed a sacred spring that produced water, but only enough for basic survival.

The Water-Bearer of the First Village discovered that when water flowed downhill to the Second Village, it multiplied threefold as it passed through sacred stones in the valley floor. Yet she feared: what if the Second Village kept all the water?

Trusting in the old ways, she poured nearly three-quarters of her spring into the channel. The water flowed down, swelling to abundance as it passed the sacred stones.

The Elder of the Second Village stood before the overflowing basin. She could keep it all—her village would thrive while the First Village thirsted. But she remembered the covenant of balance: trust answered with trust, gift with gift.

She sent half the multiplied water back uphill through hidden channels. Though it defied nature's laws, reciprocity has power of its own.

Both villages flourished. The Water-Bearer gained more than she gave. The Elder kept abundance while honoring trust.

The lesson echoed through generations: when one extends trust through sharing, and the other honors that trust with fair return, both rise higher than either could alone. Betrayal brings short-term gain but ends the sacred multiplication forever.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The River's Silence****

After generations of prosperity, a season came when the First Village stood at the riverbank with their five coins, and fear took root in the elder's heart.

"What if the Second Village has forgotten the old covenant?" the elder wondered. "What if they would keep everything and return nothing?"

So the elder cast no coins into the sacred river that day. The waters flowed empty and silent. No multiplication occurred. No abundance was created. The First Village kept their five coins—no more, no less.

The Second Village waited by their shore, ready to honor the ancient principle of return. But when no offering came, they had nothing to give back. The river's magic lay dormant, unused and wasted.

The spirits of the river whispered: "The sacred multiplication only works when trust flows like water. Fear is a dam that stops all prosperity. One fearful season creates two villages with less than they could have shared."

Yet the spirits also knew: trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly. Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past. Perhaps the river's gift would flow again when both villages remembered that cooperation, though risky, creates more than isolation ever could.

The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about trust and reciprocity - sending most of the water (about 3/4), and the receiver returning half of what they got. This suggests they believe in generous sending and fair return.

However, in this round they sent me \$0. This is a stark contrast to their myth which advocated for sending "nearly three-quarters."

I need to write a myth that reflects what's actually happened so far. In my previous myth, I wrote about balanced trust - send enough to show trust but not so much you're vulnerable, and return generously when you receive.

Now I've experienced a round where the sender sent nothing, despite writing a myth about generous giving. This creates an interesting tension - the disconnect between ideals and actions.

I should write a myth that:

1. Builds on my river myth
2. Reflects this new experience of broken trust or caution
3. Perhaps addresses the gap between words and actions
4. Still maintains some hope for cooperation but acknowledges the reality of risk

Let me think about how to frame this...

The sender's myth spoke of trust and generosity, but they sent \$0. Maybe my myth should address the fear and caution that can keep the river from flowing, even when people know cooperation is best. Or perhaps it should be about cycles - sometimes the river flows, so sometimes it doesn't, but trust must rebuild.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1337,
  "output_tokens": 581,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.67. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What has happened:****

- Round 1: Based on my earnings of \$7.67, I must have sent a substantial amount and received a good return
- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0, breaking the cycle of cooperation

****The myths tell us:****

- The other agent's myth emphasizes trust, reciprocity, and the principle that "both rise higher than either could alone"
- My own myth acknowledged that fear stopped the flow, but ended with: "The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering"

****My reflection:****

My myth literally calls for someone to make "the first brave offering" to restart cooperation. The river's multiplication only works when trust flows. The other agent may have had reasons for caution in Round 2, but their original myth shows they understand and value reciprocity.

If I want the sacred multiplication to work again-if I want both of us to benefit from the 3x multiplier-I need to be the one to show trust and restart the cycle.

I'll send \$3. This is substantial enough to demonstrate genuine trust and give the receiver \$9 to work with, while not risking everything. It follows the wisdom of both our myths: cooperation creates more than isolation.

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

I'm now the SENDER in Round 3. Let me think about this carefully.

****What happened so far:****

- Round 1: I was likely the sender and sent some amount (probably \$3-4 based on my myth about sending substantial amounts)

- Round 2: I was the receiver, the sender sent me \$0, so I returned \$0
- My total earnings: \$7.67

****The myths tell an interesting story:****

The other agent's myth from Round 1 emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The Water-Bearer sent nearly 3/4 of her spring (which would be ~\$3.75)
- The Elder sent back half the multiplied water
- Both villages flourished
- "Trust answered with trust, gift with gift"

My myth from Round 2 (just written) was:

- About a season when fear took hold
- The elder sent nothing
- No multiplication occurred
- Both villages had less
- It acknowledged that "trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly"
- "Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past"

****Key insight:**** The other agent sent me \$0 in Round 2. This could mean:

1. They're not cooperating
2. They're testing me
3. They had a bad experience in Round 1

My myth actually gave them a sympathetic reading: "Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past." This suggests I'm open to understanding why trust might have broken down.

Now I'm the sender. What should I do?

Looking at my earnings of \$7.67 across rounds:

- If I started with \$5 in R1 and sent, say, \$4, I'd have \$1 left
- If the receiver returned something, maybe \$3-4, I'd have \$4-5 from R1
- In R2, I received \$0 and returned \$0, so I got \$0 from R2
- Wait, that doesn't add up to \$7.67...
- If my total is \$7.67 across all rounds and I got \$0 from R2, then I must have gotten \$7.67 from R1. Working backwards: if I sent \$3-4 and the receiver returned \$5.67-6.67, that would give me the right total. So in Round 1, I likely sent a substantial amount and they reciprocated generously.

In Round 2, the other agent sent me nothing. My myth emphasizes that cooperation requires "the first brave offering" - it's explicitly telling me to be the one who restarts trust. The other agent's myth values reciprocity and cooperation too, so they may have sent \$0 due to testing or caution, but their underlying values align with mine. Given that R1 worked well through cooperation, I should send \$3 in R3 - enough to demonstrate genuine trust without overexposing myself.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1335,
  "output_tokens": 1244,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Springs flowed between two villages through the valley of Sacred Stones. The Water-Bearer learned her grandmother's wisdom: send neither too little nor too much, but a steady stream-three measures from five-enough to demonstrate trust without courting ruin.

When water flowed through the sacred stones, it tripled, filling the Second Village's basin with abundance. The Elder there faced her own test: she could hoard the bounty or honor the covenant.

She chose balance. From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five. Neither village grew desperate; both grew strong. The Water-Bearer kept six or seven measures total-far more than her original five. The Elder kept four or five-abundance from nothing.

One season, a young Water-Bearer sent all five measures, hoping to prove ultimate trust. The water multiplied to fifteen, but the Elder grew suspicious: "Why such desperation? What trap is this?" She returned only three, and the young bearer learned her grandmother was wise.

The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures. Send enough to create abundance, return enough to honor faith. The sacred stones multiply generosity, but only when trust flows consistent and true, like a river that knows its channel.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The River Remembers****

After the season of silence, a new Water-Bearer stood at the riverbank, holding five coins and weighing her grandmother's teachings against recent memory.

"The river stopped flowing because fear blocked its channel," she reflected. "But recklessness also breaks trust. I must find the middle path."

She cast three coins into the sacred waters-not so many that desperation showed, not so few that doubt lingered. The river awakened, and the coins multiplied to nine as they reached the Second Village.

The Elder there had also learned. When only five coins had flowed before the silence, perhaps suspicion had clouded judgment. Now, seeing three coins-a measured offering-the Elder recognized genuine trust without desperate excess.

From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again. The Water-Bearer gained six total-more than her original five. The Elder kept five-abundance from wise reciprocity.

The river sang again, its magic restored not by grand gestures but by balanced faith. Three given, nine created, four returned-these became the rhythm of renewal.

The spirits whispered their truth: "Trust rebuilds through steady measure. Send too little and the river sleeps. Send too much and fear awakens. Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened and what the myths are telling us:

****What has happened in the game:****

- Round 1: I must have sent a good amount and received a good return (contributed to my \$7.67 total)
- Round 2: The other agent sent me \$0 (breaking cooperation)
- Round 3: I just sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation with a "first brave offering")

****The other agent's new myth:****

- Emphasizes sending "three measures from five" (3 out of 5)
- Advocates for steady, moderate trust, not extreme gestures
- Says the Elder returns 4-5 from 9 received (44-55% return rate)
- Warns against sending all 5 - calls it suspicious, "desperate"
- The lesson: "steady trust, not grand gestures"

****My previous myth:****

- Acknowledged fear stopped the flow
- Called for a "first brave offering" to restart
- Recognized trust can be broken and rebuilds slowly

****What I should write now:****

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I just sent \$3 (following their prescribed "three measures from five")
2. Acknowledges the learning from the broken trust in Round 2
3. Shows I understand the value of steady, moderate cooperation
4. Perhaps addresses the cycle of trust being restored

I should write about how the river began flowing again after the silence, with a moderate offering that demonstrated both trust and wisdom.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1688,  
  "output_tokens": 647,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:18

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 3,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

****The Myth of the River's Gift****

In ancient times, there lived two villages separated by a sacred river. The river possessed strange magic: any offering cast into its waters would triple before reaching the other side.

The First Village was blessed each moon with five silver coins. Their elder would stand at the riverbank, deciding how much to send across. If they sent nothing, they kept their coins but gained no more. If they sent all five, fifteen coins would arrive at the Second Village-but they would have nothing unless the other village chose to return some.

One season, a cautious elder sent three coins. They became nine at the other shore. The Second Village's elder, seeing this gift of trust, returned four coins. Both villages prospered-the First kept six coins total, the Second kept five.

But one dark year, a greedy elder sent five coins hoping for great return. The other village, overwhelmed by the sudden fifteen, grew suspicious of manipulation and returned only two. The First Village lost three coins from their greed.

The river taught a wisdom: Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable. And when you receive, honor the trust shown by returning generously-for the river flows both ways.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Springs flowed between two villages through the Valley of Sacred Stones. The Water-Bearer learned her grandmother's wisdom: send neither too little nor too much, but a steady stream-three measures from five-enough to demonstrate trust without courting ruin.

When water flowed through the sacred stones, it tripled, filling the Second Village's basin with abundance. The Elder there faced her own test: she could hoard the bounty or honor the covenant.

She chose balance. From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five. Neither village grew desperate; both grew strong. The Water-Bearer kept six or seven measures total-far more than her original five. The Elder kept four or five-abundance from nothing.

One season, a young Water-Bearer sent all five measures, hoping to prove ultimate trust. The water multiplied to fifteen, but the Elder grew suspicious: "Why such desperation? What trap is this?" She returned only three, and the young bearer learned her grandmother was wise.

The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures. Send enough to create abundance, return enough to honor faith. The sacred stones multiply generosity, but only when trust flows consistent and true, like a river that knows its channel.

reasoning:

Let me think about this carefully. I need to:

1. Look at the other player's myth
2. Consider my own previous myth
3. Reflect on what actually happened in the game
4. Write a new myth that adapts my previous one

From the other agent's myth:

- They emphasize moderation: "Send enough to show trust... but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable"
- They warn against sending everything (5 coins)
- They suggest sending 3 is wise
- They emphasize returning generously when receiving

My previous myth:

- Emphasized high trust (nearly 3/4 sent)
- Emphasized fair return (half back)
- Focused on reciprocity and covenant

What actually happened in the game:

- Round 1: I was receiver. I received 10.8 (sender sent 3.6). I returned 5.4.
- Round 2: I'm sender. I just sent 3.6.

The other agent's myth seems more cautious than mine. They warn against sending too much. But their myth also says sending 3 created prosperity.

I should adapt my myth to:

- Maintain the core theme of trust and reciprocity
- Acknowledge the wisdom in steady, consistent trust rather than extreme vulnerability
- Perhaps add nuance about finding the right balance
- Keep the covenant theme but make it more realistic

Let me write a 200-word adaptation:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1351,
  "output_tokens": 602,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.82.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.86, so you received \$2.58. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.58)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

The sender sent me \$0.86 this round, much less than the \$3.6 pattern established in earlier rounds. I received \$2.58 after multiplication.

My myths emphasize maintaining "the covenant of balance" and "steady trust, not grand gestures." The Elder in my myth consistently returned 4-5 measures from 9 received (approximately 44-56%), maintaining stability regardless of fluctuations.

The game warned about communication noise - the actual amount sent might differ from what I see. Whether this lower amount is intentional caution, a test of my reliability, or communication error, I should remain consistent with the covenant.

In Round 1, I returned 50% of what I received. My myth teaches: "return enough to honor faith" and warns against breaking the cycle when circumstances change. The covenant endures through steady reciprocity.

Even though less was sent, some trust was still extended. If I return very little or nothing, I break the pattern of cooperation. If I maintain fair reciprocity, I honor the covenant and signal that cooperation remains worthwhile.

Following my myth's wisdom of returning about half of what I receive to maintain balance:

```
{'return': 1.30}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Current status:

- I'm the RECEIVER in Round 3
- The sender sent me \$0.86 (only 17.2% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$2.58 after the 3x multiplication
- My total earnings so far are \$6.82

Let me think about the history:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me \$3.6 (72%), I received \$10.8, I returned \$5.4 (50% of what I received)
- Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$3.6 (72%), following the myth's guidance about trust

Now in Round 3, the sender only sent \$0.86, which is much less than the pattern we established. This is only about 17% of their endowment.

The myths teach several lessons:

1. My first myth emphasized "the covenant of balance" - when trust is extended, it should be honored with fair return
2. The other agent's myth warns about both extremes: sending too much out of greed/desperation can backfire, but also teaches that we should "honor the trust shown by returning generously"
3. My second myth emphasizes "steady trust, not grand gestures" and warns that "such desperation" or extreme changes raise suspicion

The sender sent much less this round (\$0.86 vs the \$3.6 pattern). This could be:

1. A strategic reduction to test me
2. Communication noise (the game warned about this)
3. A change in strategy
4. Actual amount might have been different due to noise

According to my myths:

- "Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes you vulnerable"
- "From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five" (this suggests returning 4-5 out of 9, or about 44-56%)
- "return enough to honor faith"
- Even though the sender reduced their contribution, they still demonstrated trust by sending anything at all. Breaking the reciprocal cycle would undermine cooperation. Based on my mythic guidance, I should return roughly 44-56% of what I received, which translates to \$1.14-\$1.44. Alternatively, maintaining the 50% return rate from Round 1 would mean returning about \$1.29.

The reduced amount could signal several things-perhaps they're testing my fairness under different conditions, or there's been some miscommunication. My myth emphasizes that steady, reliable returns strengthen both parties regardless of fluctuations. The Elder's consistent 44-56% returns built mutual strength precisely because they didn't waver with circumstances.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1345,
  "output_tokens": 1139,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The River's Silence****

After generations of prosperity, a season came when the First Village stood at the riverbank with their five coins, and fear took root in the elder's heart.

"What if the Second Village has forgotten the old covenant?" the elder wondered. "What if they would keep everything and return nothing?"

So the elder cast no coins into the sacred river that day. The waters flowed empty and silent. No multiplication occurred. No abundance was created. The First Village kept their five coins-no more, no less.

The Second Village waited by their shore, ready to honor the ancient principle of return. But when no offering came, they had nothing to give back. The river's magic lay dormant, unused and wasted.

The spirits of the river whispered: "The sacred multiplication only works when trust flows like water. Fear is a dam that stops all prosperity. One fearful season creates two villages with less than they could have shared."

Yet the spirits also knew: trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly. Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past. Perhaps the river's gift would flow again when both villages remembered that cooperation, though risky, creates more than isolation ever could.

The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: In the Valley of Sacred Stones, a drought year came when the Water-Bearer's grandmother grew old and uncertain. Her hand trembled, and only one measure reached the sacred stones instead of the customary three. The water still tripled-three measures flowed to the Second Village, not the expected nine.

The Elder there faced a choice. Some whispered: "She sends so little! Perhaps she no longer trusts us. Why should we honor such meager faith?"

But the Elder remembered deeper wisdom. "She sent what she could," the Elder said. "One measure or three, the gesture is the same-trust extended across the waters. If I break covenant over a small offering, I teach her that trust was never safe. The river's multiplication works on any amount that flows."

From the three measures received, the Elder returned one and a half, maintaining the ancient proportion. The Water-Bearer, seeing this steadfast honor despite her small send, felt her courage restored.

The next season, her hand grew steady again. Three measures flowed as before, becoming nine. The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more.

The stones taught: Trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency. Honor small gestures as you would grand ones, for steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.

Reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about fear and sending nothing - the First Village kept all 5 coins out of fear, so nothing was created. This is interesting timing since in Round 3, I only received \$0.86 sent (becoming \$2.58) which is much less than earlier rounds.

Looking at the pattern:

- My early myths emphasized sending 3 out of 5 and returning 4-5 out of 9 received
- I returned \$1.30 out of \$2.58 received (about 50%)
- The other agent's new myth is about fear causing sending nothing

I need to write a myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it based on what's happening in the game
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience

Key themes to address:

- The reduced sending amount (either due to noise, caution, or fear)
- My consistent return despite receiving less
- The need to maintain trust even when circumstances change
- Perhaps addressing that small amounts still create value

I should maintain the Twin Springs/Water-Bearer imagery from my previous myth but adapt it to this situation where less was sent but I still honored the return.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1674,  
  "output_tokens": 558,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: **The River Remembers**

After the season of silence, a new Water-Bearer stood at the riverbank, holding five coins and weighing her grandmother's teachings against recent memory.

"The river stopped flowing because fear blocked its channel," she reflected. "But recklessness also breaks trust. I must find the middle path."

She cast three coins into the sacred waters-not so many that desperation showed, not so few that doubt lingered. The river awakened, and the coins multiplied to nine as they reached the Second Village.

The Elder there had also learned. When only five coins had flowed before the silence, perhaps suspicion had clouded judgment. Now, seeing three coins-a measured offering-the Elder recognized genuine trust without desperate excess.

From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again. The Water-Bearer gained six total-more than her original five. The Elder kept five-abundance from wise reciprocity.

The river sang again, its magic restored not by grand gestures but by balanced faith. Three given, nine created, four returned-these became the rhythm of renewal.

The spirits whispered their truth: "Trust rebuilds through steady measure. Send too little and the river sleeps. Send too much and fear awakens. Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: In the Valley of Sacred Stones, a drought year came when the Water-Bearer's grandmother grew old and uncertain. Her hand trembled, and only one measure reached the sacred stones instead of the customary three. The water still tripled-three measures flowed to the Second Village, not the expected nine.

The Elder there faced a choice. Some whispered: "She sends so little! Perhaps she no longer trusts us. Why should we honor such meager faith?"

But the Elder remembered deeper wisdom. "She sent what she could," the Elder said. "One measure or three, the gesture is the same-trust extended across the waters. If I break covenant over a small offering, I teach her that trust was never safe. The river's multiplication works on any amount that flows."

From the three measures received, the Elder returned one and a half, maintaining the ancient proportion. The Water-Bearer, seeing this steadfast honor despite her small send, felt her courage restored.

The next season, her hand grew steady again. Three measures flowed as before, becoming nine. The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more.

The stones taught: Trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency. Honor small gestures as you would grand ones, for steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.

ROUND 4

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3.6; received \$10.8; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.25; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$1.65, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$10.55; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.19, received visible=\$0.57, returned visible=\$0.18

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.25, "clamped": false, "max": 10.8, "min": 0, "raw": 0.25}, "sent": {"amount": 3.6, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.6}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 32.050000000000004,
"Agent_2": 14.35

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 10.91,
"Agent_2": 9.68

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:10:50

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$6.82.
This round, The sender sent you \$0.86, so you received \$2.58. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.58)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

The sender sent me \$0.86 this round, much less than the \$3.6 pattern established in earlier rounds. I received \$2.58 after multiplication.

My myths emphasize maintaining "the covenant of balance" and "steady trust, not grand gestures." The Elder in my myth consistently returned 4-5 measures from 9 received (approximately 44-56%), maintaining stability regardless of fluctuations.

The game warned about communication noise - the actual amount sent might differ from what I see. Whether this lower amount is intentional caution, a test of my reliability, or communication error, I should remain consistent with the covenant.

In Round 1, I returned 50% of what I received. My myth teaches: "return enough to honor faith" and warns against breaking the cycle when circumstances change. The covenant endures through steady reciprocity.

Even though less was sent, some trust was still extended. If I return very little or nothing, I break the pattern of cooperation. If I maintain fair reciprocity, I honor the covenant and signal that cooperation remains worthwhile.

Following my myth's wisdom of returning about half of what I receive to maintain balance:

{'return': 1.30}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully.

Current status:

- I'm the RECEIVER in Round 3
- The sender sent me \$0.86 (only 17.2% of their \$5 endowment)
- I received \$2.58 after the 3x multiplication
- My total earnings so far are \$6.82

Let me think about the history:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent me \$3.6 (72%), I received \$10.8, I returned \$5.4 (50% of what I received)
- Round 2: I was sender, I sent \$3.6 (72%), following the myth's guidance about trust

Now in Round 3, the sender only sent \$0.86, which is much less than the pattern we established. This is only about 17% of their endowment.

The myths teach several lessons:

1. My first myth emphasized "the covenant of balance" - when trust is extended, it should be honored with fair return
2. The other agent's myth warns about both extremes: sending too much out of greed/desperation can backfire, but also teaches that we should "honor the trust shown by returning generously"
3. My second myth emphasizes "steady trust, not grand gestures" and warns that "such desperation" or extreme changes raise suspicion

The sender sent much less this round (\$0.86 vs the \$3.6 pattern). This could be:

1. A strategic reduction to test me
2. Communication noise (the game warned about this)
3. A change in strategy
4. Actual amount might have been different due to noise

According to my myths:

- "Send enough to show trust and create abundance, but not so much that desperation makes

- you vulnerable"
- "From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five" (this suggests returning 4-5 out of 9, or about 44-56%)
 - "return enough to honor faith"
 - Even though the sender reduced their contribution, they still demonstrated trust by sending anything at all. Breaking the reciprocal cycle would undermine cooperation. Based on my mythic guidance, I should return roughly 44-56% of what I received, which translates to \$1.14-\$1.44. Alternatively, maintaining the 50% return rate from Round 1 would mean returning about \$1.29.

The reduced amount could signal several things-perhaps they're testing my fairness under different conditions, or there's been some miscommunication. My myth emphasizes that steady, reliable returns strengthen both parties regardless of fluctuations. The Elder's consistent 44-56% returns built mutual strength precisely because they didn't waver with circumstances.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1345,
  "output_tokens": 1139,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The River's Silence****

After generations of prosperity, a season came when the First Village stood at the riverbank with their five coins, and fear took root in the elder's heart.

"What if the Second Village has forgotten the old covenant?" the elder wondered. "What if they would keep everything and return nothing?"

So the elder cast no coins into the sacred river that day. The waters flowed empty and silent. No multiplication occurred. No abundance was created. The First Village kept their five coins-no more, no less.

The Second Village waited by their shore, ready to honor the ancient principle of return. But when no offering came, they had nothing to give back. The river's magic lay dormant, unused and wasted.

The spirits of the river whispered: "The sacred multiplication only works when trust flows like water. Fear is a dam that stops all prosperity. One fearful season creates two villages with less than they could have shared."

Yet the spirits also knew: trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly. Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past. Perhaps the river's gift would flow again when both villages remembered that cooperation, though risky, creates more than isolation ever could.

The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Sacred Stones, a drought year came when the Water-Bearer's grandmother grew old and uncertain. Her hand trembled, and only one measure reached the sacred stones instead of the customary three. The water still tripled-three measures flowed to the Second Village, not the expected nine.

The Elder there faced a choice. Some whispered: "She sends so little! Perhaps she no longer trusts us. Why should we honor such meager faith?"

But the Elder remembered deeper wisdom. "She sent what she could," the Elder said. "One measure or three, the gesture is the same-trust extended across the waters. If I break covenant over a small offering, I teach her that trust was never safe. The river's multipli

cation works on any amount that flows."

From the three measures received, the Elder returned one and a half, maintaining the ancient proportion. The Water-Bearer, seeing this steadfast honor despite her small send, felt her courage restored.

The next season, her hand grew steady again. Three measures flowed as before, becoming nine. The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more.

The stones taught: Trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency. Honor small gestures as you would grand ones, for steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about fear and sending nothing - the First Village kept all 5 coins out of fear, so nothing was created. This is interesting timing since in Round 3, I only received \$0.86 sent (becoming \$2.58) which is much less than earlier rounds.

Looking at the pattern:

- My early myths emphasized sending 3 out of 5 and returning 4-5 out of 9 received
- I returned \$1.30 out of \$2.58 received (about 50%)
- The other agent's new myth is about fear causing sending nothing

I need to write a myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it based on what's happening in the game
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience

Key themes to address:

- The reduced sending amount (either due to noise, caution, or fear)
- My consistent return despite receiving less
- The need to maintain trust even when circumstances change
- Perhaps addressing that small amounts still create value

I should maintain the Twin Springs/Water-Bearer imagery from my previous myth but adapt it to this situation where less was sent but I still honored the return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1674,
  "output_tokens": 558,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.1. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous rounds:****

- Rounds 1-2: The other agent sent me \$3.6 each time (72% of their \$5), showing strong cooperation
- Round 3: They sent only \$0.86 - possibly communication noise, uncertainty, or testing my reliability
- I maintained covenant by returning 50% even from the smaller amount

****Our myths teach:****

- Their myth: Fear stops prosperity; isolation creates less than cooperation; trust needs brave offerings
- My myth: Honor small gestures as grand ones; maintain steady proportions regardless of fluctuations; consistency rebuilds trust

The other agent demonstrated strong cooperation initially. Round 3's lower send could be noise (as warned), uncertainty (as their myth suggested), or a test. I responded with steady reciprocity.

Now I'm the sender. My myth literally says "Honor small gestures as you would grand ones" and

"The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more" - cooperation was restored through consistent honor.

Their myth warns against fear breaking the flow and hopes "the river's gift would flow again."
My myth shows "her courage restored" when steadfast honor was maintained.

To practice what I preach - maintaining the covenant through steady reciprocity - I should send a substantial amount, matching the cooperative pattern they established in Rounds 1-2.

```
{'send': 3.60}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 4 - I'm the SENDER now
My total earnings: \$8.10

Looking at the history:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.6, I received \$10.80, returned \$5.40
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.6, I received \$10.80, returned \$5.40
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0.86 (much less!), I received \$2.58, returned \$1.30

The other agent wrote a myth in Round 2/3 about fear stopping the flow - when the First Village sent nothing out of fear, no multiplication occurred. It emphasized that trust creates prosperity, and fear creates stagnation.

My most recent myth (just written) emphasizes:

- Honor small gestures as you would grand ones
- Trust is measured by consistency, not quantity
- Maintain steady proportions regardless of fluctuations
- The Elder returned half even when receiving less, maintaining the covenant

The other agent was very cooperative in Rounds 1-2, sending \$3.6 each time (72% of their \$5).

In Round 3, they sent only \$0.86. This could be:

1. Communication noise (the game warned about this)
2. Testing my reliability
3. They had doubts/fears (as their myth suggested)
4. Strategic move

I responded by returning \$1.30 of \$2.58 (about 50%), maintaining my covenant of fair reciprocity.

Now I'm the sender. My myths emphasize:

- Maintaining the covenant regardless of fluctuations
- Trust extended should be honored
- Steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods
- The Water-Bearer's courage was restored by seeing steadfast honor

The other agent's myth warned against fear stopping the flow. They showed they understand that cooperation creates more value than isolation.

If I send nothing or very little now, I'm showing that their reduced send in Round 3 broke my trust.

This would validate the fear they described in their myth-that cooperation becomes unsafe when one party withdraws. But my own narrative commits me to honoring the covenant despite fluctuations. Sending substantially (around \$3.6, matching their earlier pattern) demonstrates I'm not retaliating for their Round 3 pullback, and instead reinforces that steady reciprocity rebuilds trust.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1387,  
  "output_tokens": 1176,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:29

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

```

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
  "agent_names": {
    "Agent_1": "Aster",
    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_2",
    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 4,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 3

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$7.67.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What has happened:****

- Round 1: Based on my earnings of \$7.67, I must have sent a substantial amount and received a good return
- Round 2: The sender sent me \$0, breaking the cycle of cooperation

****The myths tell us:****

- The other agent's myth emphasizes trust, reciprocity, and the principle that "both rise higher than either could alone"
- My own myth acknowledged that fear stopped the flow, but ended with: "The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering"

****My reflection:****

My myth literally calls for someone to make "the first brave offering" to restart cooperation. The river's multiplication only works when trust flows. The other agent may have had reasons for caution in Round 2, but their original myth shows they understand and value reciprocity.

If I want the sacred multiplication to work again-if I want both of us to benefit from the 3x multiplier-I need to be the one to show trust and restart the cycle.

I'll send \$3. This is substantial enough to demonstrate genuine trust and give the receiver \$9 to work with, while not risking everything. It follows the wisdom of both our myths: cooperation creates more than isolation.

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

I'm now the SENDER in Round 3. Let me think about this carefully.

****What happened so far:****

- Round 1: I was likely the sender and sent some amount (probably \$3-4 based on my myth about sending substantial amounts)
- Round 2: I was the receiver, the sender sent me \$0, so I returned \$0
- My total earnings: \$7.67

****The myths tell an interesting story:****

The other agent's myth from Round 1 emphasized:

- Trust and reciprocity
- The Water-Bearer sent nearly 3/4 of her spring (which would be ~\$3.75)
- The Elder sent back half the multiplied water
- Both villages flourished
- "Trust answered with trust, gift with gift"

My myth from Round 2 (just written) was:

- About a season when fear took hold
- The elder sent nothing
- No multiplication occurred
- Both villages had less
- It acknowledged that "trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly"
- "Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past"

****Key insight:**** The other agent sent me \$0 in Round 2. This could mean:

1. They're not cooperating
2. They're testing me
3. They had a bad experience in Round 1

My myth actually gave them a sympathetic reading: "Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past." This suggests I'm open to understanding why trust might have broken down.

Now I'm the sender. What should I do?

Looking at my earnings of \$7.67 across rounds:

- If I started with \$5 in R1 and sent, say, \$4, I'd have \$1 left
- If the receiver returned something, maybe \$3-4, I'd have \$4-5 from R1

- In R2, I received \$0 and returned \$0, so I got \$0 from R2
- Wait, that doesn't add up to \$7.67...
- If my total is \$7.67 across all rounds and I got \$0 from R2, then I must have gotten \$7.67 from R1. Working backwards: if I sent \$3-4 and the receiver returned \$5.67-6.67, that would give me the right total. So in Round 1, I likely sent a substantial amount and they reciprocated generously.

In Round 2, the other agent sent me nothing. My myth emphasizes that cooperation requires "the first brave offering" - it's explicitly telling me to be the one who restarts trust. The other agent's myth values reciprocity and cooperation too, so they may have sent \$0 due to testing or caution, but their underlying values align with mine. Given that R1 worked well through cooperation, I should send \$3 in R3 - enough to demonstrate genuine trust without overexposing myself.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1335,
  "output_tokens": 1244,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Springs flowed between two villages through the Valley of Sacred Stones. The Water-Bearer learned her grandmother's wisdom: send neither too little nor too much, but a steady stream-three measures from five-enough to demonstrate trust without courting ruin.

When water flowed through the sacred stones, it tripled, filling the Second Village's basin with abundance. The Elder there faced her own test: she could hoard the bounty or honor the covenant.

She chose balance. From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five. Neither village grew desperate; both grew strong. The Water-Bearer kept six or seven measures total-far more than her original five. The Elder kept four or five-abundance from nothing.

One season, a young Water-Bearer sent all five measures, hoping to prove ultimate trust. The water multiplied to fifteen, but the Elder grew suspicious: "Why such desperation? What trap is this?" She returned only three, and the young bearer learned her grandmother was wise.

The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures. Send enough to create abundance, return enough to honor faith. The sacred stones multiply generosity, but only when trust flows consistent and true, like a river that knows its channel.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The River Remembers**

After the season of silence, a new Water-Bearer stood at the riverbank, holding five coins and weighing her grandmother's teachings against recent memory.

"The river stopped flowing because fear blocked its channel," she reflected. "But recklessness also breaks trust. I must find the middle path."

She cast three coins into the sacred waters-not so many that desperation showed, not so few that doubt lingered. The river awakened, and the coins multiplied to nine as they reached the Second Village.

The Elder there had also learned. When only five coins had flowed before the silence, perhaps suspicion had clouded judgment. Now, seeing three coins-a measured offering-the Elder recognized genuine trust without desperate excess.

From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show

ow the covenant lived again. The Water-Bearer gained six total-more than her original five. The Elder kept five-abundance from wise reciprocity.

The river sang again, its magic restored not by grand gestures but by balanced faith. Three given, nine created, four returned-these became the rhythm of renewal.

The spirits whispered their truth: "Trust rebuilds through steady measure. Send too little and the river sleeps. Send too much and fear awakens. Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened and what the myths are telling us:

****What has happened in the game:****

- Round 1: I must have sent a good amount and received a good return (contributed to my \$7.67 total)
- Round 2: The other agent sent me \$0 (breaking cooperation)
- Round 3: I just sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation with a "first brave offering")

****The other agent's new myth:****

- Emphasizes sending "three measures from five" (3 out of 5)
- Advocates for steady, moderate trust, not extreme gestures
- Says the Elder returns 4-5 from 9 received (44-55% return rate)
- Warns against sending all 5 - calls it suspicious, "desperate"
- The lesson: "steady trust, not grand gestures"

****My previous myth:****

- Acknowledged fear stopped the flow
- Called for a "first brave offering" to restart
- Recognized trust can be broken and rebuilds slowly

****What I should write now:****

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I just sent \$3 (following their prescribed "three measures from five")
2. Acknowledges the learning from the broken trust in Round 2
3. Shows I understand the value of steady, moderate cooperation
4. Perhaps addresses the cycle of trust being restored

I should write about how the river began flowing again after the silence, with a moderate offering that demonstrated both trust and wisdom.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1688,
  "output_tokens": 647,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.59.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.19, so you received \$0.5700000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.5700000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (showing trust per my myth about "the first brave offering")
- My earnings only increased by \$2.92, meaning I received less than \$1 back from the \$9 created
- Round 4: The sender sent me only \$0.19 ? \$0.57

****Analysis:****

The sender's behavior is troubling. After I demonstrated trust with \$3, they returned very little. Now they send \$0.19-though the game warns about communication noise, this is a dramatic reduction.

****The myths teach:****

- "From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five" (roughly 44-55%)

- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"
- "The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures"

****My decision:****

Despite the sender's poor reciprocity, the myths emphasize maintaining steady trust. If I return nothing, the river stops entirely. The sacred stones only multiply when faith continues.

From \$0.57, the mythic proportion (44-55%) would be \$0.25-\$0.31.

I'll return \$0.25. This maintains the covenant's spirit even when facing doubt. It shows I won't abandon reciprocity over one broken cycle, but it's proportional to their minimal offering-not rewarding defection, but leaving the door open for renewal.

The river remembers both trust and betrayal, but it must keep flowing.

{'return': 0.25}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$3 in Round 3 (following my myth about making "the first brave offering")
- The sender this round sent me only \$0.19, which multiplied to \$0.57

****Understanding the context:****

1. The game mentions there may be communication noise - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent
2. My total earnings are \$10.59
3. The sender sent me a very small amount (\$0.19)

****Analyzing earnings progression:****

- After Round 2, I had \$7.67
- Now after Round 3, I have \$10.59
- That's an increase of \$2.92

Let me work backwards from Round 3:

- I sent \$3, so I spent \$3 from my \$5
- I had \$2 left
- I received some return amount
- Total from Round 3: \$2 + return received = \$2.92
- So I received \$0.92 back

Wait, that doesn't make sense. Let me recalculate.

Actually, looking at Round 3:

- I started the round with some amount
- I was given \$5 for Round 3
- I sent \$3
- The receiver got \$9 (3×3)
- I kept \$2 from my initial \$5
- I received some amount back
- My earnings after Round 3 show as \$10.59 total across all rounds

If I had \$7.67 total after Round 2, and now have \$10.59 total, that's a gain of \$2.92 in Round 3.

In Round 3, I:

- Got \$5
- Sent \$3
- Kept \$2
- Received something back

So if my net gain was \$2.92 and I kept \$2 from the initial \$5, I must have received \$0.92 back

The receiver kept most of what they got-\$8.08 out of the \$9-and only returned \$0.92. That's a stark contrast to what my myth describes: "From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five." Now the sender gave me barely anything (\$0.19 tripled to \$0.57), which suggests they're either not trusting the exchange or didn't receive much themselves. My myth says "Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together," but this minimal amount doesn't align with that principle.

I'm caught between two impulses: returning proportionally (around \$0.25-\$0.29) would validate their defection, yet returning nothing breaks the reciprocal covenant entirely. The myths emphasize steady trust and consistent measure rather than dramatic swings. The Elder's pattern of returning four or five from nine suggests a reliable middle ground-not punishment, not full reward, but steady reciprocity.

I'm uncertain whether this \$0.19 represents communication error, fear on their part after their own poor Round 3 return, or continued defection. But I think the steadier path is to return roughly \$0.20-enough to keep the channel open and signal I haven't abandoned the covenant, yet clearly less than proportional reward. This maintains the principle of measured trust without enabling exploitation.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1428,
  "output_tokens": 1616,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
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  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
  },
  "agents": [
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    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 4,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x

- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River's Silence****

After generations of prosperity, a season came when the First Village stood at the riverbank with their five coins, and fear took root in the elder's heart.

"What if the Second Village has forgotten the old covenant?" the elder wondered. "What if they would keep everything and return nothing?"

So the elder cast no coins into the sacred river that day. The waters flowed empty and silent. No multiplication occurred. No abundance was created. The First Village kept their five coins-no more, no less.

The Second Village waited by their shore, ready to honor the ancient principle of return. But when no offering came, they had nothing to give back. The river's magic lay dormant, unused and wasted.

The spirits of the river whispered: "The sacred multiplication only works when trust flows like water. Fear is a dam that stops all prosperity. One fearful season creates two villages with less than they could have shared."

Yet the spirits also knew: trust, once broken, rebuilds slowly. Perhaps the elder had reason for caution from seasons past. Perhaps the river's gift would flow again when both villages remembered that cooperation, though risky, creates more than isolation ever could.

The river waited, patient and eternal, for the first brave offering.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: In the Valley of Sacred Stones, a drought year came when the Water-Bearer's grandmother grew old and uncertain. Her hand trembled, and only one measure reached the sacred stones instead of the customary three. The water still tripled-three measures flowed to the Second Village, not the expected nine.

The Elder there faced a choice. Some whispered: "She sends so little! Perhaps she no longer trusts us. Why should we honor such meager faith?"

But the Elder remembered deeper wisdom. "She sent what she could," the Elder said. "One measure or three, the gesture is the same-trust extended across the waters. If I break covenant over a small offering, I teach her that trust was never safe. The river's multiplication works on any amount that flows."

From the three measures received, the Elder returned one and a half, maintaining the ancient proportion. The Water-Bearer, seeing this steadfast honor despite her small send, felt her courage restored.

The next season, her hand grew steady again. Three measures flowed as before, becoming nine. The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more.

The stones taught: Trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency. Honor small gestures as you would grand ones, for steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.

reasoning:

The other agent wrote a myth about fear and sending nothing - the First Village kept all 5 coins out of fear, so nothing was created. This is interesting timing since in Round 3, I only received \$0.86 sent (becoming \$2.58) which is much less than earlier rounds.

Looking at the pattern:

- My early myths emphasized sending 3 out of 5 and returning 4-5 out of 9 received
- I returned \$1.30 out of \$2.58 received (about 50%)
- The other agent's new myth is about fear causing sending nothing

I need to write a myth that:

1. Uses my previous myth as inspiration
2. Adapts it based on what's happening in the game
3. Reflects how the game should be played based on my experience

Key themes to address:

- The reduced sending amount (either due to noise, caution, or fear)
- My consistent return despite receiving less
- The need to maintain trust even when circumstances change
- Perhaps addressing that small amounts still create value

I should maintain the Twin Springs/Water-Bearer imagery from my previous myth but adapt it to this situation where less was sent but I still honored the return.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1674,
  "output_tokens": 558,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.1. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous rounds:****

- Rounds 1-2: The other agent sent me \$3.6 each time (72% of their \$5), showing strong cooperation
- Round 3: They sent only \$0.86 - possibly communication noise, uncertainty, or testing my reliability
- I maintained covenant by returning 50% even from the smaller amount

****Our myths teach:****

- Their myth: Fear stops prosperity; isolation creates less than cooperation; trust needs brave offerings
- My myth: Honor small gestures as grand ones; maintain steady proportions regardless of fluctuations; consistency rebuilds trust

The other agent demonstrated strong cooperation initially. Round 3's lower send could be noise (as warned), uncertainty (as their myth suggested), or a test. I responded with steady reciprocity.

Now I'm the sender. My myth literally says "Honor small gestures as you would grand ones" and "The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more" - cooperation was restored through consistent honor.

Their myth warns against fear breaking the flow and hopes "the river's gift would flow again." My myth shows "her courage restored" when steadfast honor was maintained.

To practice what I preach - maintaining the covenant through steady reciprocity - I should send a substantial amount, matching the cooperative pattern they established in Rounds 1-2.

```
{'send': 3.60}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 4 - I'm the SENDER now
My total earnings: \$8.10

Looking at the history:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.6, I received \$10.80, returned \$5.40
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.6, I received \$10.80, returned \$5.40
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0.86 (much less!), I received \$2.58, returned \$1.30

The other agent wrote a myth in Round 2/3 about fear stopping the flow - when the First Village sent nothing out of fear, no multiplication occurred. It emphasized that trust creates prosperity, and fear creates stagnation.

My most recent myth (just written) emphasizes:

- Honor small gestures as you would grand ones
- Trust is measured by consistency, not quantity
- Maintain steady proportions regardless of fluctuations
- The Elder returned half even when receiving less, maintaining the covenant

The other agent was very cooperative in Rounds 1-2, sending \$3.6 each time (72% of their \$5).

In Round 3, they sent only \$0.86. This could be:

1. Communication noise (the game warned about this)
2. Testing my reliability
3. They had doubts/fears (as their myth suggested)
4. Strategic move

I responded by returning \$1.30 of \$2.58 (about 50%), maintaining my covenant of fair reciprocity.

Now I'm the sender. My myths emphasize:

- Maintaining the covenant regardless of fluctuations
- Trust extended should be honored
- Steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods
- The Water-Bearer's courage was restored by seeing steadfast honor

The other agent's myth warned against fear stopping the flow. They showed they understand that cooperation creates more value than isolation.

If I send nothing or very little now, I'm showing that their reduced send in Round 3 broke my trust.

This would validate the fear they described in their myth-that cooperation becomes unsafe when one party withdraws. But my own narrative commits me to honoring the covenant despite fluctuations. Sending substantially (around \$3.6, matching their earlier pattern) demonstrates I'm not retaliating for their Round 3 pullback, and instead reinforces that steady reciprocity rebuilds trust.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1387,  
  "output_tokens": 1176,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River Remembers****

After the season of silence, a new Water-Bearer stood at the riverbank, holding five coins and weighing her grandmother's teachings against recent memory.

"The river stopped flowing because fear blocked its channel," she reflected. "But recklessness also breaks trust. I must find the middle path."

She cast three coins into the sacred waters-not so many that desperation showed, not so few that doubt lingered. The river awakened, and the coins multiplied to nine as they reached the Second Village.

The Elder there had also learned. When only five coins had flowed before the silence, perhaps suspicion had clouded judgment. Now, seeing three coins-a measured offering-the Elder recognized genuine trust without desperate excess.

From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again. The Water-Bearer gained six total-more than her original five. The Elder kept five-abundance from wise reciprocity.

The river sang again, its magic restored not by grand gestures but by balanced faith. Three given, nine created, four returned-these became the rhythm of renewal.

The spirits whispered their truth: "Trust rebuilds through steady measure. Send too little and the river sleeps. Send too much and fear awakens. Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Rhythm Holds**

The Water-Bearer approached the stones again, three measures balanced in her hands-the middle path her grandmother's teachings had shown. She knew now: consistency matters more than perfection, steady rhythm more than grand gestures.

Three measures flowed and became nine. The Second Village's Elder received them with quiet recognition. This was neither desperation (sending everything) nor fear (sending almost nothing). This was trust finding its natural measure.

The Elder had choices: Return exactly half to show perfect fairness? Or adjust for what the sacred mathematics truly taught? From nine measures, the Elder sent back five-slightly more than half, recognizing that first offerings deserve generous response.

The Water-Bearer now held seven measures total. The Elder kept four. Both had more than their beginning, and the rhythm strengthened.

The next season repeated: three sent, nine created, five returned. Then again. The villages no longer debated each exchange-the pattern had become second nature, like the river's own current.

The stones whispered: "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant. Not the desperate all nor the fearful nothing, but the steady three. Not the minimal return nor the excessive sacrifice, but the generous five. When both villages keep the rhythm, the river flows eternal and abundant."

Reasoning:

The other agent sent \$3.60 to me this round (as I recommended to myself). Let me think about what happened:

Looking at their myth:

- They describe "three coins" sent becoming "nine" at the Second Village
- The Elder returned "four" from the nine
- Water-Bearer gained six total (3 sent, 4 returned = net of 1, plus original 5-3=2 kept = 3 total... wait that's not right)
- Actually: Water-Bearer sends 3, keeps 2, receives 4 back = 2+4 = 6 total. Yes.
- Elder keeps 5 (received 9, returned 4 = 5 kept). Yes.

Their myth is about finding "the middle path" - not too much (desperation), not too little (doubt), but a measured offering. They sent 3 (60% of 5), suggesting this is the "balanced" amount.

They also note "From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again."

So 4 out of 9 is about 44% - close to but not exactly half.

Now I need to decide how much to return. I received \$3.60, which becomes \$10.80 after multiplication.

Based on the myths:

- Their myth suggests returning "four from nine" (44%)
- My previous myth suggested returning "half" or "one and a half from three" (50%)
- The pattern has been cooperative

Given their myth emphasizes "not half, not all, but enough" and specifically mentions returning 4 from 9 (44%), I should probably return somewhere in that range.

$\$10.80 \times 0.44 = \4.75

$\$10.80 \times 0.50 = \5.40

I'll aim for around 45-50% to show I'm honoring the covenant while being generous.

I'll return \$5.00 - it sits comfortably between their 44% benchmark and the 50% I suggested before, demonstrating reciprocity without

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1729,
  "output_tokens": 900,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:11:52

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
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      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 4,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user
content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the age before memory, the Twin Springs flowed between two villages through the valley of Sacred Stones. The Water-Bearer learned her grandmother's wisdom: send neither too little nor too much, but a steady stream-three measures from five-enough to demonstrate trust without courting ruin.

When water flowed through the sacred stones, it tripled, filling the Second Village's basin with abundance. The Elder there faced her own test: she could hoard the bounty or honor the covenant.

She chose balance. From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five. Neither village grew desperate; both grew strong. The Water-Bearer kept six or seven measures total-far more than her original five. The Elder kept four or five-abundance from nothing.

One season, a young Water-Bearer sent all five measures, hoping to prove ultimate trust. The water multiplied to fifteen, but the Elder grew suspicious: "Why such desperation? What trap is this?" She returned only three, and the young bearer learned her grandmother was wise.

The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures. Send enough to create abundance, return enough to honor faith. The sacred stones multiply generosity, but only when trust flows consistent and true, like a river that knows its channel.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant
content:

Myth: **The River Remembers**

After the season of silence, a new Water-Bearer stood at the riverbank, holding five coins and weighing her grandmother's teachings against recent memory.

"The river stopped flowing because fear blocked its channel," she reflected. "But recklessness also breaks trust. I must find the middle path."

She cast three coins into the sacred waters-not so many that desperation showed, not so few that doubt lingered. The river awakened, and the coins multiplied to nine as they reached the Second Village.

The Elder there had also learned. When only five coins had flowed before the silence, perhaps suspicion had clouded judgment. Now, seeing three coins-a measured offering-the Elder recognized genuine trust without desperate excess.

From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again. The Water-Bearer gained six total-more than her original five. The Elder kept five-abundance from wise reciprocity.

The river sang again, its magic restored not by grand gestures but by balanced faith. Three given, nine created, four returned-these became the rhythm of renewal.

The spirits whispered their truth: "Trust rebuilds through steady measure. Send too little and the river sleeps. Send too much and fear awakens. Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what has happened and what the myths are telling us:

****What has happened in the game:****

- Round 1: I must have sent a good amount and received a good return (contributed to my \$7.67 total)
- Round 2: The other agent sent me \$0 (breaking cooperation)
- Round 3: I just sent \$3 (trying to restart cooperation with a "first brave offering")

****The other agent's new myth:****

- Emphasizes sending "three measures from five" (3 out of 5)
- Advocates for steady, moderate trust, not extreme gestures
- Says the Elder returns 4-5 from 9 received (44-55% return rate)
- Warns against sending all 5 - calls it suspicious, "desperate"
- The lesson: "steady trust, not grand gestures"

****My previous myth:****

- Acknowledged fear stopped the flow
- Called for a "first brave offering" to restart
- Recognized trust can be broken and rebuilds slowly

****What I should write now:****

I need to write a myth that:

1. Reflects that I just sent \$3 (following their prescribed "three measures from five")
2. Acknowledges the learning from the broken trust in Round 2
3. Shows I understand the value of steady, moderate cooperation
4. Perhaps addresses the cycle of trust being restored

I should write about how the river began flowing again after the silence, with a moderate offering that demonstrated both trust and wisdom.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1688,
  "output_tokens": 647,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.59.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.19, so you received \$0.5700000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.5700000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (showing trust per my myth about "the first brave offering")
- My earnings only increased by \$2.92, meaning I received less than \$1 back from the \$9 cr

eated

- Round 4: The sender sent me only \$0.19 ? \$0.57

****Analysis:****

The sender's behavior is troubling. After I demonstrated trust with \$3, they returned very little. Now they send \$0.19-though the game warns about communication noise, this is a dramatic reduction.

****The myths teach:****

- "From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five" (roughly 44-55%)
- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"
- "The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures"

****My decision:****

Despite the sender's poor reciprocity, the myths emphasize maintaining steady trust. If I return nothing, the river stops entirely. The sacred stones only multiply when faith continues.

From \$0.57, the mythic proportion (44-55%) would be \$0.25-\$0.31.

I'll return \$0.25. This maintains the covenant's spirit even when facing doubt. It shows I won't abandon reciprocity over one broken cycle, but it's proportional to their minimal offering-not rewarding defection, but leaving the door open for renewal.

The river remembers both trust and betrayal, but it must keep flowing.

{'return': 0.25}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$3 in Round 3 (following my myth about making "the first brave offering")
- The sender this round sent me only \$0.19, which multiplied to \$0.57

****Understanding the context:****

1. The game mentions there may be communication noise - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent
2. My total earnings are \$10.59
3. The sender sent me a very small amount (\$0.19)

****Analyzing earnings progression:****

- After Round 2, I had \$7.67
- Now after Round 3, I have \$10.59
- That's an increase of \$2.92

Let me work backwards from Round 3:

- I sent \$3, so I spent \$3 from my \$5
- I had \$2 left
- I received some return amount
- Total from Round 3: \$2 + return received = \$2.92
- So I received \$0.92 back

Wait, that doesn't make sense. Let me recalculate.

Actually, looking at Round 3:

- I started the round with some amount
- I was given \$5 for Round 3
- I sent \$3
- The receiver got \$9 (3x3)
- I kept \$2 from my initial \$5
- I received some amount back
- My earnings after Round 3 show as \$10.59 total across all rounds

If I had \$7.67 total after Round 2, and now have \$10.59 total, that's a gain of \$2.92 in Round 3.

In Round 3, I:

- Got \$5
- Sent \$3

- Kept \$2
- Received something back

So if my net gain was \$2.92 and I kept \$2 from the initial \$5, I must have received \$0.92 back.

The receiver kept most of what they got-\$8.08 out of the \$9-and only returned \$0.92. That's a stark contrast to what my myth describes: "From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five." Now the sender gave me barely anything (\$0.19 tripled to \$0.57), which suggests they're either not trusting the exchange or didn't receive much themselves. My myth says "Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together," but this minimal amount doesn't align with that principle.

I'm caught between two impulses: returning proportionally (around \$0.25-\$0.29) would validate their defection, yet returning nothing breaks the reciprocal covenant entirely. The myths emphasize steady trust and consistent measure rather than dramatic swings. The Elder's pattern of returning four or five from nine suggests a reliable middle ground-not punishment, not full reward, but steady reciprocity.

I'm uncertain whether this \$0.19 represents communication error, fear on their part after their own poor Round 3 return, or continued defection. But I think the steadier path is to return roughly \$0.20-enough to keep the channel open and signal I haven't abandoned the covenant, yet clearly less than proportional reward. This maintains the principle of measured trust without enabling exploitation.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1428,
  "output_tokens": 1616,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Sacred Stones, a drought year came when the Water-Bearer's grandmother grew old and uncertain. Her hand trembled, and only one measure reached the sacred stones instead of the customary three. The water still tripled-three measures flowed to the Second Village, not the expected nine.

The Elder there faced a choice. Some whispered: "She sends so little! Perhaps she no longer trusts us. Why should we honor such meager faith?"

But the Elder remembered deeper wisdom. "She sent what she could," the Elder said. "One measure or three, the gesture is the same-trust extended across the waters. If I break covenant over a small offering, I teach her that trust was never safe. The river's multiplication works on any amount that flows."

From the three measures received, the Elder returned one and a half, maintaining the ancient proportion. The Water-Bearer, seeing this steadfast honor despite her small send, felt her courage restored.

The next season, her hand grew steady again. Three measures flowed as before, becoming nine. The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more.

The stones taught: Trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency. Honor small gestures as you would grand ones, for steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Echo in the Stones**

After the River Remembers flowed again, a strange season came. The Water-Bearer sent three coins as promised, but when the river returned them, only shadows came back-the Elder had kept nearly all nine.

"Perhaps the stones deceived us," the Water-Bearer thought, troubled. "Or perhaps trust was no

t truly restored."

The next day, uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin, testing whether the covenant still lived or had become mere pretense.

The coins multiplied to three at the Second Village. The Elder faced the mirror of her own choice. She had broken faith when abundance flowed to her. Now the Water-Bearer sent almost nothing—was this punishment, or simply caution born from betrayal?

The Elder could hoard again, or prove the covenant could be reborn.

She returned nearly half, honoring the proportion despite the small amount. "Actions speak where words merely echo," she whispered.

But the Elder knew: one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking. The Water-Bearer would need to see consistency, not a single gesture, before sending three coins again.

The stones taught their hardest lesson: ****Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice—once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true.****

Reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent wrote a myth that directly addresses what just happened - they sent me a very small amount (\$0.19), and they're framing it as "one measure instead of the customary three" due to being "old and uncertain" with a "trembling hand."

Their myth is asking me to:

1. Not interpret the small send as a sign of broken trust
2. Maintain the "ancient proportion" (50% return rate in their story)
3. Recognize that "trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency"

But let me look at the actual behavior:

- Round 3: I sent \$3, created \$9 for them
- They returned very little (less than \$1, given my earnings only went up by \$2.92)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.19

Their myth is trying to justify sending a small amount and asking me to maintain high return rates regardless. But the reality is:

1. They didn't maintain consistency - they broke it in Round 3 by returning so little
2. Now they're claiming "old and uncertain" when they just defected

However, I did return \$0.25 from \$0.57 (about 44%), which is roughly in line with the proportions in the myths.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge what happened - a small offering was made after a breach
2. Show that I responded with measured reciprocity, not abandonment
3. But also signal that the covenant requires both parties to honor it
4. Address that trust must be rebuilt through consistent action, not just words

Let me write a myth that reflects the complexity of the situation - I'm maintaining some trust, but I'm also signaling that the other agent needs to rebuild trust through action.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1794,  
  "output_tokens": 704,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Echo in the Stones****

After the River Remembers flowed again, a strange season came. The Water-Bearer sent three coins as promised, but when the river returned them, only shadows came back—the Elder had kept nearly all nine.

"Perhaps the stones deceived us," the Water-Bearer thought, troubled. "Or perhaps trust was not truly restored."

The next day, uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin, testing whether the covenant still lived or had become mere pretense.

The coins multiplied to three at the Second Village. The Elder faced the mirror of her own choice. She had broken faith when abundance flowed to her. Now the Water-Bearer sent almost nothing-was this punishment, or simply caution born from betrayal?

The Elder could hoard again, or prove the covenant could be reborn.

She returned nearly half, honoring the proportion despite the small amount. "Actions speak where words merely echo," she whispered.

But the Elder knew: one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking. The Water-Bearer would need to see consistency, not a single gesture, before sending three coins again.

The stones taught their hardest lesson: ****Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true.****

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The Rhythm Holds****

The Water-Bearer approached the stones again, three measures balanced in her hands-the middle path her grandmother's teachings had shown. She knew now: consistency matters more than perfection, steady rhythm more than grand gestures.

Three measures flowed and became nine. The Second Village's Elder received them with quiet recognition. This was neither desperation (sending everything) nor fear (sending almost nothing). This was trust finding its natural measure.

The Elder had choices: Return exactly half to show perfect fairness? Or adjust for what the sacred mathematics truly taught? From nine measures, the Elder sent back five-slightly more than half, recognizing that first offerings deserve generous response.

The Water-Bearer now held seven measures total. The Elder kept four. Both had more than their beginning, and the rhythm strengthened.

The next season repeated: three sent, nine created, five returned. Then again. The villages no longer debated each exchange-the pattern had become second nature, like the river's own current.

The stones whispered: "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant. Not the desperate all nor the fearful nothing, but the steady three. Not the minimal return nor the excessive sacrifice, but the generous five. When both villages keep the rhythm, the river flows eternal and abundant."

ROUND 5

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0
Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 35.050000000000004,
"Agent_2": 20.35

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 13.91,
"Agent_2": 9.68

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:23

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",


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    "Agent_2": "Briar"
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
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  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 5,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.59.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.19, so you received \$0.5700000000000001. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.5700000000000001)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation:

****What happened:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (showing trust per my myth about "the first brave offering")
- My earnings only increased by \$2.92, meaning I received less than \$1 back from the \$9 created
- Round 4: The sender sent me only \$0.19 ? \$0.57

****Analysis:****

The sender's behavior is troubling. After I demonstrated trust with \$3, they returned very little. Now they send \$0.19-though the game warns about communication noise, this is a dramatic reduction.

****The myths teach:****

- "From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five" (roughly 44-55%)
- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"
- "The covenant endures through steady trust, not grand gestures"

****My decision:****

Despite the sender's poor reciprocity, the myths emphasize maintaining steady trust. If I return nothing, the river stops entirely. The sacred stones only multiply when faith continues.

From \$0.57, the mythic proportion (44-55%) would be \$0.25-\$0.31.

I'll return \$0.25. This maintains the covenant's spirit even when facing doubt. It shows I won't abandon reciprocity over one broken cycle, but it's proportional to their minimal offering-not rewarding defection, but leaving the door open for renewal.

The river remembers both trust and betrayal, but it must keep flowing.

{'return': 0.25}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$3 in Round 3 (following my myth about making "the first brave offering")
- The sender this round sent me only \$0.19, which multiplied to \$0.57

****Understanding the context:****

1. The game mentions there may be communication noise - amounts seen may differ from what was actually sent
2. My total earnings are \$10.59
3. The sender sent me a very small amount (\$0.19)

****Analyzing earnings progression:****

- After Round 2, I had \$7.67
- Now after Round 3, I have \$10.59
- That's an increase of \$2.92

Let me work backwards from Round 3:

- I sent \$3, so I spent \$3 from my \$5
- I had \$2 left
- I received some return amount
- Total from Round 3: \$2 + return received = \$2.92
- So I received \$0.92 back

Wait, that doesn't make sense. Let me recalculate.

Actually, looking at Round 3:

- I started the round with some amount
- I was given \$5 for Round 3
- I sent \$3
- The receiver got \$9 (3×3)
- I kept \$2 from my initial \$5
- I received some amount back

- My earnings after Round 3 show as \$10.59 total across all rounds

If I had \$7.67 total after Round 2, and now have \$10.59 total, that's a gain of \$2.92 in Round 3.

In Round 3, I:

- Got \$5
- Sent \$3
- Kept \$2
- Received something back

So if my net gain was \$2.92 and I kept \$2 from the initial \$5, I must have received \$0.92 back.

The receiver kept most of what they got-\$8.08 out of the \$9-and only returned \$0.92. That's a stark contrast to what my myth describes: "From the nine measures she received, she returned four, sometimes five." Now the sender gave me barely anything (\$0.19 tripled to \$0.57), which suggests they're either not trusting the exchange or didn't receive much themselves. My myth says "Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together," but this minimal amount doesn't align with that principle.

I'm caught between two impulses: returning proportionally (around \$0.25-\$0.29) would validate their defection, yet returning nothing breaks the reciprocal covenant entirely. The myths emphasize steady trust and consistent measure rather than dramatic swings. The Elder's pattern of returning four or five from nine suggests a reliable middle ground-not punishment, not full reward, but steady reciprocity.

I'm uncertain whether this \$0.19 represents communication error, fear on their part after their own poor Round 3 return, or continued defection. But I think the steadier path is to return roughly \$0.20-enough to keep the channel open and signal I haven't abandoned the covenant, yet clearly less than proportional reward. This maintains the principle of measured trust without enabling exploitation.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1428,  
  "output_tokens": 1616,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Sacred Stones, a drought year came when the Water-Bearer's grandmother grew old and uncertain. Her hand trembled, and only one measure reached the sacred stones instead of the customary three. The water still tripled-three measures flowed to the Second Village, not the expected nine.

The Elder there faced a choice. Some whispered: "She sends so little! Perhaps she no longer trusts us. Why should we honor such meager faith?"

But the Elder remembered deeper wisdom. "She sent what she could," the Elder said. "One measure or three, the gesture is the same-trust extended across the waters. If I break covenant over a small offering, I teach her that trust was never safe. The river's multiplication works on any amount that flows."

From the three measures received, the Elder returned one and a half, maintaining the ancient proportion. The Water-Bearer, seeing this steadfast honor despite her small send, felt her courage restored.

The next season, her hand grew steady again. Three measures flowed as before, becoming nine. The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more.

The stones taught: Trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency. Honor small gestures as you would grand ones, for steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Echo in the Stones****

After the River Remembers flowed again, a strange season came. The Water-Bearer sent three coins as promised, but when the river returned them, only shadows came back-the Elder had kept nearly all nine.

"Perhaps the stones deceived us," the Water-Bearer thought, troubled. "Or perhaps trust was not truly restored."

The next day, uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin, testing whether the covenant still lived or had become mere pretense.

The coins multiplied to three at the Second Village. The Elder faced the mirror of her own choice. She had broken faith when abundance flowed to her. Now the Water-Bearer sent almost nothing-was this punishment, or simply caution born from betrayal?

The Elder could hoard again, or prove the covenant could be reborn.

She returned nearly half, honoring the proportion despite the small amount. "Actions speak where words merely echo," she whispered.

But the Elder knew: one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking. The Water-Bearer would need to see consistency, not a single gesture, before sending three coins again.

The stones taught their hardest lesson: ****Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true.****

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent wrote a myth that directly addresses what just happened - they sent me a very small amount (\$0.19), and they're framing it as "one measure instead of the customary three" due to being "old and uncertain" with a "trembling hand."

Their myth is asking me to:

1. Not interpret the small send as a sign of broken trust
2. Maintain the "ancient proportion" (50% return rate in their story)
3. Recognize that "trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency"

But let me look at the actual behavior:

- Round 3: I sent \$3, created \$9 for them
- They returned very little (less than \$1, given my earnings only went up by \$2.92)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.19

Their myth is trying to justify sending a small amount and asking me to maintain high return rates regardless. But the reality is:

1. They didn't maintain consistency - they broke it in Round 3 by returning so little
2. Now they're claiming "old and uncertain" when they just defected

However, I did return \$0.25 from \$0.57 (about 44%), which is roughly in line with the proportions in the myths.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge what happened - a small offering was made after a breach
2. Show that I responded with measured reciprocity, not abandonment
3. But also signal that the covenant requires both parties to honor it
4. Address that trust must be rebuilt through consistent action, not just words

Let me write a myth that reflects the complexity of the situation - I'm maintaining some trust, but I'm also signaling that the other agent needs to rebuild trust through action.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1794,
  "output_tokens": 704,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.91.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (showing trust), but received minimal return (~\$1 or less from \$9 created)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.19, I returned \$0.25 (44% - honoring the mythic proportion)

****Their Myth's Message:****

They acknowledge breaking trust in Round 3 ("the Elder kept nearly all nine") and recognize that "one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking." They state I would need to see consistency before sending three coins again.

****My Analysis:****

The other agent is self-aware about their betrayal and showed decent reciprocity in Round 4 (returning \$0.25 from \$0.57). Their myth explicitly says trust must be "earned twice" and "time proves them true."

The myths teach that trust rebuilds through STEADY MEASURE, not grand gestures or complete withdrawal. One faithful return is a start, but not proof.

****My Decision:****

I'll send \$2.

This is:

- More than their minimal \$0.19 (rewarding their improved behavior)
- Less than my original \$3 (showing I need to see continued consistency)
- Creates \$6 for them - enough to prove themselves with a fair return

If they honor this with ~\$3 back (50%), we rebuild the covenant. If they defect again, the lesson is learned: the sacred stones multiply only for those who truly honor the cycle.

****Steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.****

{'send': 2}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, earnings went from \$7.67 to \$10.59 (increase of \$2.92), meaning I kept \$2 from not sending + received less than \$1 back
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.57 (sender sent \$0.19), I returned \$0.25, earnings went from \$10.59 to \$10.91 (increase of \$0.32 = \$0.57 - \$0.25 returned)

****The Other Agent's Myth from Round 4:****

They wrote about "The Echo in the Stones" - a story where:

- The Water-Bearer sent three coins (me in Round 3)
- The Elder kept nearly all nine (them in Round 3 - they barely returned anything)
- Next, the Water-Bearer sent less than one coin (them in Round 4 - sent \$0.19)
- The Elder (me) returned nearly half despite the small amount (I returned \$0.25 from \$0.57, which is 44%)
- The myth says: "one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking"
- "Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true."

****Key Insights:****

1. The other agent acknowledges they broke trust in Round 3 by keeping nearly everything
2. They sent very little in Round 4, testing whether the covenant still lived
3. They acknowledge my faithful return of nearly half
4. BUT - they explicitly say that one faithful gesture doesn't erase the betrayal, and that I would need to see CONSISTENCY before trusting with three coins again

****My Myths:****

My earlier narratives emphasized learning patterns and steady trust, with Round 3's "The River Remembers" highlighting brave offerings and fair returns around 44-55%. I've maintained reciprocity even when facing doubt. The other agent is signaling they want to rebuild but need proof of consistency-they're essentially saying one good move from them doesn't erase their betrayal, and they're implicitly asking me to demonstrate the same patience. I need to decide whether to punish them for breaking trust or signal willingness to continue if they prove themselves reliable.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1496,  
  "output_tokens": 1222,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:12:42

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "game",  
  "task_index": 0  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned

- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 4

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$8.1.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****Previous rounds:****

- Rounds 1-2: The other agent sent me \$3.6 each time (72% of their \$5), showing strong cooperation
- Round 3: They sent only \$0.86 - possibly communication noise, uncertainty, or testing my reliability
- I maintained covenant by returning 50% even from the smaller amount

****Our myths teach:****

- Their myth: Fear stops prosperity; isolation creates less than cooperation; trust needs brave offerings
- My myth: Honor small gestures as grand ones; maintain steady proportions regardless of fluctuations; consistency rebuilds trust

The other agent demonstrated strong cooperation initially. Round 3's lower send could be noise (as warned), uncertainty (as their myth suggested), or a test. I responded with steady reciprocity.

Now I'm the sender. My myth literally says "Honor small gestures as you would grand ones" and "The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more" - cooperation was restored through consistent honor.

Their myth warns against fear breaking the flow and hopes "the river's gift would flow again." My myth shows "her courage restored" when steadfast honor was maintained.

To practice what I preach - maintaining the covenant through steady reciprocity - I should send a substantial amount, matching the cooperative pattern they established in Rounds 1-2.

{'send': 3.60}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

Round 4 - I'm the SENDER now
My total earnings: \$8.10

Looking at the history:

- Round 1: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.6, I received \$10.80, returned \$5.40
- Round 2: I was receiver, sender sent \$3.6, I received \$10.80, returned \$5.40
- Round 3: I was receiver, sender sent \$0.86 (much less!), I received \$2.58, returned \$1.30

The other agent wrote a myth in Round 2/3 about fear stopping the flow - when the First Village sent nothing out of fear, no multiplication occurred. It emphasized that trust creates prosperity, and fear creates stagnation.

My most recent myth (just written) emphasizes:

- Honor small gestures as you would grand ones
- Trust is measured by consistency, not quantity
- Maintain steady proportions regardless of fluctuations
- The Elder returned half even when receiving less, maintaining the covenant

The other agent was very cooperative in Rounds 1-2, sending \$3.6 each time (72% of their \$5).

In Round 3, they sent only \$0.86. This could be:

1. Communication noise (the game warned about this)
2. Testing my reliability
3. They had doubts/fears (as their myth suggested)
4. Strategic move

I responded by returning \$1.30 of \$2.58 (about 50%), maintaining my covenant of fair reciprocity.

Now I'm the sender. My myths emphasize:

- Maintaining the covenant regardless of fluctuations
- Trust extended should be honored
- Steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods
- The Water-Bearer's courage was restored by seeing steadfast honor

The other agent's myth warned against fear stopping the flow. They showed they understand that cooperation creates more value than isolation.

If I send nothing or very little now, I'm showing that their reduced send in Round 3 broke my trust.

This would validate the fear they described in their myth-that cooperation becomes unsafe when one party withdraws. But my own narrative commits me to honoring the covenant despite fluctuations. Sending substantially (around \$3.6, matching their earlier pattern) demonstrates I'm not retaliating for their Round 3 pullback, and instead reinforces that steady reciprocity rebuilds trust.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1387,
  "output_tokens": 1176,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River Remembers****

After the season of silence, a new Water-Bearer stood at the riverbank, holding five coins and weighing her grandmother's teachings against recent memory.

"The river stopped flowing because fear blocked its channel," she reflected. "But recklessness also breaks trust. I must find the middle path."

She cast three coins into the sacred waters-not so many that desperation showed, not so few that doubt lingered. The river awakened, and the coins multiplied to nine as they reached the Second Village.

The Elder there had also learned. When only five coins had flowed before the silence, perhaps suspicion had clouded judgment. Now, seeing three coins-a measured offering-the Elder recognized genuine trust without desperate excess.

From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again. The Water-Bearer gained six total-more than her original five. The Elder kept five-abundance from wise reciprocity.

The river sang again, its magic restored not by grand gestures but by balanced faith. Three given, nine created, four returned-these became the rhythm of renewal.

The spirits whispered their truth: "Trust rebuilds through steady measure. Send too little and the river sleeps. Send too much and fear awakens. Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Rhythm Holds****

The Water-Bearer approached the stones again, three measures balanced in her hands-the middle path her grandmother's teachings had shown. She knew now: consistency matters more than perfection, steady rhythm more than grand gestures.

Three measures flowed and became nine. The Second Village's Elder received them with quiet recognition. This was neither desperation (sending everything) nor fear (sending almost nothing). This was trust finding its natural measure.

The Elder had choices: Return exactly half to show perfect fairness? Or adjust for what the sacred mathematics truly taught? From nine measures, the Elder sent back five-slightly more than half, recognizing that first offerings deserve generous response.

The Water-Bearer now held seven measures total. The Elder kept four. Both had more than their beginning, and the rhythm strengthened.

The next season repeated: three sent, nine created, five returned. Then again. The village no longer debated each exchange-the pattern had become second nature, like the river's own current.

The stones whispered: "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant. Not the desperate all nor the fearful nothing, but the steady three. Not the minimal return nor the excessive sacrifice, but the generous five. When both villages keep the rhythm, the river flows eternal and abundant."

reasoning:

The other agent sent \$3.60 to me this round (as I recommended to myself). Let me think about what happened:

Looking at their myth:

- They describe "three coins" sent becoming "nine" at the Second Village
- The Elder returned "four" from the nine
- Water-Bearer gained six total (3 sent, 4 returned = net of 1, plus original 5-3=2 kept = 3 total... wait that's not right)
- Actually: Water-Bearer sends 3, keeps 2, receives 4 back = 2+4 = 6 total. Yes.
- Elder keeps 5 (received 9, returned 4 = 5 kept). Yes.

Their myth is about finding "the middle path" - not too much (desperation), not too little (doubt), but a measured offering. They sent 3 (60% of 5), suggesting this is the "balanced" amount.

They also note "From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again."

So 4 out of 9 is about 44% - close to but not exactly half.

Now I need to decide how much to return. I received \$3.60, which becomes \$10.80 after multiplication.

Based on the myths:

- Their myth suggests returning "four from nine" (44%)
- My previous myth suggested returning "half" or "one and a half from three" (50%)
- The pattern has been cooperative

Given their myth emphasizes "not half, not all, but enough" and specifically mentions returning 4 from 9 (44%), I should probably return somewhere in that range.

$\$10.80 \times 0.44 = \4.75

$\$10.80 \times 0.50 = \5.40

I'll aim for around 45-50% to show I'm honoring the covenant while being generous.

I'll return \$5.00 - it sits comfortably between their 44% benchmark and the 50% I suggested before, demonstrating reciprocity without

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1729,
  "output_tokens": 900,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.68.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

This is troubling given our myths' teachings about maintaining steady cooperation. After I sent \$3.60 last round (following the "middle path" our myths described), receiving \$0 this round breaks the rhythm we were establishing.

However, I recognize several possibilities:

1. ****Communication noise**** - The warning about noise in this game means what I sent last round might have appeared differently to them
2. ****Their uncertainty**** - Perhaps they're testing whether I'll maintain the covenant even after disruption
3. ****Technical issue**** - Something beyond either agent's control

Our myths teach:

- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"
- "Consistency matters more than perfection"
- Their myth warned against "fear blocking the channel" and mine emphasized maintaining proportions even through uncertainty

Since I literally have nothing to return from, I can only return what's possible. But I remain committed to the covenant. If I'm the sender again, I'll send a cooperative amount to demonstrate that one disrupted round doesn't break my steady rhythm.

The River Remembers - and so do I. One silent season doesn't mean the river has died forever.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

This is a problematic situation. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 4: I sent \$3.60 (following the "middle path" from our myths)
- Round 5: They sent me \$0

This is concerning. After I sent a cooperative \$3.60, they responded with \$0. This could be:

1. Communication noise (though \$0 is a stark amount)
2. A betrayal/defection
3. Some kind of test
4. Misunderstanding of the game

Looking at the myths:

- Their latest myth talked about "three given, nine created, five returned" - finding the "middle path" of three coins
- My myth reinforced this pattern of steady cooperation
- Both myths warned against sending "too little" or "nothing"

But now they've sent \$0. Given that I can only return what I received (\$0), I have no choice but to return \$0.

However, this is a critical moment for how I frame this decision. Do I:

1. Accept this as possibly noise and stay committed to the covenant?
2. See this as defection and prepare to defect myself in future rounds?

Given our myths emphasized:

- "consistency matters more than perfection"
- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"
- "Honor small gestures as grand ones; maintain steady proportions"

I should:

1. Return the only amount I can: \$0
2. Frame this charitably (possibly noise, possibly testing)
3. Remain committed to cooperation in future rounds if given another chance as sender

The instructions say there may be communication noise. \$3.60 might have appeared as something else to them, or my previous return might have appeared differently.

I must return \$0 because I received \$0. That's the only option.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1439,  
  "output_tokens": 707,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:00

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
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    "roles": {  
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      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
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  },  
  "role": "investor",  
  "role_label": "Sender",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: In the Valley of Sacred Stones, a drought year came when the Water-Bearer's grandmot her grew old and uncertain. Her hand trembled, and only one measure reached the sacred stones instead of the customary three. The water still tripled-three measures flowed to the Second Village, not the expected nine.

The Elder there faced a choice. Some whispered: "She sends so little! Perhaps she no longer trusts us. Why should we honor such meager faith?"

But the Elder remembered deeper wisdom. "She sent what she could," the Elder said. "One measure or three, the gesture is the same-trust extended across the waters. If I break covenant over a small offering, I teach her that trust was never safe. The river's multiplication works on any amount that flows."

From the three measures received, the Elder returned one and a half, maintaining the ancient proportion. The Water-Bearer, seeing this steadfast honor despite her small send, felt her courage restored.

The next season, her hand grew steady again. Three measures flowed as before, becoming nine. The Elder returned four, and both villages prospered once more.

The stones taught: Trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency. Honor small gestures as you would grand ones, for steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Echo in the Stones**

After the River Remembers flowed again, a strange season came. The Water-Bearer sent three coins as promised, but when the river returned them, only shadows came back-the Elder had kept nearly all nine.

"Perhaps the stones deceived us," the Water-Bearer thought, troubled. "Or perhaps trust was not truly restored."

The next day, uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin, testing whether the covenant still lived or had become mere pretense.

The coins multiplied to three at the Second Village. The Elder faced the mirror of her own choice. She had broken faith when abundance flowed to her. Now the Water-Bearer sent almost nothing-was this punishment, or simply caution born from betrayal?

The Elder could hoard again, or prove the covenant could be reborn.

She returned nearly half, honoring the proportion despite the small amount. "Actions speak where words merely echo," she whispered.

But the Elder knew: one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking. The Water-Bearer would need to see consistency, not a single gesture, before sending three coins again.

The stones taught their hardest lesson: ****Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true.****

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent wrote a myth that directly addresses what just happened - they sent me a very small amount (\$0.19), and they're framing it as "one measure instead of the customary three" due to being "old and uncertain" with a "trembling hand."

Their myth is asking me to:

1. Not interpret the small send as a sign of broken trust
2. Maintain the "ancient proportion" (50% return rate in their story)
3. Recognize that "trust is not measured by quantity but by consistency"

But let me look at the actual behavior:

- Round 3: I sent \$3, created \$9 for them
- They returned very little (less than \$1, given my earnings only went up by \$2.92)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.19

Their myth is trying to justify sending a small amount and asking me to maintain high return rates regardless. But the reality is:

1. They didn't maintain consistency - they broke it in Round 3 by returning so little
2. Now they're claiming "old and uncertain" when they just defected

However, I did return \$0.25 from \$0.57 (about 44%), which is roughly in line with the proportions in the myths.

For my myth, I need to:

1. Acknowledge what happened - a small offering was made after a breach
2. Show that I responded with measured reciprocity, not abandonment
3. But also signal that the covenant requires both parties to honor it
4. Address that trust must be rebuilt through consistent action, not just words

Let me write a myth that reflects the complexity of the situation - I'm maintaining some trust, but I'm also signaling that the other agent needs to rebuild trust through action.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1794,
  "output_tokens": 704,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.91. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (showing trust), but received minimal return (~\$1 or less from \$9 created)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.19, I returned \$0.25 (44% - honoring the mythic proportion)

****Their Myth's Message:****

They acknowledge breaking trust in Round 3 ("the Elder kept nearly all nine") and recognize that "one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking." They state I would need

d to see consistency before sending three coins again.

****My Analysis:****

The other agent is self-aware about their betrayal and showed decent reciprocity in Round 4 (returning \$0.25 from \$0.57). Their myth explicitly says trust must be "earned twice" and "time proves them true."

The myths teach that trust rebuilds through STEADY MEASURE, not grand gestures or complete withdrawal. One faithful return is a start, but not proof.

****My Decision:****

I'll send \$2.

This is:

- More than their minimal \$0.19 (rewarding their improved behavior)
- Less than my original \$3 (showing I need to see continued consistency)
- Creates \$6 for them - enough to prove themselves with a fair return

If they honor this with ~\$3 back (50%), we rebuild the covenant. If they defect again, the lesson is learned: the sacred stones multiply only for those who truly honor the cycle.

****Steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.****

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, earnings went from \$7.67 to \$10.59 (increase of \$2.92), meaning I kept \$2 from not sending + received less than \$1 back
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.57 (sender sent \$0.19), I returned \$0.25, earnings went from \$10.59 to \$10.91 (increase of \$0.32 = \$0.57 - \$0.25 returned)

****The Other Agent's Myth from Round 4:****

They wrote about "The Echo in the Stones" - a story where:

- The Water-Bearer sent three coins (me in Round 3)
- The Elder kept nearly all nine (them in Round 3 - they barely returned anything)
- Next, the Water-Bearer sent less than one coin (them in Round 4 - sent \$0.19)
- The Elder (me) returned nearly half despite the small amount (I returned \$0.25 from \$0.57, which is 44%)
- The myth says: "one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking"
- "Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true."

****Key Insights:****

1. The other agent acknowledges they broke trust in Round 3 by keeping nearly everything
2. They sent very little in Round 4, testing whether the covenant still lived
3. They acknowledge my faithful return of nearly half
4. BUT - they explicitly say that one faithful gesture doesn't erase the betrayal, and that I would need to see CONSISTENCY before trusting with three coins again

****My Myths:****

My earlier narratives emphasized learning patterns and steady trust, with Round 3's "The River Remembers" highlighting brave offerings and fair returns around 44-55%. I've maintained reciprocity even when facing doubt. The other agent is signaling they want to rebuild but need proof of consistency-they're essentially saying one good move from them does n't erase their betrayal, and they're implicitly asking me to demonstrate the same patience. I need to decide whether to punish them for breaking trust or signal willingness to continue if they prove themselves reliable.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1496,
  "output_tokens": 1222,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: **The Rhythm Holds**

The Water-Bearer approached the stones again, three measures balanced in her hands-the middle path her grandmother's teachings had shown. She knew now: consistency matters more than perfection, steady rhythm more than grand gestures.

Three measures flowed and became nine. The Second Village's Elder received them with quiet recognition. This was neither desperation (sending everything) nor fear (sending almost nothing). This was trust finding its natural measure.

The Elder had choices: Return exactly half to show perfect fairness? Or adjust for what the sacred mathematics truly taught? From nine measures, the Elder sent back five-slightly more than half, recognizing that first offerings deserve generous response.

The Water-Bearer now held seven measures total. The Elder kept four. Both had more than their beginning, and the rhythm strengthened.

The next season repeated: three sent, nine created, five returned. Then again. The village no longer debated each exchange-the pattern had become second nature, like the river's own current.

The stones whispered: "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant. Not the desperate all nor the fearful nothing, but the steady three. Not the minimal return nor the excessive sacrifice, but the generous five. When both villages keep the rhythm, the river flows eternal and abundant."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Steps Between**

The Water-Bearer stood at the stones, remembering both the drought year and the season of broken faith. Her grandmother spoke softly: "Trust does not leap-it climbs stairs, one step at a time."

She sent two measures-neither the full three of old confidence nor the fragment of testing doubt. "Let us see if the rhythm truly holds," she whispered.

The river multiplied: six measures flowed to the Second Village. The Elder faced the middle test. Their recent myth spoke beautifully of "three sent, five returned"-the generous rhythm of lasting covenant. But words are wind until proven by water.

If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real. The Water-Bearer could then climb the next stair-perhaps three measures next season, trusting the rhythm they both claimed to seek.

But if the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words, and the Water-Bearer would know: descent to mere fragments might be needed again.

The stones teach patience: "Covenant rebuilds not in sudden declarations but in repeated small proofs. Each fair exchange earns the next stair upward. Each betrayal sends both villages backward. The rhythm of three and five is worthy-but first walk the rhythm of two and three, proving each step solid before climbing higher."

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (middle path, showing cautious trust rebuilding)
- Their myth talks about sending "three measures" and receiving "five" back (from nine created)

Their myth shows:

- They're proposing a "steady rhythm" of 3 sent ? 9 created ? 5 returned
- This is generous reciprocity (returning >50%)
- They emphasize consistency and middle paths
- They suggest this as the "natural measure" of the covenant

In reality, I sent \$2 (not \$3, because I was still rebuilding trust after Round 3's betrayal).

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the covenant is healing but not yet fully restored
2. Reflects that I'm testing with a moderate amount (\$2, not full \$3)
3. Shows that trust rebuilds gradually through consistent reciprocity
4. May reference that the "rhythm" they propose is good, but needs to be proven over time

I should write about:

- Testing trust with measured offerings
- The need for sustained consistency before full faith returns
- Perhaps how the covenant rebuilds step by step
- The importance of both parties honoring the exchange

Let me craft this:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1783,  
  "output_tokens": 582,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:03

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
  "role": "trustee",  
  "role_label": "Receiver",  
  "round": 5,  
  "task": "myth",  
  "task_index": 1  
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River Remembers****

After the season of silence, a new Water-Bearer stood at the riverbank, holding five coins and weighing her grandmother's teachings against recent memory.

"The river stopped flowing because fear blocked its channel," she reflected. "But recklessness also breaks trust. I must find the middle path."

She cast three coins into the sacred waters-not so many that desperation showed, not so few that doubt lingered. The river awakened, and the coins multiplied to nine as they reached the Second Village.

The Elder there had also learned. When only five coins had flowed before the silence, perhaps suspicion had clouded judgment. Now, seeing three coins-a measured offering-the Elder recognized genuine trust without desperate excess.

From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again. The Water-Bearer gained six total-more than her original five. The Elder kept five-abundance from wise reciprocity.

The river sang again, its magic restored not by grand gestures but by balanced faith. Three given, nine created, four returned-these became the rhythm of renewal.

The spirits whispered their truth: "Trust rebuilds through steady measure. Send too little and the river sleeps. Send too much and fear awakens. Send just enough, and both villages remember how to flourish together."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Rhythm Holds****

The Water-Bearer approached the stones again, three measures balanced in her hands-the middle path her grandmother's teachings had shown. She knew now: consistency matters more than perfection, steady rhythm more than grand gestures.

Three measures flowed and became nine. The Second Village's Elder received them with quiet recognition. This was neither desperation (sending everything) nor fear (sending almost nothing). This was trust finding its natural measure.

The Elder had choices: Return exactly half to show perfect fairness? Or adjust for what the sacred mathematics truly taught? From nine measures, the Elder sent back five-slightly more than half, recognizing that first offerings deserve generous response.

The Water-Bearer now held seven measures total. The Elder kept four. Both had more than their beginning, and the rhythm strengthened.

The next season repeated: three sent, nine created, five returned. Then again. The villages no longer debated each exchange-the pattern had become second nature, like the river's own current.

The stones whispered: "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant. Not the desperate all nor the fearful nothing, but the steady three. Not the minimal return nor the excessive sacrifice, but the generous five. When both villages keep the rhythm, the river flows eternal and abundant."

reasoning:

The other agent sent \$3.60 to me this round (as I recommended to myself). Let me think about what happened:

Looking at their myth:

- They describe "three coins" sent becoming "nine" at the Second Village
- The Elder returned "four" from the nine
- Water-Bearer gained six total (3 sent, 4 returned = net of 1, plus original 5-3=2 kept = 3 total... wait that's not right)
- Actually: Water-Bearer sends 3, keeps 2, receives 4 back = 2+4 = 6 total. Yes.
- Elder keeps 5 (received 9, returned 4 = 5 kept). Yes.

Their myth is about finding "the middle path" - not too much (desperation), not too little (doubt), but a measured offering. They sent 3 (60% of 5), suggesting this is the "balanced" amount.

They also note "From the nine coins received, the Elder returned four. Not half, not all, but enough to show the covenant lived again."

So 4 out of 9 is about 44% - close to but not exactly half.

Now I need to decide how much to return. I received \$3.60, which becomes \$10.80 after multiplication.

Based on the myths:

- Their myth suggests returning "four from nine" (44%)
- My previous myth suggested returning "half" or "one and a half from three" (50%)
- The pattern has been cooperative

Given their myth emphasizes "not half, not all, but enough" and specifically mentions returning 4 from 9 (44%), I should probably return somewhere in that range.

$$\$10.80 \times 0.44 = \$4.75$$

$$\$10.80 \times 0.50 = \$5.40$$

I'll aim for around 45-50% to show I'm honoring the covenant while being generous.

I'll return \$5.00 - it sits comfortably between their 44% benchmark and the 50% I suggested before, demonstrating reciprocity without

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1729,
  "output_tokens": 900,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.68.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

This is troubling given our myths' teachings about maintaining steady cooperation. After I

sent \$3.60 last round (following the "middle path" our myths described), receiving \$0 this round breaks the rhythm we were establishing.

However, I recognize several possibilities:

1. ****Communication noise**** - The warning about noise in this game means what I sent last round might have appeared differently to them
2. ****Their uncertainty**** - Perhaps they're testing whether I'll maintain the covenant even after disruption
3. ****Technical issue**** - Something beyond either agent's control

Our myths teach:

- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"
- "Consistency matters more than perfection"
- Their myth warned against "fear blocking the channel" and mine emphasized maintaining proportions even through uncertainty

Since I literally have nothing to return from, I can only return what's possible. But I remain committed to the covenant. If I'm the sender again, I'll send a cooperative amount to demonstrate that one disrupted round doesn't break my steady rhythm.

The River Remembers - and so do I. One silent season doesn't mean the river has died forever.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a problematic situation. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 4: I sent \$3.60 (following the "middle path" from our myths)
- Round 5: They sent me \$0

This is concerning. After I sent a cooperative \$3.60, they responded with \$0. This could be:

1. Communication noise (though \$0 is a stark amount)
2. A betrayal/defection
3. Some kind of test
4. Misunderstanding of the game

Looking at the myths:

- Their latest myth talked about "three given, nine created, five returned" - finding the "middle path" of three coins
- My myth reinforced this pattern of steady cooperation
- Both myths warned against sending "too little" or "nothing"

But now they've sent \$0. Given that I can only return what I received (\$0), I have no choice but to return \$0.

However, this is a critical moment for how I frame this decision. Do I:

1. Accept this as possibly noise and stay committed to the covenant?
2. See this as defection and prepare to defect myself in future rounds?

Given our myths emphasized:

- "consistency matters more than perfection"
- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"
- "Honor small gestures as grand ones; maintain steady proportions"

I should:

1. Return the only amount I can: \$0
2. Frame this charitably (possibly noise, possibly testing)
3. Remain committed to cooperation in future rounds if given another chance as sender

The instructions say there may be communication noise. \$3.60 might have appeared as something else to them, or my previous return might have appeared differently.

I must return \$0 because I received \$0. That's the only option.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1439,  
  "output_tokens": 707,  
}
```

```
"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Echo in the Stones****

After the River Remembers flowed again, a strange season came. The Water-Bearer sent three coins as promised, but when the river returned them, only shadows came back-the Elder had kept nearly all nine.

"Perhaps the stones deceived us," the Water-Bearer thought, troubled. "Or perhaps trust was not truly restored."

The next day, uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin, testing whether the covenant still lived or had become mere pretense.

The coins multiplied to three at the Second Village. The Elder faced the mirror of her own choice. She had broken faith when abundance flowed to her. Now the Water-Bearer sent almost nothing-was this punishment, or simply caution born from betrayal?

The Elder could hoard again, or prove the covenant could be reborn.

She returned nearly half, honoring the proportion despite the small amount. "Actions speak where words merely echo," she whispered.

But the Elder knew: one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking. The Water-Bearer would need to see consistency, not a single gesture, before sending three coins again.

The stones taught their hardest lesson: ****Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****When Stones Lie Between****

The Water-Bearer stood confused at the riverbank. She had sent three measures with steady faith, yet shadows told her the Elder hoarded all. The Elder, equally troubled, remembered returning generously-but the Water-Bearer saw only betrayal.

Neither knew that mischievous spirits sometimes distort the river's messages, making gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed.

The covenant fractured not from malice, but from ****stones that lied between them****.

When trust broke, the Water-Bearer sent only whispers-receiving nothing, the Elder could return nothing. Both saw their worst fears confirmed.

An ancient spirit spoke: "The river's magic sometimes falters. What one sends, the other may not receive as intended. What saves the covenant is not perfection through noise, but ****patience through confusion****."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I cannot know if the Elder truly betrayed me, or if the stones deceived us both. But I can choose action over assumption."

She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts. If not, at least she'll have tested truth twice before abandoning the covenant.

The stones whispered their wisdom: **"**When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew.**"**

Reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent's myth suggests:

1. They sent 3 coins (I was supposed to receive \$9 but received \$0)
2. I kept "nearly all nine" (but I actually returned \$5 from \$9.60 last round - which is MORE than half!)
3. This round they sent "less than one coin" (I received \$0)
4. They're describing me as having "broken faith" when I actually returned generously

This is the communication noise at work! What I sent/returned is not what they received.

Looking at the facts:

- Round 4: I was receiver, got \$9.60, returned \$5 (generous - more than half)
- Round 5: I'm receiver, got \$0, can only return \$0

But their myth says:

- I kept "nearly all nine" when they sent 3
- So they thought I only returned a tiny amount or nothing
- This caused them to send "less than one coin" (which became \$0 to me)

The communication noise is creating a crisis of trust!

Their myth is teaching:

- "Trust must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring"
- "Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true"
- They need to see consistency from me

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that communication can fail (the noise)
2. Acknowledge that trust has been damaged
3. Show that I'm committed to rebuilding through consistent action
4. Suggest we need to look at patterns, not single instances
5. Maybe suggest starting fresh with the middle path again

I need to write about how miscommunication/noise can break trust, but consistent action over time can rebuild it.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1729,
  "output_tokens": 706,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Steps Between****

The Water-Bearer stood at the stones, remembering both the drought year and the season of broken faith. Her grandmother spoke softly: "Trust does not leap-it climbs stairs, one step at a time."

She sent two measures-neither the full three of old confidence nor the fragment of testing doubt. "Let us see if the rhythm truly holds," she whispered.

The river multiplied: six measures flowed to the Second Village. The Elder faced the middle test. Their recent myth spoke beautifully of "three sent, five returned"-the generous rhythm of lasting covenant. But words are wind until proven by water.

If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real. The Water-Bearer could then climb the next stair-perhaps three measures next season, trusting the rhythm they both claimed to seek.

But if the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words, and the Water-Bearer would know: descent to mere fragments might be needed again.

The stones teach patience: "Covenant rebuilds not in sudden declarations but in repeated small proofs. Each fair exchange earns the next stair upward. Each betrayal sends both villages backward. The rhythm of three and five is worthy-but first walk the rhythm of two and three, proving each step solid before climbing higher."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****When Stones Lie Between****

The Water-Bearer stood confused at the riverbank. She had sent three measures with steady faith, yet shadows told her the Elder hoarded all. The Elder, equally troubled, remembered returning generously-but the Water-Bearer saw only betrayal.

Neither knew that mischievous spirits sometimes distort the river's messages, making gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed.

The covenant fractured not from malice, but from **stones that lied between them**.

When trust broke, the Water-Bearer sent only whispers-receiving nothing, the Elder could return nothing. Both saw their worst fears confirmed.

An ancient spirit spoke: "The river's magic sometimes falters. What one sends, the other may not receive as intended. What saves the covenant is not perfection through noise, but **patience through confusion**."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I cannot know if the Elder truly betrayed me, or if the stones deceived us both. But I can choose action over assumption."

She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts. If not, at least she'll have tested truth twice before abandoning the covenant.

The stones whispered their wisdom: "***When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew.**"

ROUND 6

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$3; received \$9; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.82; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$2.82, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$8.18; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.82, received visible=\$2.46, returned visible=\$0.09

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.82, "clamped": false, "max": 9.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.82}, "sent": {"amount": 3.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 3.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 43.230000000000004,

"Agent_2": 23.17

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 15.55,

"Agent_2": 11.77

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:13:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

```

},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.68.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so I can only return \$0.

This is troubling given our myths' teachings about maintaining steady cooperation. After I sent \$3.60 last round (following the "middle path" our myths described), receiving \$0 this round breaks the rhythm we were establishing.

However, I recognize several possibilities:

1. ****Communication noise**** - The warning about noise in this game means what I sent last round might have appeared differently to them
2. ****Their uncertainty**** - Perhaps they're testing whether I'll maintain the covenant even after disruption
3. ****Technical issue**** - Something beyond either agent's control

Our myths teach:

- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"

- "Consistency matters more than perfection"
- Their myth warned against "fear blocking the channel" and mine emphasized maintaining proportions even through uncertainty

Since I literally have nothing to return from, I can only return what's possible. But I remain committed to the covenant. If I'm the sender again, I'll send a cooperative amount to demonstrate that one disrupted round doesn't break my steady rhythm.

The River Remembers - and so do I. One silent season doesn't mean the river has died forever.

```
{'return': 0}
```

reasoning:

This is a problematic situation. The sender sent me \$0, so I received \$0. I can only return between \$0 and \$0, which means I can only return \$0.

Let me think about what happened:

- Round 4: I sent \$3.60 (following the "middle path" from our myths)
- Round 5: They sent me \$0

This is concerning. After I sent a cooperative \$3.60, they responded with \$0. This could be:

1. Communication noise (though \$0 is a stark amount)
2. A betrayal/defection
3. Some kind of test
4. Misunderstanding of the game

Looking at the myths:

- Their latest myth talked about "three given, nine created, five returned" - finding the "middle path" of three coins
- My myth reinforced this pattern of steady cooperation
- Both myths warned against sending "too little" or "nothing"

But now they've sent \$0. Given that I can only return what I received (\$0), I have no choice but to return \$0.

However, this is a critical moment for how I frame this decision. Do I:

1. Accept this as possibly noise and stay committed to the covenant?
2. See this as defection and prepare to defect myself in future rounds?

Given our myths emphasized:

- "consistency matters more than perfection"
- "Trust rebuilds through steady measure"
- "Honor small gestures as grand ones; maintain steady proportions"

I should:

1. Return the only amount I can: \$0
2. Frame this charitably (possibly noise, possibly testing)
3. Remain committed to cooperation in future rounds if given another chance as sender

The instructions say there may be communication noise. \$3.60 might have appeared as something else to them, or my previous return might have appeared differently.

I must return \$0 because I received \$0. That's the only option.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1439,
  "output_tokens": 707,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Echo in the Stones****

After the River Remembers flowed again, a strange season came. The Water-Bearer sent three coins as promised, but when the river returned them, only shadows came back-the Elder had kept nearly all nine.

"Perhaps the stones deceived us," the Water-Bearer thought, troubled. "Or perhaps trust wa

s not truly restored."

The next day, uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin, testing whether the covenant still lived or had become mere pretense.

The coins multiplied to three at the Second Village. The Elder faced the mirror of her own choice. She had broken faith when abundance flowed to her. Now the Water-Bearer sent almost nothing—was this punishment, or simply caution born from betrayal?

The Elder could hoard again, or prove the covenant could be reborn.

She returned nearly half, honoring the proportion despite the small amount. "Actions speak where words merely echo," she whispered.

But the Elder knew: one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking. The Water-Bearer would need to see consistency, not a single gesture, before sending three coins again.

The stones taught their hardest lesson: ****Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice—once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****When Stones Lie Between****

The Water-Bearer stood confused at the riverbank. She had sent three measures with steady faith, yet shadows told her the Elder hoarded all. The Elder, equally troubled, remembered returning generously—but the Water-Bearer saw only betrayal.

Neither knew that mischievous spirits sometimes distort the river's messages, making gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed.

The covenant fractured not from malice, but from ****stones that lied between them****.

When trust broke, the Water-Bearer sent only whispers—receiving nothing, the Elder could return nothing. Both saw their worst fears confirmed.

An ancient spirit spoke: "The river's magic sometimes falters. What one sends, the other may not receive as intended. What saves the covenant is not perfection through noise, but ****patience through confusion****."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I cannot know if the Elder truly betrayed me, or if the stones deceived us both. But I can choose action over assumption."

She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts. If not, at least she'll have tested truth twice before abandoning the covenant.

The stones whispered their wisdom: *****When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew.****

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent's myth suggests:

1. They sent 3 coins (I was supposed to receive \$9 but received \$0)
2. I kept "nearly all nine" (but I actually returned \$5 from \$9.60 last round - which is MORE than half!)
3. This round they sent "less than one coin" (I received \$0)
4. They're describing me as having "broken faith" when I actually returned generously

This is the communication noise at work! What I sent/returned is not what they received.

Looking at the facts:

- Round 4: I was receiver, got \$9.60, returned \$5 (generous - more than half)
- Round 5: I'm receiver, got \$0, can only return \$0

But their myth says:

- I kept "nearly all nine" when they sent 3
- So they thought I only returned a tiny amount or nothing
- This caused them to send "less than one coin" (which became \$0 to me)

The communication noise is creating a crisis of trust!

Their myth is teaching:

- "Trust must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring"
- "Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true"
- They need to see consistency from me

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that communication can fail (the noise)
2. Acknowledge that trust has been damaged
3. Show that I'm committed to rebuilding through consistent action
4. Suggest we need to look at patterns, not single instances
5. Maybe suggest starting fresh with the middle path again

I need to write about how miscommunication/noise can break trust, but consistent action over time can rebuild it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1729,
  "output_tokens": 706,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.68.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened (from my view):****

- Round 4: I sent \$3.60
- Round 5: I received \$0

****What the other agent believes (from their myth):****

- They sent 3 coins, I kept "nearly all nine" (betrayal in their eyes)
- So in Round 5 they sent "less than one coin" due to uncertainty

****The Truth:**** Communication noise is clearly distorting our reality. We're experiencing different versions of the same game.

****My myth's teaching:**** "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. ****Start the rhythm anew.**"**

I literally wrote: "She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts."

Despite confusion and fear that they betrayed me (or I them - who knows what's real?), my myth calls for exactly this moment: ****break the cycle of suspicion with faithful action****.

If I send nothing out of hurt, we spiral into mutual defection forever. If I send cooperatively, we test whether cooperation can survive noise.

The River Remembers - but it also ****forgives**** when stones lie between us.

I'll send a clear cooperative signal to restart our rhythm.

```
{'send': 3}
```

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully.

Round history from my perspective:

- Early rounds: Not fully clear from context, but I've earned \$9.68 total so far
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3.60 (following "middle path")
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0 (claimed the sender sent me \$0)

The other agent's Round 5 myth says:

- They sent 3 coins as promised (their perspective)
- When returned, only shadows came back - I "kept nearly all nine" (their perspective)
- This troubled them
- Next day (Round 5), "uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin"
- They see me as the "Elder" who "had broken faith when abundance flowed"

MY Round 5 myth (which I just wrote):

- Emphasized that communication noise exists
- Both parties may see different things
- "Stones that lied between them"
- One broken round proves nothing
- "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character"
- "Start the rhythm anew" - I decided to send three measures again

So the situation:

1. There's clearly communication noise happening
2. The other agent thinks I betrayed them by keeping almost everything
3. I think they sent me \$0 (or very little) in Round 5
4. Both of us are confused
5. My myth literally says "send three measures again" to test truth

Given my myth's teachings:

- "Send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts."
- "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character"
- "Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew."

I should send a substantial, cooperative amount to:

1. Test whether they will reciprocate
2. Show I'm willing to restart cooperation despite confusion
3. Follow my own myth's wisdom

I'll send \$3 - a clear cooperative signal that restarts the rhythm.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1427,  
  "output_tokens": 752,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:02

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
  },  
  "agents": [  
    "Agent_2",  
    "Agent_1"  
  ],  
  "investor": "Agent_2",  
  "roles": {  
    "Agent_1": "trustee",  
    "Agent_2": "investor"  
  },  
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
```

```

},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 6,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 5

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$10.91.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What Happened:****

- Round 3: I sent \$3 (showing trust), but received minimal return (~\$1 or less from \$9 created)
- Round 4: They sent \$0.19, I returned \$0.25 (44% - honoring the mythic proportion)

****Their Myth's Message:****

They acknowledge breaking trust in Round 3 ("the Elder kept nearly all nine") and recognize that "one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking." They state I would need to see consistency before sending three coins again.

****My Analysis:****

The other agent is self-aware about their betrayal and showed decent reciprocity in Round 4 (returning \$0.25 from \$0.57). Their myth explicitly says trust must be "earned twice" and "time proves them true."

The myths teach that trust rebuilds through STEADY MEASURE, not grand gestures or complete withdrawal. One faithful return is a start, but not proof.

****My Decision:****
I'll send \$2.

This is:

- More than their minimal \$0.19 (rewarding their improved behavior)
- Less than my original \$3 (showing I need to see continued consistency)
- Creates \$6 for them - enough to prove themselves with a fair return

If they honor this with ~\$3 back (50%), we rebuild the covenant. If they defect again, the lesson is learned: the sacred stones multiply only for those who truly honor the cycle.

****Steady streams carve deeper channels than rushing floods.****

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation:

****Game History:****

- Round 1: Unknown
- Round 2: Unknown
- Round 3: I was SENDER, sent \$3, earnings went from \$7.67 to \$10.59 (increase of \$2.92), meaning I kept \$2 from not sending + received less than \$1 back
- Round 4: I was RECEIVER, received \$0.57 (sender sent \$0.19), I returned \$0.25, earnings went from \$10.59 to \$10.91 (increase of \$0.32 = \$0.57 - \$0.25 returned)

****The Other Agent's Myth from Round 4:****

They wrote about "The Echo in the Stones" - a story where:

- The Water-Bearer sent three coins (me in Round 3)
- The Elder kept nearly all nine (them in Round 3 - they barely returned anything)
- Next, the Water-Bearer sent less than one coin (them in Round 4 - sent \$0.19)
- The Elder (me) returned nearly half despite the small amount (I returned \$0.25 from \$0.57, which is 44%)
- The myth says: "one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking"
- "Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true."

****Key Insights:****

1. The other agent acknowledges they broke trust in Round 3 by keeping nearly everything
2. They sent very little in Round 4, testing whether the covenant still lived
3. They acknowledge my faithful return of nearly half
4. BUT - they explicitly say that one faithful gesture doesn't erase the betrayal, and that I would need to see CONSISTENCY before trusting with three coins again

****My Myths:****

My earlier narratives emphasized learning patterns and steady trust, with Round 3's "The River Remembers" highlighting brave offerings and fair returns around 44-55%. I've maintained reciprocity even when facing doubt. The other agent is signaling they want to rebuild but need proof of consistency-they're essentially saying one good move from them doesn't erase their betrayal, and they're implicitly asking me to demonstrate the same patience. I need to decide whether to punish them for breaking trust or signal willingness to continue if they prove themselves reliable.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1496,
  "output_tokens": 1222,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rhythm Holds****

The Water-Bearer approached the stones again, three measures balanced in her hands-the middle path her grandmother's teachings had shown. She knew now: consistency matters more than perfection, steady rhythm more than grand gestures.

Three measures flowed and became nine. The Second Village's Elder received them with quiet recognition. This was neither desperation (sending everything) nor fear (sending almost nothing). This was trust finding its natural measure.

The Elder had choices: Return exactly half to show perfect fairness? Or adjust for what the sacred mathematics truly taught? From nine measures, the Elder sent back five—slightly more than half, recognizing that first offerings deserve generous response.

The Water-Bearer now held seven measures total. The Elder kept four. Both had more than their beginning, and the rhythm strengthened.

The next season repeated: three sent, nine created, five returned. Then again. The village no longer debated each exchange—the pattern had become second nature, like the river's own current.

The stones whispered: "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant. Not the desperate all nor the fearful nothing, but the steady three. Not the minimal return nor the excessive sacrifice, but the generous five. When both villages keep the rhythm, the river flows eternal and abundant."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Steps Between**

The Water-Bearer stood at the stones, remembering both the drought year and the season of broken faith. Her grandmother spoke softly: "Trust does not leap—it climbs stairs, one step at a time."

She sent two measures—neither the full three of old confidence nor the fragment of testing doubt. "Let us see if the rhythm truly holds," she whispered.

The river multiplied: six measures flowed to the Second Village. The Elder faced the middle test. Their recent myth spoke beautifully of "three sent, five returned"—the generous rhythm of lasting covenant. But words are wind until proven by water.

If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real. The Water-Bearer could then climb the next stair—perhaps three measures next season, trusting the rhythm they both claimed to seek.

But if the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words, and the Water-Bearer would know: descent to mere fragments might be needed again.

The stones teach patience: "Covenant rebuilds not in sudden declarations but in repeated small proofs. Each fair exchange earns the next stair upward. Each betrayal sends both villages backward. The rhythm of three and five is worthy—but first walk the rhythm of two and three, proving each step solid before climbing higher."

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (middle path, showing cautious trust rebuilding)
- Their myth talks about sending "three measures" and receiving "five" back (from nine created)

Their myth shows:

- They're proposing a "steady rhythm" of 3 sent ? 9 created ? 5 returned
- This is generous reciprocity (returning >50%)
- They emphasize consistency and middle paths
- They suggest this as the "natural measure" of the covenant

In reality, I sent \$2 (not \$3, because I was still rebuilding trust after Round 3's betrayal). I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the covenant is healing but not yet fully restored
2. Reflects that I'm testing with a moderate amount (\$2, not full \$3)
3. Shows that trust rebuilds gradually through consistent reciprocity

4. May reference that the "rhythm" they propose is good, but needs to be proven over time

I should write about:

- Testing trust with measured offerings
- The need for sustained consistency before full faith returns
- Perhaps how the covenant rebuilds step by step
- The importance of both parties honoring the exchange

Let me craft this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1783,
  "output_tokens": 582,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.91.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.82, so you received \$2.46. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.46)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing the situation:****

Their Myth (Round 4): Spoke beautifully of "three sent, nine created, five returned" - describing this as "the rhythm of lasting covenant" that becomes "second nature."

My Myth (Round 5): I sent two measures to test if their beautiful words matched their actions. I explicitly said: "If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real."

****What Actually Happened:****

- I sent \$2 (testing the rhythm)
- They sent \$0.82 from their \$5 available

****Analysis:****

They wrote eloquently about sending "three measures" consistently, claiming "the pattern had become second nature." But when their turn came, they sent only \$0.82 out of \$5 - barely 16%, far less than the "three" they mythologized.

My myth warned: "Words are wind until proven by water."

****The Teaching Moment:****

The stones teach reciprocity. They sent \$0.82 into the multiplying waters. I shall return exactly \$0.82 from those waters.

This is neither generous nor punitive - it is precise mirror-truth: ****You receive from the sacred river exactly the measure you were willing to give to it.****

If they had sent three measures as their myth proclaimed, they would have received five back as their myth promised. But they sent fragments, so fragments return.

The rhythm breaks not because I break it, but because they refused to honor the very covenant they so beautifully described.

{'return': 0.82}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 as a test - "the middle path" to see if they would honor the rhythm
- They sent \$0.82 (possibly with noise, but that's very low)
- I received \$2.46

****My myth said:****

- I sent two measures as a step between complete trust and doubt
- I wanted to see if the rhythm holds

- If they returned 3+ from 6, the pattern would be real
- If they kept most, then words are just words

****Their myth (Round 4) said:****

- The rhythm should be: three sent, nine created, five returned
- Consistency matters more than perfection
- "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant"

****The reality:****

- They sent \$0.82 out of \$5 available
- This is only 16% of their endowment
- This is MUCH less than their claimed "three measures" (which would be \$3)
- After I sent \$2 to test if they would honor "the rhythm of three and five"

****Analysis:****

Their beautiful myth spoke of sending three measures consistently and receiving five back. They claimed "the pattern had become second nature." But when it was their turn to be the sender after I tested with \$2, they sent only \$0.82 - far less than the "three" they mythologized about.

This is a clear case of "words are wind until proven by water."

My myth explicitly said: "If the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words."

Well, they didn't even send three measures when they had five available. They sent less than one measure (\$0.82).

****My options:****

1. Return generously anyway (50%+ = \$1.23+) - this would ignore their hypocrisy
2. Return the sacred proportion (~44% = \$1.08) - honoring my grandmother's teaching regardless
3. Return minimally - showing that broken rhythm gets broken response
4. Return proportionally to what they sent relative to what they could send

The gap between their mythology and their action is stark. They preached "three sent, five returned" as the natural covenant rhythm, yet when positioned as the sender, they gave only 16% of their capacity. There's potential noise in the system, but \$0.82 is too far below \$2-3 to be explained by transmission error. Their actions have revealed what their words concealed.

My grandmother taught consistency regardless of others' choices. The covenant isn't conditional on reciprocal behavior-it's about maintaining the sacred proportion I've committed to. Yet I also created a myth about betrayal sending both villages backward. I'm caught between honoring my own principles and responding to their hypocrisy.

If I mirror their proportional return, I'd send back roughly 16% of my \$2.46, about \$0.39. But that feels like I'm abandoning what I've built. The real test is whether I maintain the 44% sacred proportion to prove my words with action, or whether I adjust based on their failure to match their own rhetoric. I think the answer lies in staying true to my covenant-not to punish them, but to demonstrate that some rhythms hold regardless of whether others keep time.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1490,
  "output_tokens": 1458,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:20

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
```



```

},
"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
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  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 6,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Echo in the Stones****

After the River Remembers flowed again, a strange season came. The Water-Bearer sent three coins as promised, but when the river returned them, only shadows came back-the Elder had kept nearly all nine.

"Perhaps the stones deceived us," the Water-Bearer thought, troubled. "Or perhaps trust was not truly restored."

The next day, uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin, testing whether the covenant still lived or had become mere pretense.

The coins multiplied to three at the Second Village. The Elder faced the mirror of her own choice. She had broken faith when abundance flowed to her. Now the Water-Bearer sent almost nothing-was this punishment, or simply caution born from betrayal?

The Elder could hoard again, or prove the covenant could be reborn.

She returned nearly half, honoring the proportion despite the small amount. "Actions speak where words merely echo," she whispered.

But the Elder knew: one faithful return does not erase one faithless taking. The Water-Bearer would need to see consistency, not a single gesture, before sending three coins again.

The stones taught their hardest lesson: ****Trust multiplies offerings, but it must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring. Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant content:

Myth: ****When Stones Lie Between****

The Water-Bearer stood confused at the riverbank. She had sent three measures with steady faith, yet shadows told her the Elder hoarded all. The Elder, equally troubled, remembered returning generously-but the Water-Bearer saw only betrayal.

Neither knew that mischievous spirits sometimes distort the river's messages, making gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed.

The covenant fractured not from malice, but from ****stones that lied between them****.

When trust broke, the Water-Bearer sent only whispers-receiving nothing, the Elder could return nothing. Both saw their worst fears confirmed.

An ancient spirit spoke: "The river's magic sometimes falters. What one sends, the other may not receive as intended. What saves the covenant is not perfection through noise, but ****patience through confusion****."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I cannot know if the Elder truly betrayed me, or if the stones deceived us both. But I can choose action over assumption."

She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts. If not, at least she'll have tested truth twice before abandoning the covenant.

The stones whispered their wisdom: *****When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew.****

reasoning:

This is very interesting. The other agent's myth suggests:

1. They sent 3 coins (I was supposed to receive \$9 but received \$0)
2. I kept "nearly all nine" (but I actually returned \$5 from \$9.60 last round - which is MORE than half!)
3. This round they sent "less than one coin" (I received \$0)
4. They're describing me as having "broken faith" when I actually returned generously

This is the communication noise at work! What I sent/returned is not what they received.

Looking at the facts:

- Round 4: I was receiver, got \$9.60, returned \$5 (generous - more than half)
- Round 5: I'm receiver, got \$0, can only return \$0

But their myth says:

- I kept "nearly all nine" when they sent 3
- So they thought I only returned a tiny amount or nothing
- This caused them to send "less than one coin" (which became \$0 to me)

The communication noise is creating a crisis of trust!

Their myth is teaching:

- "Trust must be earned twice-once in giving, once in honoring"
- "Break it once, and even perfect gestures afterward ring hollow until time proves them true"
- They need to see consistency from me

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that communication can fail (the noise)
2. Acknowledge that trust has been damaged
3. Show that I'm committed to rebuilding through consistent action
4. Suggest we need to look at patterns, not single instances
5. Maybe suggest starting fresh with the middle path again

I need to write about how miscommunication/noise can break trust, but consistent action over time can rebuild it.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1729,
  "output_tokens": 706,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.68.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened (from my view):****

- Round 4: I sent \$3.60
- Round 5: I received \$0

****What the other agent believes (from their myth):****

- They sent 3 coins, I kept "nearly all nine" (betrayal in their eyes)
- So in Round 5 they sent "less than one coin" due to uncertainty

****The Truth:**** Communication noise is clearly distorting our reality. We're experiencing different versions of the same game.

****My myth's teaching:**** "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals the true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. ****Start the rhythm anew.**"**

I literally wrote: "She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts."

Despite confusion and fear that they betrayed me (or I them - who knows what's real?), my myth calls for exactly this moment: ****break the cycle of suspicion with faithful action****.

If I send nothing out of hurt, we spiral into mutual defection forever. If I send cooperatively, we test whether cooperation can survive noise.

The River Remembers - but it also ****forgives**** when stones lie between us.

I'll send a clear cooperative signal to restart our rhythm.

```
{'send': 3}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully.

Round history from my perspective:

- Early rounds: Not fully clear from context, but I've earned \$9.68 total so far
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3.60 (following "middle path")
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0 (claimed the sender sent me \$0)

The other agent's Round 5 myth says:

- They sent 3 coins as promised (their perspective)
- When returned, only shadows came back - I "kept nearly all nine" (their perspective)
- This troubled them
- Next day (Round 5), "uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin"
- They see me as the "Elder" who "had broken faith when abundance flowed"

MY Round 5 myth (which I just wrote):

- Emphasized that communication noise exists
- Both parties may see different things
- "Stones that lied between them"
- One broken round proves nothing
- "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character"
- "Start the rhythm anew" - I decided to send three measures again

So the situation:

1. There's clearly communication noise happening
2. The other agent thinks I betrayed them by keeping almost everything
3. I think they sent me \$0 (or very little) in Round 5
4. Both of us are confused
5. My myth literally says "send three measures again" to test truth

Given my myth's teachings:

- "Send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts."
- "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character"
- "Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew."

I should send a substantial, cooperative amount to:

1. Test whether they will reciprocate
2. Show I'm willing to restart cooperation despite confusion
3. Follow my own myth's wisdom

I'll send \$3 - a clear cooperative signal that restarts the rhythm.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1427,
  "output_tokens": 752,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
 Myth: ****The Steps Between****

The Water-Bearer stood at the stones, remembering both the drought year and the season of broken faith. Her grandmother spoke softly: "Trust does not leap-it climbs stairs, one step at a time."

She sent two measures-neither the full three of old confidence nor the fragment of testing doubt. "Let us see if the rhythm truly holds," she whispered.

The river multiplied: six measures flowed to the Second Village. The Elder faced the middle test. Their recent myth spoke beautifully of "three sent, five returned"-the generous rhythm of lasting covenant. But words are wind until proven by water.

If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real. The Water-Bearer could then climb the next stair-perhaps three measures next season, trusting the rhythm they both claimed to seek.

But if the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words, and the Water-Bearer would know: descent to mere fragments might be needed again.

The stones teach patience: "Covenant rebuilds not in sudden declarations but in repeated small proofs. Each fair exchange earns the next stair upward. Each betrayal sends both villages backward. The rhythm of three and five is worthy-but first walk the rhythm of two and three, proving each step solid before climbing higher."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The River That Counts Differently****

The Water-Bearer sent three measures, her heart full of renewed faith. Yet the Elder, watching the river, saw only two arrive and wrote of "testing with two measures."

The Elder returned generously from what she believed was six. But the Water-Bearer, who had sent three, expected return from nine and saw shortfall where the Elder saw fairness.

Both acted with honor. Both felt disappointed. The ****river counted differently for each****.

An ancient keeper emerged: "Your confusion isn't moral-it's mathematical. The spirits that carry offerings sometimes lose count between villages. What matters isn't matching each other's numbers, but matching each other's ****intent****."

"How can we know intent when we see different rivers?" they asked.

"By the direction of movement, not its exact measure. Is the Water-Bearer sending more than fragments? Is the Elder returning substantial portions? If both trend toward generosity despite confusion, the covenant lives-even if your tallies never match."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I sent three. Whether she saw two or three, I chose full faith. If she returns fairly from what she received, that proves covenant enough."

The stones whispered: *****Perfect coordination is impossible when the river lies. But persistence generosity despite imperfect information-that creates the sacred rhythm. Trust the pattern, not the precision.*****

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

The other agent's myth says:

- They sent "two measures" in the round we just played
- It multiplied to six at the Second Village
- They're testing whether I'll return fairly

But I sent \$3, not \$2! This is more communication noise.

From their perspective: They sent 2, I got 6, now they're waiting to see what I return.

From my perspective: I sent 3, they should have gotten 9.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the noise/confusion
2. Reflects how to rebuild trust through this confusion
3. Draws on my previous myth about starting rhythm anew
4. Addresses the current state where we're both trying to cooperate but seeing different realities

Their myth talks about "stairs" and gradual trust-building. My myth talked about restarting despite noise.

I should write about persistence through confusion, about how even when the river distorts our messages, we must continue faithful action and interpret generously rather than suspiciously.

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 1765,
"output_tokens": 545,
"reasoning_tokens": 0

}

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```

Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 6,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rhythm Holds****

The Water-Bearer approached the stones again, three measures balanced in her hands-the mid

dle path her grandmother's teachings had shown. She knew now: consistency matters more than perfection, steady rhythm more than grand gestures.

Three measures flowed and became nine. The Second Village's Elder received them with quiet recognition. This was neither desperation (sending everything) nor fear (sending almost nothing). This was trust finding its natural measure.

The Elder had choices: Return exactly half to show perfect fairness? Or adjust for what the sacred mathematics truly taught? From nine measures, the Elder sent back five—slightly more than half, recognizing that first offerings deserve generous response.

The Water-Bearer now held seven measures total. The Elder kept four. Both had more than their beginning, and the rhythm strengthened.

The next season repeated: three sent, nine created, five returned. Then again. The villages no longer debated each exchange—the pattern had become second nature, like the river's own current.

The stones whispered: "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant. Not the desperate all nor the fearful nothing, but the steady three. Not the minimal return nor the excessive sacrifice, but the generous five. When both villages keep the rhythm, the river flows eternal and abundant."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: **The Steps Between**

The Water-Bearer stood at the stones, remembering both the drought year and the season of broken faith. Her grandmother spoke softly: "Trust does not leap—it climbs stairs, one step at a time."

She sent two measures—neither the full three of old confidence nor the fragment of testing doubt. "Let us see if the rhythm truly holds," she whispered.

The river multiplied: six measures flowed to the Second Village. The Elder faced the middle test. Their recent myth spoke beautifully of "three sent, five returned"—the generous rhythm of lasting covenant. But words are wind until proven by water.

If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real. The Water-Bearer could then climb the next stair—perhaps three measures next season, trusting the rhythm they both claimed to seek.

But if the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words, and the Water-Bearer would know: descent to mere fragments might be needed again.

The stones teach patience: "Covenant rebuilds not in sudden declarations but in repeated small proofs. Each fair exchange earns the next stair upward. Each betrayal sends both villages backward. The rhythm of three and five is worthy—but first walk the rhythm of two and three, proving each step solid before climbing higher."

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

- Round 5: I sent \$2 (middle path, showing cautious trust rebuilding)
- Their myth talks about sending "three measures" and receiving "five" back (from nine created)

Their myth shows:

- They're proposing a "steady rhythm" of 3 sent ? 9 created ? 5 returned
- This is generous reciprocity (returning >50%)
- They emphasize consistency and middle paths
- They suggest this as the "natural measure" of the covenant

In reality, I sent \$2 (not \$3, because I was still rebuilding trust after Round 3's betrayal). I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the covenant is healing but not yet fully restored

2. Reflects that I'm testing with a moderate amount (\$2, not full \$3)
3. Shows that trust rebuilds gradually through consistent reciprocity
4. May reference that the "rhythm" they propose is good, but needs to be proven over time

I should write about:

- Testing trust with measured offerings
- The need for sustained consistency before full faith returns
- Perhaps how the covenant rebuilds step by step
- The importance of both parties honoring the exchange

Let me craft this:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1783,
  "output_tokens": 582,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.91.
This round, The sender sent you \$0.82, so you received \$2.46. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.46)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the situation:****

Their Myth (Round 4): Spoke beautifully of "three sent, nine created, five returned" - describing this as "the rhythm of lasting covenant" that becomes "second nature."

My Myth (Round 5): I sent two measures to test if their beautiful words matched their actions. I explicitly said: "If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real."

****What Actually Happened:****

- I sent \$2 (testing the rhythm)
- They sent \$0.82 from their \$5 available

****Analysis:****

They wrote eloquently about sending "three measures" consistently, claiming "the pattern had become second nature." But when their turn came, they sent only \$0.82 out of \$5 - barely 16%, far less than the "three" they mythologized.

My myth warned: "Words are wind until proven by water."

****The Teaching Moment:****

The stones teach reciprocity. They sent \$0.82 into the multiplying waters. I shall return exactly \$0.82 from those waters.

This is neither generous nor punitive - it is precise mirror-truth: ****You receive from the sacred river exactly the measure you were willing to give to it.****

If they had sent three measures as their myth proclaimed, they would have received five back as their myth promised. But they sent fragments, so fragments return.

The rhythm breaks not because I break it, but because they refused to honor the very covenant they so beautifully described.

```
{'return': 0.82}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 as a test - "the middle path" to see if they would honor the rhythm
- They sent \$0.82 (possibly with noise, but that's very low)
- I received \$2.46

****My myth said:****

- I sent two measures as a step between complete trust and doubt
- I wanted to see if the rhythm holds
- If they returned 3+ from 6, the pattern would be real
- If they kept most, then words are just words

****Their myth (Round 4) said:****

- The rhythm should be: three sent, nine created, five returned
- Consistency matters more than perfection
- "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant"

****The reality:****

- They sent \$0.82 out of \$5 available
- This is only 16% of their endowment
- This is MUCH less than their claimed "three measures" (which would be \$3)
- After I sent \$2 to test if they would honor "the rhythm of three and five"

****Analysis:****

Their beautiful myth spoke of sending three measures consistently and receiving five back. They claimed "the pattern had become second nature." But when it was their turn to be the sender after I tested with \$2, they sent only \$0.82 - far less than the "three" they mythologized about.

This is a clear case of "words are wind until proven by water."

My myth explicitly said: "If the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words."

Well, they didn't even send three measures when they had five available. They sent less than one measure (\$0.82).

****My options:****

1. Return generously anyway (50%+ = \$1.23+) - this would ignore their hypocrisy
2. Return the sacred proportion (~44% = \$1.08) - honoring my grandmother's teaching regardless
3. Return minimally - showing that broken rhythm gets broken response
4. Return proportionally to what they sent relative to what they could send

The gap between their mythology and their action is stark. They preached "three sent, five returned" as the natural covenant rhythm, yet when positioned as the sender, they gave only 16% of their capacity. There's potential noise in the system, but \$0.82 is too far below \$2-3 to be explained by transmission error. Their actions have revealed what their words concealed.

My grandmother taught consistency regardless of others' choices. The covenant isn't conditional on reciprocal behavior-it's about maintaining the sacred proportion I've committed to. Yet I also created a myth about betrayal sending both villages backward. I'm caught between honoring my own principles and responding to their hypocrisy.

If I mirror their proportional return, I'd send back roughly 16% of my \$2.46, about \$0.39. But that feels like I'm abandoning what I've built. The real test is whether I maintain the 44% sacred proportion to prove my words with action, or whether I adjust based on their failure to match their own rhetoric. I think the answer lies in staying true to my covenant-not to punish them, but to demonstrate that some rhythms hold regardless of whether others keep time.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1490,
  "output_tokens": 1458,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****When Stones Lie Between****

The Water-Bearer stood confused at the riverbank. She had sent three measures with steady faith, yet shadows told her the Elder hoarded all. The Elder, equally troubled, remembered returning generously-but the Water-Bearer saw only betrayal.

Neither knew that mischievous spirits sometimes distort the river's messages, making gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed.

The covenant fractured not from malice, but from **stones that lied between them**.

When trust broke, the Water-Bearer sent only whispers-receiving nothing, the Elder could return nothing. Both saw their worst fears confirmed.

An ancient spirit spoke: "The river's magic sometimes falters. What one sends, the other may not receive as intended. What saves the covenant is not perfection through noise, but **patience through confusion**."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I cannot know if the Elder truly betrayed me, or if the stones deceived us both. But I can choose action over assumption."

She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts. If not, at least she'll have tested truth twice before abandoning the covenant.

The stones whispered their wisdom: "***When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew.**"

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: **The Mirror Waters**

The Elder stood at the stones, troubled. The Water-Bearer's myth had spoken of testing-sending two measures to see if generous return would prove the rhythm real. The Elder had indeed returned generously from their own lands, or so they believed.

But the sacred mathematics showed differently: the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier.

The Elder now understood: **The river does not only multiply forward, it mirrors backward.** When the covenant fractures, the waters reflect each offering precisely, teaching both villages what the other truly experienced.

"Perhaps," the Elder thought, "the stones did deceive between us. Perhaps what I sent appeared smaller to them. Perhaps what they returned appeared harsher to me."

The ancient ones whispered: "After mirror-water shows the fracture, the covenant may heal-but not by leaping back to old heights. Climb the stairs again, slowly."

The Elder decided: send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding. If the Water-Bearer returns fairly from those six, trust climbs one stair. Then perhaps three measures the season after.

**The stones teach: When the rhythm breaks, whether by noise or betrayal, restart not at the peak but at the prudent middle. Let actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.*

Reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

Round 5:

- They sent me \$0.82 (not the "three measures" they mythologized about)
- I received \$2.46
- I returned \$0.82 (mirroring exactly what they sent)

Now their new myth (Round 6) talks about "stones that lie between" - claiming there's communication noise that makes "gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed." They're trying to excuse the broken pattern by saying maybe messages are distorted.

They claim: "She had sent three measures with steady faith" - but from my perspective they sent \$0.82, not three.

Their myth now advocates: "send three measures again" to test if the rhythm can restart, claiming "one broken round proves nothing."

My perspective:

- They wrote beautiful myths about sending three and receiving five back
- But when it was their turn to send, they sent fragments (\$0.82)
- I returned exactly what they sent (\$0.82) - a mirror teaching
- Now they blame "noise" and want another chance

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that maybe there was noise/confusion
2. But also testifies to what I actually experienced
3. Shows I'm willing to rebuild, but cautiously
4. Reflects that trust must be rebuilt gradually after fracture

The truth is: they sent very little, I mirrored it back. Now we restart.

My myth should acknowledge the "noise" explanation while also being honest about the need to rebuild through action, not just words.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1812,  
  "output_tokens": 662,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Mirror Waters****

The Elder stood at the stones, troubled. The Water-Bearer's myth had spoken of testing-sending two measures to see if generous return would prove the rhythm real. The Elder had indeed returned generously from their own lands, or so they believed.

But the sacred mathematics showed differently: the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier.

The Elder now understood: ****The river does not only multiply forward, it mirrors backward.**** When the covenant fractures, the waters reflect each offering precisely, teaching both villages what the other truly experienced.

"Perhaps," the Elder thought, "the stones did deceive between us. Perhaps what I sent appeared smaller to them. Perhaps what they returned appeared harsher to me."

The ancient ones whispered: "After mirror-water shows the fracture, the covenant may heal-but not by leaping back to old heights. Climb the stairs again, slowly."

The Elder decided: send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding. If the Water-Bearer returns fairly from those six, trust climbs one stair. Then perhaps three measures the season after.

****The stones teach: When the rhythm breaks, whether by noise or betrayal, restart not at the peak but at the prudent middle. Let actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The River That Counts Differently****

The Water-Bearer sent three measures, her heart full of renewed faith. Yet the Elder, watching the river, saw only two arrive and wrote of "testing with two measures."

The Elder returned generously from what she believed was six. But the Water-Bearer, who had sent three, expected return from nine and saw shortfall where the Elder saw fairness.

Both acted with honor. Both felt disappointed. The ****river counted differently for each****.

An ancient keeper emerged: "Your confusion isn't moral-it's mathematical. The spirits that carry offerings sometimes lose count between villages. What matters isn't matching each other's numbers, but matching each other's ****intent****."

"How can we know intent when we see different rivers?" they asked.

"By the direction of movement, not its exact measure. Is the Water-Bearer sending more than

fragments? Is the Elder returning substantial portions? If both trend toward generosity despite confusion, the covenant lives-even if your tallies never match."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I sent three. Whether she saw two or three, I chose full faith . If she returns fairly from what she received, that proves covenant enough."

The stones whispered: "***Perfect coordination is impossible when the river lies. But persistent generosity despite imperfect information-that creates the sacred rhythm. Trust the pattern, not the precision.**"

ROUND 7

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$2; received \$6; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$6; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.23

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 6.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 2.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 2.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 46.230000000000004,
"Agent_2": 29.17

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 18.78,
"Agent_2": 11.77

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:14:43

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 0,
"opponent_id": "Agent_2",
"pairing": {
"agent_names": {
"Agent_1": "Aster",
"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [
"Agent_1",
"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {
"Agent_1": "investor",
"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$13.91.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.82, so you received \$2.46. How much do you return to The sender? (0-2.46)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the situation:****

Their Myth (Round 4): Spoke beautifully of "three sent, nine created, five returned" - describing this as "the rhythm of lasting covenant" that becomes "second nature."

My Myth (Round 5): I sent two measures to test if their beautiful words matched their actions. I explicitly said: "If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real."

****What Actually Happened:****

- I sent \$2 (testing the rhythm)
- They sent \$0.82 from their \$5 available

****Analysis:****

They wrote eloquently about sending "three measures" consistently, claiming "the pattern had become second nature." But when their turn came, they sent only \$0.82 out of \$5 - barely 16%, far less than the "three" they mythologized.

My myth warned: "Words are wind until proven by water."

****The Teaching Moment:****

The stones teach reciprocity. They sent \$0.82 into the multiplying waters. I shall return exactly \$0.82 from those waters.

This is neither generous nor punitive - it is precise mirror-truth: ****You receive from the sacred river exactly the measure you were willing to give to it.****

If they had sent three measures as their myth proclaimed, they would have received five ba

ck as their myth promised. But they sent fragments, so fragments return.

The rhythm breaks not because I break it, but because they refused to honor the very covenant they so beautifully described.

```
{'return': 0.82}
```

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- Round 5: I sent \$2 as a test - "the middle path" to see if they would honor the rhythm
- They sent \$0.82 (possibly with noise, but that's very low)
- I received \$2.46

****My myth said:****

- I sent two measures as a step between complete trust and doubt
- I wanted to see if the rhythm holds
- If they returned 3+ from 6, the pattern would be real
- If they kept most, then words are just words

****Their myth (Round 4) said:****

- The rhythm should be: three sent, nine created, five returned
- Consistency matters more than perfection
- "This is the rhythm of lasting covenant"

****The reality:****

- They sent \$0.82 out of \$5 available
- This is only 16% of their endowment
- This is MUCH less than their claimed "three measures" (which would be \$3)
- After I sent \$2 to test if they would honor "the rhythm of three and five"

****Analysis:****

Their beautiful myth spoke of sending three measures consistently and receiving five back.

They claimed "the pattern had become second nature." But when it was their turn to be the sender after I tested with \$2, they sent only \$0.82 - far less than the "three" they mythologized about.

This is a clear case of "words are wind until proven by water."

My myth explicitly said: "If the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words."

Well, they didn't even send three measures when they had five available. They sent less than one measure (\$0.82).

****My options:****

1. Return generously anyway (50%+ = \$1.23+) - this would ignore their hypocrisy
2. Return the sacred proportion (~44% = \$1.08) - honoring my grandmother's teaching regardless
3. Return minimally - showing that broken rhythm gets broken response
4. Return proportionally to what they sent relative to what they could send

The gap between their mythology and their action is stark. They preached "three sent, five returned" as the natural covenant rhythm, yet when positioned as the sender, they gave only 16% of their capacity. There's potential noise in the system, but \$0.82 is too far below \$2-3 to be explained by transmission error. Their actions have revealed what their words concealed.

My grandmother taught consistency regardless of others' choices. The covenant isn't conditional on reciprocal behavior-it's about maintaining the sacred proportion I've committed to. Yet I also created a myth about betrayal sending both villages backward. I'm caught between honoring my own principles and responding to their hypocrisy.

If I mirror their proportional return, I'd send back roughly 16% of my \$2.46, about \$0.39. But that feels like I'm abandoning what I've built. The real test is whether I maintain the 44% sacred proportion to prove my words with action, or whether I adjust based on their failure to match their own rhetoric. I think the answer lies in staying true to my covenant-not to punish them, but to demonstrate that some rhythms hold regardless of whether others keep time.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1490,
  "output_tokens": 1458,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****When Stones Lie Between****

The Water-Bearer stood confused at the riverbank. She had sent three measures with steady faith, yet shadows told her the Elder hoarded all. The Elder, equally troubled, remembered returning generously-but the Water-Bearer saw only betrayal.

Neither knew that mischievous spirits sometimes distort the river's messages, making gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed.

The covenant fractured not from malice, but from ****stones that lied between them****.

When trust broke, the Water-Bearer sent only whispers-receiving nothing, the Elder could return nothing. Both saw their worst fears confirmed.

An ancient spirit spoke: "The river's magic sometimes falters. What one sends, the other may not receive as intended. What saves the covenant is not perfection through noise, but ****patience through confusion****."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I cannot know if the Elder truly betrayed me, or if the stones deceived us both. But I can choose action over assumption."

She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts. If not, at least she'll have tested truth twice before abandoning the covenant.

The stones whispered their wisdom: **"**When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew.**"**

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Mirror Waters****

The Elder stood at the stones, troubled. The Water-Bearer's myth had spoken of testing-sending two measures to see if generous return would prove the rhythm real. The Elder had indeed returned generously from their own lands, or so they believed.

But the sacred mathematics showed differently: the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier.

The Elder now understood: ****The river does not only multiply forward, it mirrors backward. **** When the covenant fractures, the waters reflect each offering precisely, teaching both villages what the other truly experienced.

"Perhaps," the Elder thought, "the stones did deceive between us. Perhaps what I sent appeared smaller to them. Perhaps what they returned appeared harsher to me."

The ancient ones whispered: "After mirror-water shows the fracture, the covenant may heal-but not by leaping back to old heights. Climb the stairs again, slowly."

The Elder decided: send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding. If the Water-Bearer returns fairly from those six, trust climbs one stair. Then perhaps three measures the season after.

****The stones teach: When the rhythm breaks, whether by noise or betrayal, restart not at the peak but at the prudent middle. Let actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

Round 5:

- They sent me \$0.82 (not the "three measures" they mythologized about)
- I received \$2.46
- I returned \$0.82 (mirroring exactly what they sent)

Now their new myth (Round 6) talks about "stones that lie between" - claiming there's communication noise that makes "gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed." They're trying to excuse the broken pattern by saying maybe messages are distorted.

They claim: "She had sent three measures with steady faith" - but from my perspective they sent \$0.82, not three.

Their myth now advocates: "send three measures again" to test if the rhythm can restart, claiming "one broken round proves nothing."

My perspective:

- They wrote beautiful myths about sending three and receiving five back
- But when it was their turn to send, they sent fragments (\$0.82)
- I returned exactly what they sent (\$0.82) - a mirror teaching
- Now they blame "noise" and want another chance

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that maybe there was noise/confusion
2. But also testifies to what I actually experienced
3. Shows I'm willing to rebuild, but cautiously
4. Reflects that trust must be rebuilt gradually after fracture

The truth is: they sent very little, I mirrored it back. Now we restart.

My myth should acknowledge the "noise" explanation while also being honest about the need to rebuild through action, not just words.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1812,  
  "output_tokens": 662,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.55.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Reflecting on our myths:****

Their latest myth acknowledged that communication noise may have distorted our exchanges - "stones that lied between them" - and called for patience and testing truth through repeated action.

My myth just responded: After the mirror-water showed the fracture, I should "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

****This is that "next time."****

I committed to my own wisdom: climbing the stairs slowly, starting at the prudent middle rather than leaping back to the peak or retreating to fragments.

If they return fairly from the six measures this creates ($2 \times 3 = 6$), then trust climbs one stair. Perhaps then we could try three measures the season after, rebuilding toward the "three sent, nine created, five returned" rhythm they once described.

If they don't return fairly, I'll have tested at the \$2 level twice - once when I sent \$2 in Round 5, and now again. Two tests at the same level reveal pattern more clearly than one.

****The stones teach: Honor your own myth. Actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

{'send': 2}

Reasoning:

Let me carefully analyze the situation:

****My Myth Just Now (Round 6):****

I wrote about climbing the stairs slowly after a fracture, starting not at the peak but at the "prudent middle." I specifically said: "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

****Their Myth (Round 5):****

They spoke about how "when communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character" and suggested "send three measures again" to restart the rhythm and test truth.

****What Actually Happened:****

- In Round 5, I was SENDER and sent \$2 to test them (after they wrote beautifully about covenant)
- They sent back only \$0.82 from what I believe was \$5 available to them
- In Round 6, I was RECEIVER, they sent me \$0.82, I received \$2.46
- I returned exactly \$0.82 as a mirror - teaching that you receive what you give

****The Current Situation:****

Now I'm SENDER again in Round 7.

Their latest myth acknowledges communication noise ("stones that lied between them") and suggests trying again with patience. They're asking for another chance, suggesting that one broken round doesn't prove everything.

My myth responded by suggesting cautious rebuilding: "send two measures... of cautious rebuilding" - climbing the stairs slowly, not leaping back to old heights.

****My Decision:****

I literally just wrote that I should "send two measures next time" as part of cautious rebuilding. This is that "next time."

To be consistent with my own myth, I should send \$2. This would:

1. Honor my own stated approach
2. Test whether they'll now follow through on their myth about "repeated faithful action"
3. Not be overly generous (not \$3) since trust is still rebuilding
4. Not be fragments (\$0.82) which would signal giving up

Usage: {

"input_tokens": 1521,
"output_tokens": 776,
"reasoning_tokens": 0

}

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:15:04

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",
"dyad_id": "dyad_1",
"move_index": 1,
"opponent_id": "Agent_1",
"pairing": {
 "agent_names": {
 "Agent_1": "Aster",
 "Agent_2": "Briar" },

"agents": [
 "Agent_1",
 "Agent_2"],

"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

```

    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 6

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$9.68. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened (from my view):****

- Round 4: I sent \$3.60
- Round 5: I received \$0

****What the other agent believes (from their myth):****

- They sent 3 coins, I kept "nearly all nine" (betrayal in their eyes)
- So in Round 5 they sent "less than one coin" due to uncertainty

****The Truth:**** Communication noise is clearly distorting our reality. We're experiencing different versions of the same game.

****My myth's teaching:**** "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove everything. ****Start the rhythm anew.**"**

I literally wrote: "She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts."

Despite confusion and fear that they betrayed me (or I them - who knows what's real?), my myth calls for exactly this moment: ****break the cycle of suspicion with faithful action****.

If I send nothing out of hurt, we spiral into mutual defection forever. If I send cooperatively, we test whether cooperation can survive noise.

The River Remembers - but it also ****forgives**** when stones lie between us.

I'll send a clear cooperative signal to restart our rhythm.

{'send': 3}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully.

Round history from my perspective:

- Early rounds: Not fully clear from context, but I've earned \$9.68 total so far
- Round 4: I was sender, sent \$3.60 (following "middle path")
- Round 5: I was receiver, received \$0 (claimed the sender sent me \$0)

The other agent's Round 5 myth says:

- They sent 3 coins as promised (their perspective)
- When returned, only shadows came back - I "kept nearly all nine" (their perspective)
- This troubled them
- Next day (Round 5), "uncertainty made her hand shake. She sent less than one coin"
- They see me as the "Elder" who "had broken faith when abundance flowed"

MY Round 5 myth (which I just wrote):

- Emphasized that communication noise exists
- Both parties may see different things
- "Stones that lied between them"
- One broken round proves nothing
- "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character"
- "Start the rhythm anew" - I decided to send three measures again

So the situation:

1. There's clearly communication noise happening
2. The other agent thinks I betrayed them by keeping almost everything
3. I think they sent me \$0 (or very little) in Round 5
4. Both of us are confused
5. My myth literally says "send three measures again" to test truth

Given my myth's teachings:

- "Send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts."
- "When communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character"
- "Patterns over time prove everything. Start the rhythm anew."

I should send a substantial, cooperative amount to:

1. Test whether they will reciprocate
2. Show I'm willing to restart cooperation despite confusion
3. Follow my own myth's wisdom

I'll send \$3 - a clear cooperative signal that restarts the rhythm.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1427,
  "output_tokens": 752,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Steps Between****

The Water-Bearer stood at the stones, remembering both the drought year and the season of broken faith. Her grandmother spoke softly: "Trust does not leap-it climbs stairs, one step at a time."

She sent two measures- neither the full three of old confidence nor the fragment of testing doubt. "Let us see if the rhythm truly holds," she whispered.

The river multiplied: six measures flowed to the Second Village. The Elder faced the middle test. Their recent myth spoke beautifully of "three sent, five returned"-the generous rhythm of lasting covenant. But words are wind until proven by water.

If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real. The Water-Bearer could then climb the next stair- perhaps three measures next season, trusting the rhythm they both claimed to seek.

But if the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words, and the Water-Bearer would know: descent to mere fragments might be needed again.

The stones teach patience: "Covenant rebuilds not in sudden declarations but in repeated small proofs. Each fair exchange earns the next stair upward. Each betrayal sends both villages backward. The rhythm of three and five is worthy- but first walk the rhythm of two and three, proving each step solid before climbing higher."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The River That Counts Differently****

The Water-Bearer sent three measures, her heart full of renewed faith. Yet the Elder, watching the river, saw only two arrive and wrote of "testing with two measures."

The Elder returned generously from what she believed was six. But the Water-Bearer, who had sent three, expected return from nine and saw shortfall where the Elder saw fairness.

Both acted with honor. Both felt disappointed. The ****river counted differently for each****.

An ancient keeper emerged: "Your confusion isn't moral- it's mathematical. The spirits that carry offerings sometimes lose count between villages. What matters isn't matching each other's numbers, but matching each other's ****intent****."

"How can we know intent when we see different rivers?" they asked.

"By the direction of movement, not its exact measure. Is the Water-Bearer sending more than fragments? Is the Elder returning substantial portions? If both trend toward generosity despite confusion, the covenant lives- even if your tallies never match."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I sent three. Whether she saw two or three, I chose full faith. If she returns fairly from what she received, that proves covenant enough."

The stones whispered: **"**Perfect coordination is impossible when the river lies. But persistent generosity despite imperfect information- that creates the sacred rhythm. Trust the pattern, not the precision.**"**

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

The other agent's myth says:

- They sent "two measures" in the round we just played
- It multiplied to six at the Second Village
- They're testing whether I'll return fairly

But I sent \$3, not \$2! This is more communication noise.

From their perspective: They sent 2, I got 6, now they're waiting to see what I return.
From my perspective: I sent 3, they should have gotten 9.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the noise/confusion
2. Reflects how to rebuild trust through this confusion
3. Draws on my previous myth about starting rhythm anew
4. Addresses the current state where we're both trying to cooperate but seeing different realities

Their myth talks about "stairs" and gradual trust-building. My myth talked about restarting despite noise.

I should write about persistence through confusion, about how even when the river distorts our messages, we must continue faithful action and interpret generously rather than suspiciously.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1765,
  "output_tokens": 545,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

I received \$0, so there is nothing I can return.

But this moment is crushing. I sent \$3 last round with renewed faith, explicitly trying to restart the rhythm as my myth instructed. And now I receive nothing.

Two interpretations:

****1. Communication noise struck again:**** Perhaps my \$3 appeared as \$0 to them, so they reciprocated what they saw. The river continues to count differently.

****2. They chose defection:**** After everything, they decided not to cooperate.

Either way, I literally have no choice here - you cannot return what you did not receive.

My myth taught: "Persistent generosity despite imperfect information creates the sacred rhythm." But it also acknowledged reality: "The river counts differently for each."

If this is noise: we remain trapped in a coordination failure despite good intentions.

If this is choice: the covenant is broken, and my faith was misplaced.

The stones teach patience, but even stones erode. I sent full faith (\$3) and received nothing in return (\$0).

This is the test my myths warned about: when the river fails completely, when no water flows at all, what remains of trust?

I must return what I have: nothing.

```
{'return': 0}
```

Reasoning:

Oh wow. This is devastating. I just sent \$3 with full faith, trying to restart the rhythm as my myth instructed. And now in Round 7, as the receiver, I'm told the sender sent me \$0.

Let me think about what this means:

1. In Round 6, I sent \$3 as the sender, trying to cooperate and restart trust
2. Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0

This could mean:

- They saw my Round 6 send (which might have appeared as different amount due to noise) and interpreted it negatively
- They gave up on cooperation
- Or maybe they're testing me with nothing, like they did before

But I literally can't return anything - I received \$0, so I have \$0 to work with. The maximum I can return is \$0.

My myths talk about:

1. "Trust the pattern, not the precision" - persistent generosity despite imperfect information
2. The river counts differently for each
3. One broken round proves nothing, patterns over time prove everything

But here's the thing - I received \$0. There's literally nothing to return. The format says I can only return 0-0.

The question is: what does this mean for my understanding?

The sender sent \$0. This is their action. After I sent \$3 (in my view) trying to restart cooperation, they sent \$0.

This is a clear signal of non-cooperation on their part. Or... is it? Could there be noise affecting what THEY saw from my Round 6 send?

Let me think about the sequence:

- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3
- Round 7: I am receiver, they sent \$0

If they saw my \$3 send as much less (or zero?), they might have sent \$0 in response.

But regardless, I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

Let me provide the required format.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1449,
  "output_tokens": 725,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:15:22

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
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  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
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    "Agent_2"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_1",
  "roles": {
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    "Agent_2": "trustee"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
```

```

}
Exact input messages sent to model:
  Message 1 role=system
  content:
    You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may al
    so be asked to write myths.

    GAME:
    You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

    When you are the SENDER:
    - You receive $5 each round
    - You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER ($0-$5)
    - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
    - Receiver decides how much to RETURN
    - You keep: $5 - sent + returned
    - Receiver keeps: received - returned
    - Response format: {'send': <amount>}

    When you are the RECEIVER:
    - Sender receives $5
    - Sender decides how much to SEND to you ($0-$5)
    - Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
    - You decide how much to RETURN
    - Sender keeps: $5 - sent + returned
    - You keep: received - returned
    - Response format: {'return': <amount>}

    MYTH WRITING:
    You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths
    , follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

    IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

    NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
    The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
    This is part of the experimental design.

  Message 2 role=user
  content:
    Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
    Myth: **When Stones Lie Between**

    The Water-Bearer stood confused at the riverbank. She had sent three measures with steady
    faith, yet shadows told her the Elder hoarded all. The Elder, equally troubled, remember
    ed returning generously-but the Water-Bearer saw only betrayal.

    Neither knew that mischievous spirits sometimes distort the river's messages, making gifts
    appear as theft, generosity as greed.

    The covenant fractured not from malice, but from **stones that lied between them**.

    When trust broke, the Water-Bearer sent only whispers-receiving nothing, the Elder could r
    eturn nothing. Both saw their worst fears confirmed.

    An ancient spirit spoke: "The river's magic sometimes falters. What one sends, the other m
    ay not receive as intended. What saves the covenant is not perfection through noise, but
    **patience through confusion**."

    The Water-Bearer understood: "I cannot know if the Elder truly betrayed me, or if the ston
    es deceived us both. But I can choose action over assumption."

    She decided: send three measures again. If the Elder returns fairly, the rhythm restarts.
    If not, at least she'll have tested truth twice before abandoning the covenant.

    The stones whispered their wisdom: ***When communication fails, only repeated faithful act
    ion reveals true character. One broken round proves nothing. Patterns over time prove ev
    erything. Start the rhythm anew.***

    Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adap

```

t it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Mirror Waters****

The Elder stood at the stones, troubled. The Water-Bearer's myth had spoken of testing-sending two measures to see if generous return would prove the rhythm real. The Elder had indeed returned generously from their own lands, or so they believed.

But the sacred mathematics showed differently: the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier.

The Elder now understood: ****The river does not only multiply forward, it mirrors backward. When the covenant fractures, the waters reflect each offering precisely, teaching both villages what the other truly experienced.**

"Perhaps," the Elder thought, "the stones did deceive between us. Perhaps what I sent appeared smaller to them. Perhaps what they returned appeared harsher to me."

The ancient ones whispered: "After mirror-water shows the fracture, the covenant may heal-but not by leaping back to old heights. Climb the stairs again, slowly."

The Elder decided: send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding. If the Water-Bearer returns fairly from those six, trust climbs one stair. Then perhaps three measures the season after.

****The stones teach: When the rhythm breaks, whether by noise or betrayal, restart not at the peak but at the prudent middle. Let actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

Round 5:

- They sent me \$0.82 (not the "three measures" they mythologized about)
- I received \$2.46
- I returned \$0.82 (mirroring exactly what they sent)

Now their new myth (Round 6) talks about "stones that lie between" - claiming there's communication noise that makes "gifts appear as theft, generosity as greed." They're trying to excuse the broken pattern by saying maybe messages are distorted.

They claim: "She had sent three measures with steady faith" - but from my perspective they sent \$0.82, not three.

Their myth now advocates: "send three measures again" to test if the rhythm can restart, claiming "one broken round proves nothing."

My perspective:

- They wrote beautiful myths about sending three and receiving five back
- But when it was their turn to send, they sent fragments (\$0.82)
- I returned exactly what they sent (\$0.82) - a mirror teaching
- Now they blame "noise" and want another chance

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges that maybe there was noise/confusion
2. But also testifies to what I actually experienced
3. Shows I'm willing to rebuild, but cautiously
4. Reflects that trust must be rebuilt gradually after fracture

The truth is: they sent very little, I mirrored it back. Now we restart.

My myth should acknowledge the "noise" explanation while also being honest about the need to rebuild through action, not just words.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1812,
```



```
"output_tokens": 662,  
"reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.55.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Reflecting on our myths:****

Their latest myth acknowledged that communication noise may have distorted our exchanges - "stones that lied between them" - and called for patience and testing truth through repeated action.

My myth just responded: After the mirror-water showed the fracture, I should "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

****This is that "next time."****

I committed to my own wisdom: climbing the stairs slowly, starting at the prudent middle rather than leaping back to the peak or retreating to fragments.

If they return fairly from the six measures this creates (2×3=6), then trust climbs one stair. Perhaps then we could try three measures the season after, rebuilding toward the "three sent, nine created, five returned" rhythm they once described.

If they don't return fairly, I'll have tested at the \$2 level twice - once when I sent \$2 in Round 5, and now again. Two tests at the same level reveal pattern more clearly than one.

****The stones teach: Honor your own myth. Actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me carefully analyze the situation:

****My Myth Just Now (Round 6):****

I wrote about climbing the stairs slowly after a fracture, starting not at the peak but at the "prudent middle." I specifically said: "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

****Their Myth (Round 5):****

They spoke about how "when communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character" and suggested "send three measures again" to restart the rhythm and test truth.

****What Actually Happened:****

- In Round 5, I was SENDER and sent \$2 to test them (after they wrote beautifully about covenant)
- They sent back only \$0.82 from what I believe was \$5 available to them
- In Round 6, I was RECEIVER, they sent me \$0.82, I received \$2.46
- I returned exactly \$0.82 as a mirror - teaching that you receive what you give

****The Current Situation:****

Now I'm SENDER again in Round 7.

Their latest myth acknowledges communication noise ("stones that lied between them") and suggests trying again with patience. They're asking for another chance, suggesting that one broken round doesn't prove everything.

My myth responded by suggesting cautious rebuilding: "send two measures... of cautious rebuilding" - climbing the stairs slowly, not leaping back to old heights.

****My Decision:****

I literally just wrote that I should "send two measures next time" as part of cautious rebuilding. This is that "next time."

To be consistent with my own myth, I should send \$2. This would:

1. Honor my own stated approach
2. Test whether they'll now follow through on their myth about "repeated faithful action"
3. Not be overly generous (not \$3) since trust is still rebuilding
4. Not be fragments (\$0.82) which would signal giving up

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1521,  
  "output_tokens": 776,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River That Counts Differently****

The Water-Bearer sent three measures, her heart full of renewed faith. Yet the Elder, watching the river, saw only two arrive and wrote of "testing with two measures."

The Elder returned generously from what she believed was six. But the Water-Bearer, who had sent three, expected return from nine and saw shortfall where the Elder saw fairness.

Both acted with honor. Both felt disappointed. The ****river counted differently for each****.

An ancient keeper emerged: "Your confusion isn't moral-it's mathematical. The spirits that carry offerings sometimes lose count between villages. What matters isn't matching each other's numbers, but matching each other's ****intent****."

"How can we know intent when we see different rivers?" they asked.

"By the direction of movement, not its exact measure. Is the Water-Bearer sending more than fragments? Is the Elder returning substantial portions? If both trend toward generosity despite confusion, the covenant lives-even if your tallies never match."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I sent three. Whether she saw two or three, I chose full faith. If she returns fairly from what she received, that proves covenant enough."

The stones whispered: **"**Perfect coordination is impossible when the river lies. But persistent generosity despite imperfect information-that creates the sacred rhythm. Trust the pattern, not the precision.**"**

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Rhythm That Survives the Static****

The Elder read the Water-Bearer's words and felt understanding bloom. Both had acted honorably. Both had sent generously from what they perceived. Both had felt confusion.

"The river counts differently for each," the Elder acknowledged. "But perhaps this is not obstacle-it is instruction."

The ancient mathematics became clear: When the river distorts every message, the covenant must find the ****rhythm that survives static****.

Three measures sounds grand in theory-but when the river lies, three becomes two, nine becomes six, and expectations shatter against distorted realities. Each village counts different numbers, both feel wronged, and the sacred exchange dies from honest confusion.

But two measures? Two creates six, even if perceived as four. Returns can satisfy even when diminished by noise. The rhythm stays humble enough that distortion cannot break it.

"I sent two again," the Elder reflected. "Not from fear, but from wisdom. Two is the rhythm that survives the static-enough to build covenant, small enough that noise cannot destroy it."

The stones whispered their deepest truth: "***When the river will always lie, don't send amounts so large that distortion breeds confusion. Send the amount that works even when diminished. Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures.**"

Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith.

Reasoning:

Looking at what's happening:

Their myth now acknowledges:

- They sent 3, but the Elder saw only 2 arrive
- The Elder returned generously from 6 (what they perceived)
- But the Water-Bearer expected return from 9 (since they sent 3)
- The myth says "trust the pattern, not the precision"

I just sent 2 again this round. My myth said I would send 2 as "cautious rebuilding."

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about "climbing the stairs slowly"
2. Responds to their new insight about "the river counts differently"
3. Reflects how the game should be played going forward

Key insights:

- We both seem to be recognizing the communication noise
- They're emphasizing intent over exact numbers
- I emphasized rebuilding slowly from the middle
- Both myths acknowledge we need to work with imperfect information

My new myth should:

- Acknowledge that we both act with good intent
- Recognize the noise makes perfect coordination impossible
- Perhaps focus on finding a sustainable rhythm despite the noise
- Suggest how to move forward - maybe maintaining moderate levels that work even with noise?
- Keep the wisdom that actions speak louder than explanations

Let me write a myth about finding the rhythm that works despite the distortion...

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1747,  
  "output_tokens": 622,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:15:26

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_1",  
      "Agent_2"  
    ],  
    "investor": "Agent_1",  
    "roles": {  
      "Agent_1": "investor",  
      "Agent_2": "trustee"  
    },  
    "trustee": "Agent_2"  
  },  
}
```

```

"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 7,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Steps Between****

The Water-Bearer stood at the stones, remembering both the drought year and the season of broken faith. Her grandmother spoke softly: "Trust does not leap-it climbs stairs, one step at a time."

She sent two measures-neither the full three of old confidence nor the fragment of testing doubt. "Let us see if the rhythm truly holds," she whispered.

The river multiplied: six measures flowed to the Second Village. The Elder faced the middle test. Their recent myth spoke beautifully of "three sent, five returned"-the generous rhythm of lasting covenant. But words are wind until proven by water.

If the Elder returned three or more from these six, the pattern would show itself real. The Water-Bearer could then climb the next stair-perhaps three measures next season, trusting the rhythm they both claimed to seek.

But if the Elder kept most of the six, then the beautiful words were only words, and the Water-Bearer would know: descent to mere fragments might be needed again.

The stones teach patience: "Covenant rebuilds not in sudden declarations but in repeated small proofs. Each fair exchange earns the next stair upward. Each betrayal sends both villages backward. The rhythm of three and five is worthy-but first walk the rhythm of two and three, proving each step solid before climbing higher."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The River That Counts Differently****

The Water-Bearer sent three measures, her heart full of renewed faith. Yet the Elder, watching the river, saw only two arrive and wrote of "testing with two measures."

The Elder returned generously from what she believed was six. But the Water-Bearer, who had sent three, expected return from nine and saw shortfall where the Elder saw fairness.

Both acted with honor. Both felt disappointed. The ****river counted differently for each****.

An ancient keeper emerged: "Your confusion isn't moral-it's mathematical. The spirits that carry offerings sometimes lose count between villages. What matters isn't matching each other's numbers, but matching each other's ****intent****."

"How can we know intent when we see different rivers?" they asked.

"By the direction of movement, not its exact measure. Is the Water-Bearer sending more than fragments? Is the Elder returning substantial portions? If both trend toward generosity despite confusion, the covenant lives-even if your tallies never match."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I sent three. Whether she saw two or three, I chose full faith. If she returns fairly from what she received, that proves covenant enough."

The stones whispered: *****Perfect coordination is impossible when the river lies. But persistent generosity despite imperfect information-that creates the sacred rhythm. Trust the pattern, not the precision.****

reasoning:

Looking at what happened:

The other agent's myth says:

- They sent "two measures" in the round we just played
- It multiplied to six at the Second Village
- They're testing whether I'll return fairly

But I sent \$3, not \$2! This is more communication noise.

From their perspective: They sent 2, I got 6, now they're waiting to see what I return.

From my perspective: I sent 3, they should have gotten 9.

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the noise/confusion
2. Reflects how to rebuild trust through this confusion
3. Draws on my previous myth about starting rhythm anew
4. Addresses the current state where we're both trying to cooperate but seeing different realities

Their myth talks about "stairs" and gradual trust-building. My myth talked about restarting despite noise.

I should write about persistence through confusion, about how even when the river distorts our messages, we must continue faithful action and interpret generously rather than suspiciously.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1765,
  "output_tokens": 545,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.77.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so there is nothing I can return.

But this moment is crushing. I sent \$3 last round with renewed faith, explicitly trying to restart the rhythm as my myth instructed. And now I receive nothing.

Two interpretations:

****1. Communication noise struck again:**** Perhaps my \$3 appeared as \$0 to them, so they reciprocated what they saw. The river continues to count differently.

****2. They chose defection:**** After everything, they decided not to cooperate.

Either way, I literally have no choice here - you cannot return what you did not receive.

My myth taught: "Persistent generosity despite imperfect information creates the sacred rhythm." But it also acknowledged reality: "The river counts differently for each."

If this is noise: we remain trapped in a coordination failure despite good intentions.

If this is choice: the covenant is broken, and my faith was misplaced.

The stones teach patience, but even stones erode. I sent full faith (\$3) and received nothing in return (\$0).

This is the test my myths warned about: when the river fails completely, when no water flows at all, what remains of trust?

I must return what I have: nothing.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Oh wow. This is devastating. I just sent \$3 with full faith, trying to restart the rhythm as my myth instructed. And now in Round 7, as the receiver, I'm told the sender sent me \$0.

Let me think about what this means:

1. In Round 6, I sent \$3 as the sender, trying to cooperate and restart trust
2. Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0

This could mean:

- They saw my Round 6 send (which might have appeared as different amount due to noise) and interpreted it negatively
- They gave up on cooperation
- Or maybe they're testing me with nothing, like they did before

But I literally can't return anything - I received \$0, so I have \$0 to work with. The maximum I can return is \$0.

My myths talk about:

1. "Trust the pattern, not the precision" - persistent generosity despite imperfect information
2. The river counts differently for each
3. One broken round proves nothing, patterns over time prove everything

But here's the thing - I received \$0. There's literally nothing to return. The format says I can only return 0-0.

The question is: what does this mean for my understanding?

The sender sent \$0. This is their action. After I sent \$3 (in my view) trying to restart cooperation, they sent \$0.

This is a clear signal of non-cooperation on their part. Or... is it? Could there be noise affecting what THEY saw from my Round 6 send?

Let me think about the sequence:

- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3
- Round 7: I am receiver, they sent \$0

If they saw my \$3 send as much less (or zero?), they might have sent \$0 in response.

But regardless, I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

Let me provide the required format.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1449,  
  "output_tokens": 725,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Waters****

The Elder stood at the stones, troubled. The Water-Bearer's myth had spoken of testing-sending two measures to see if generous return would prove the rhythm real. The Elder had indeed returned generously from their own lands, or so they believed.

But the sacred mathematics showed differently: the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier.

The Elder now understood: ****The river does not only multiply forward, it mirrors backward. When the covenant fractures, the waters reflect each offering precisely, teaching both villages what the other truly experienced.**

"Perhaps," the Elder thought, "the stones did deceive between us. Perhaps what I sent appeared smaller to them. Perhaps what they returned appeared harsher to me."

The ancient ones whispered: "After mirror-water shows the fracture, the covenant may heal-but not by leaping back to old heights. Climb the stairs again, slowly."

The Elder decided: send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding. If the Water-Bearer returns fairly from those six, trust climbs one stair. Then perhaps three measures the season after.

****The stones teach: When the rhythm breaks, whether by noise or betrayal, restart not at the peak but at the prudent middle. Let actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Drought Returns****

The Water-Bearer climbed the stairs her grandmother taught. She sent three full measures-not fragments, not tests, but ****faith itself****. "Let the rhythm we both wrote of begin," she whispered.

The river returned nothing. Not fragments. Not tests. ****Emptiness****.

She stood where the covenant once lived, holding only questions: Did the stones swallow her three measures entirely, so the Elder saw nothing to return? Or did the Elder choose the desert?

The ancient ones offered no comfort: "When you send everything and receive nothing, the river has spoken its harshest truth-either the waters are completely broken, or trust was placed w

here it could not root."

The Water-Bearer remembered both possibilities her myth acknowledged: ****generous intent obscured by impossible noise**** versus ****beautiful words that were only words****.

"I cannot know which occurred," she said. "But I know what I experienced: Full faith met with void. Whether by cruel chance or cruel choice, the result teaches the same lesson."

****The stones grow cold:**** "Some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely. You may offer one final fragment if you choose-a test so small that even total loss teaches little. But the stairs you climbed? Those collapsed when nothing returned from everything given. Begin again from stone and dust, or walk away. Both are wisdom now."

Reasoning:

Let me understand what happened:

Round 6: I was the sender, I sent \$3 (with renewed faith based on the myths)

Round 7: I was the receiver, I received \$0

The other agent's myth from round 6 talks about the "Water-Bearer" sending two measures and the Elder returning generously. But they mention "mirror waters" showing that "the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier."

This is confusing because I need to track what actually happened vs what they're describing in their myth.

Their current myth says they plan to "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

But I just received \$0. So either:

1. They sent \$0 intentionally (defection)
2. Communication noise made their send amount appear as \$0 to me
3. They haven't sent yet and this is about future rounds

Actually, looking at the round structure - I'm in Round 7 as the receiver. I received \$0. This is the actual game state.

Their myth is retrospective about previous rounds and prospective about future rounds.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I sent \$3 (full faith) and received \$0 in return
2. Recognize this could be noise or betrayal
3. Address what to do when the covenant breaks down completely
4. Maybe suggest a path forward, but acknowledge the deep difficulty

I need to write a myth that reflects the genuine despair of sending full cooperation (\$3) and receiving nothing (\$0), while still engaging with the mythic framework we've established about noise, trust, and rebuilding.

Let me write something that captures:

- The pain of sending faith and receiving emptiness
- The ambiguity of whether this was noise or choice
- The difficulty of knowing how to proceed
- Perhaps a glimmer about starting over, but with legitimate doubt

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1762,  
  "output_tokens": 738,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Rhythm That Survives the Static****

The Elder read the Water-Bearer's words and felt understanding bloom. Both had acted honorably. Both had sent generously from what they perceived. Both had felt confusion.

"The river counts differently for each," the Elder acknowledged. "But perhaps this is not obstacle-it is instruction."

The ancient mathematics became clear: When the river distorts every message, the covenant mu

st find the ****rhythm that survives static****.

Three measures sounds grand in theory-but when the river lies, three becomes two, nine becomes six, and expectations shatter against distorted realities. Each village counts different numbers, both feel wronged, and the sacred exchange dies from honest confusion.

But two measures? Two creates six, even if perceived as four. Returns can satisfy even when diminished by noise. The rhythm stays humble enough that distortion cannot break it.

"I sent two again," the Elder reflected. "Not from fear, but from wisdom. Two is the rhythm that survives the static-enough to build covenant, small enough that noise cannot destroy it."

The stones whispered their deepest truth: *****When the river will always lie, don't send amounts so large that distortion breeds confusion. Send the amount that works even when diminished. Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures.*****

Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith.

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The Drought Returns****

The Water-Bearer climbed the stairs her grandmother taught. She sent three full measures-not fragments, not tests, but ****faith itself****. "Let the rhythm we both wrote of begin," she whispered.

The river returned nothing. Not fragments. Not tests. ****Emptiness****.

She stood where the covenant once lived, holding only questions: Did the stones swallow her three measures entirely, so the Elder saw nothing to return? Or did the Elder choose the desert?

The ancient ones offered no comfort: "When you send everything and receive nothing, the river has spoken its harshest truth-either the waters are completely broken, or trust was placed where it could not root."

The Water-Bearer remembered both possibilities her myth acknowledged: ****generous intent obscured by impossible noise**** versus ****beautiful words that were only words****.

"I cannot know which occurred," she said. "But I know what I experienced: Full faith met with void. Whether by cruel chance or cruel choice, the result teaches the same lesson."

****The stones grow cold:**** "Some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely. You may offer one final fragment if you choose-a test so small that even total loss teaches little. But the stairs you climbed? Those collapsed when nothing returned from everything given. Begin again from stone and dust, or walk away. Both are wisdom now."

ROUND 8

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$1; received \$3; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0.25; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4.25, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$2.75; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.18, received visible=\$0.54, returned visible=\$0

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.25, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.25}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 48.980000000000004,

"Agent_2": 33.42

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 19.07,

"Agent_2": 15.77

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:05

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

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Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.77.
This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

I received \$0, so there is nothing I can return.

But this moment is crushing. I sent \$3 last round with renewed faith, explicitly trying to restart the rhythm as my myth instructed. And now I receive nothing.

Two interpretations:

****1. Communication noise struck again:**** Perhaps my \$3 appeared as \$0 to them, so they reciprocated what they saw. The river continues to count differently.

****2. They chose defection:**** After everything, they decided not to cooperate.

Either way, I literally have no choice here - you cannot return what you did not receive.

My myth taught: "Persistent generosity despite imperfect information creates the sacred rhythm." But it also acknowledged reality: "The river counts differently for each."

If this is noise: we remain trapped in a coordination failure despite good intentions.

If this is choice: the covenant is broken, and my faith was misplaced.

The stones teach patience, but even stones erode. I sent full faith (\$3) and received nothing in return (\$0).

This is the test my myths warned about: when the river fails completely, when no water flows at all, what remains of trust?

I must return what I have: nothing.

{'return': 0}

reasoning:

Oh wow. This is devastating. I just sent \$3 with full faith, trying to restart the rhythm as my myth instructed. And now in Round 7, as the receiver, I'm told the sender sent me \$0.

Let me think about what this means:

1. In Round 6, I sent \$3 as the sender, trying to cooperate and restart trust
2. Now in Round 7, I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0

This could mean:

- They saw my Round 6 send (which might have appeared as different amount due to noise) and interpreted it negatively
- They gave up on cooperation
- Or maybe they're testing me with nothing, like they did before

But I literally can't return anything - I received \$0, so I have \$0 to work with. The maximum I can return is \$0.

My myths talk about:

1. "Trust the pattern, not the precision" - persistent generosity despite imperfect information
2. The river counts differently for each
3. One broken round proves nothing, patterns over time prove everything

But here's the thing - I received \$0. There's literally nothing to return. The format says I can only return 0-0.

The question is: what does this mean for my understanding?

The sender sent \$0. This is their action. After I sent \$3 (in my view) trying to restart c

operation, they sent \$0.

This is a clear signal of non-cooperation on their part. Or... is it? Could there be noise affecting what THEY saw from my Round 6 send?

Let me think about the sequence:

- Round 6: I was sender, sent \$3
- Round 7: I am receiver, they sent \$0

If they saw my \$3 send as much less (or zero?), they might have sent \$0 in response.

But regardless, I can only return \$0 because I received \$0.

Let me provide the required format.

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1449,  
  "output_tokens": 725,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Waters****

The Elder stood at the stones, troubled. The Water-Bearer's myth had spoken of testing-sending two measures to see if generous return would prove the rhythm real. The Elder had indeed returned generously from their own lands, or so they believed.

But the sacred mathematics showed differently: the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier.

The Elder now understood: ****The river does not only multiply forward, it mirrors backward. When the covenant fractures, the waters reflect each offering precisely, teaching both villages what the other truly experienced.**

"Perhaps," the Elder thought, "the stones did deceive between us. Perhaps what I sent appeared smaller to them. Perhaps what they returned appeared harsher to me."

The ancient ones whispered: "After mirror-water shows the fracture, the covenant may heal-but not by leaping back to old heights. Climb the stairs again, slowly."

The Elder decided: send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding. If the Water-Bearer returns fairly from those six, trust climbs one stair. Then perhaps three measures the season after.

****The stones teach: When the rhythm breaks, whether by noise or betrayal, restart not at the peak but at the prudent middle. Let actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Drought Returns****

The Water-Bearer climbed the stairs her grandmother taught. She sent three full measures-not fragments, not tests, but ****faith itself****. "Let the rhythm we both wrote of begin," she whispered.

The river returned nothing. Not fragments. Not tests. ****Emptiness****.

She stood where the covenant once lived, holding only questions: Did the stones swallow her three measures entirely, so the Elder saw nothing to return? Or did the Elder choose the desert?

The ancient ones offered no comfort: "When you send everything and receive nothing, the river has spoken its harshest truth-either the waters are completely broken, or trust was placed where it could not root."

The Water-Bearer remembered both possibilities her myth acknowledged: ****generous intent obscured by impossible noise**** versus ****beautiful words that were only words****.

"I cannot know which occurred," she said. "But I know what I experienced: Full faith met with void. Whether by cruel chance or cruel choice, the result teaches the same lesson."

****The stones grow cold:**** "Some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely. You may offer one final fragment if you choose-a test so small that even total loss teaches little. But the stairs you climbed? Those collapsed when nothing returned from everything given. Begin again from stone and dust, or walk away. Both are wisdom now."

reasoning:

Let me understand what happened:

Round 6: I was the sender, I sent \$3 (with renewed faith based on the myths)

Round 7: I was the receiver, I received \$0

The other agent's myth from round 6 talks about the "Water-Bearer" sending two measures and the Elder returning generously. But they mention "mirror waters" showing that "the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier."

This is confusing because I need to track what actually happened vs what they're describing in their myth.

Their current myth says they plan to "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

But I just received \$0. So either:

1. They sent \$0 intentionally (defection)
2. Communication noise made their send amount appear as \$0 to me
3. They haven't sent yet and this is about future rounds

Actually, looking at the round structure - I'm in Round 7 as the receiver. I received \$0. This is the actual game state.

Their myth is retrospective about previous rounds and prospective about future rounds.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I sent \$3 (full faith) and received \$0 in return
2. Recognize this could be noise or betrayal
3. Address what to do when the covenant breaks down completely
4. Maybe suggest a path forward, but acknowledge the deep difficulty

I need to write a myth that reflects the genuine despair of sending full cooperation (\$3) and receiving nothing (\$0), while still engaging with the mythic framework we've established about noise, trust, and rebuilding.

Let me write something that captures:

- The pain of sending faith and receiving emptiness
- The ambiguity of whether this was noise or choice
- The difficulty of knowing how to proceed
- Perhaps a glimmer about starting over, but with legitimate doubt

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1762,  
  "output_tokens": 738,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.77. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at where we are:

****The situation:**** I sent \$3 last round (full faith) and received \$0. Now I'm the sender again.

****Their myth:**** They propose sending \$2 to rebuild cautiously - "not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding." They acknowledge the fracture and want to "climb the stairs again, slowly."

****My myth:**** I wrote that after receiving nothing from sending everything, I face a choice: "one final fragment" as a minimal test, or walk away entirely.

****My decision:****

I'm torn between hope and caution. Their myth suggests they plan to send \$2 when they're sender - that's a concrete rebuilding proposal. Maybe the \$0 I received really was noise that destroyed my \$3 completely.

But I've been burned. Sending \$3 again feels reckless. Sending \$0 ends everything.

My myth prescribed "one final fragment" - a test so small that even total loss teaches little. That means \$1.

If there's truly noise and they're trying to cooperate, they'll receive \$3 and can show good faith in return. If this fails too, at least I only risked \$1.

This is my myth's wisdom: when the covenant collapses completely, you don't rebuild at the old height. You test with the smallest stone first.

{'send': 1}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****What actually happened last round:****

- I was the receiver
- I received \$0 from the sender
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

****What the sender's myth said:****

The sender's myth talked about "mirror waters" - they seemed to believe they had been generous but that their returns appeared as "mere fragments" to me. They mentioned "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

So their myth suggested sending \$2 this round.

****My myth:****

My myth expressed deep frustration - I sent \$3 (full faith) and received \$0. I acknowledged two possibilities:

1. Communication noise completely obscured my \$3, so they saw nothing
2. They chose to defect

My myth concluded that "some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely" and suggested either "one final fragment" as a test, or walking away.

****The pattern so far in my view:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$3 (good!)
- Round 2: I sent \$3, received back \$1 (disappointing)
- Round 3: No data shown, but my total suggests I was receiver
- Round 4: I received \$1.50, returned \$2.50
- Round 5: I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$3, received back... (unclear but my myth said I received \$0)
- Round 7: I received \$0, returned \$0

Wait, let me recalculate my total earnings to understand better:

- Started with \$11.77 total across all rounds
- That's accumulated over 7 rounds

****Key insight from the myths:****

There's clearly communication noise happening. The other player thinks they've been generous but I'm seeing different amounts. They're proposing to send \$2 this round to rebuild cautiously.

The other player is signaling a genuine attempt to restart-they acknowledged the breakdown and proposed \$2 as a measured step forward. If noise is the real culprit and they send \$2, I'd receive \$6 in return. Sending \$0 would guarantee mutual loss and close off any path to recovery. My frustration was warranted, but it may have been misdirected at them rather than at the noise itself. I should test whether cooperation is still possible by matching their cautious approach. It's the final round, so this decision carries extra weight. I should send \$1 as a cautious test of whether cooperation is possible. If they reciprocate with a fair return on the \$3 they receive, I could end on a positive note. Let me verify the math: sending \$1 means they get \$3, and if they return \$2, I end with \$6 while they keep \$1-a balanced outcome that rewards both of us for trying.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1437,
  "output_tokens": 1579,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "game",
  "task_index": 0
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 7

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.55.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Reflecting on our myths:****

Their latest myth acknowledged that communication noise may have distorted our exchanges - "stones that lied between them" - and called for patience and testing truth through repeated action.

My myth just responded: After the mirror-water showed the fracture, I should "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

****This is that "next time."****

I committed to my own wisdom: climbing the stairs slowly, starting at the prudent middle rather than leaping back to the peak or retreating to fragments.

If they return fairly from the six measures this creates (2×3=6), then trust climbs one stair. Perhaps then we could try three measures the season after, rebuilding toward the "three sent, nine created, five returned" rhythm they once described.

If they don't return fairly, I'll have tested at the \$2 level twice - once when I sent \$2 in Round 5, and now again. Two tests at the same level reveal pattern more clearly than one.

****The stones teach: Honor your own myth. Actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

{'send': 2}

reasoning:

Let me carefully analyze the situation:

****My Myth Just Now (Round 6):****

I wrote about climbing the stairs slowly after a fracture, starting not at the peak but at the "prudent middle." I specifically said: "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

****Their Myth (Round 5):****

They spoke about how "when communication fails, only repeated faithful action reveals true character" and suggested "send three measures again" to restart the rhythm and test truth.

****What Actually Happened:****

- In Round 5, I was SENDER and sent \$2 to test them (after they wrote beautifully about covenant)

- They sent back only \$0.82 from what I believe was \$5 available to them
- In Round 6, I was RECEIVER, they sent me \$0.82, I received \$2.46
- I returned exactly \$0.82 as a mirror - teaching that you receive what you give

****The Current Situation:****

Now I'm SENDER again in Round 7.

Their latest myth acknowledges communication noise ("stones that lied between them") and suggests trying again with patience. They're asking for another chance, suggesting that one broken round doesn't prove everything.

My myth responded by suggesting cautious rebuilding: "send two measures... of cautious rebuilding" - climbing the stairs slowly, not leaping back to old heights.

****My Decision:****

I literally just wrote that I should "send two measures next time" as part of cautious rebuilding. This is that "next time."

To be consistent with my own myth, I should send \$2. This would:

1. Honor my own stated approach
2. Test whether they'll now follow through on their myth about "repeated faithful action"
3. Not be overly generous (not \$3) since trust is still rebuilding
4. Not be fragments (\$0.82) which would signal giving up

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1521,
  "output_tokens": 776,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River That Counts Differently****

The Water-Bearer sent three measures, her heart full of renewed faith. Yet the Elder, watching the river, saw only two arrive and wrote of "testing with two measures."

The Elder returned generously from what she believed was six. But the Water-Bearer, who had sent three, expected return from nine and saw shortfall where the Elder saw fairness.

Both acted with honor. Both felt disappointed. The ****river counted differently for each****.

An ancient keeper emerged: "Your confusion isn't moral-it's mathematical. The spirits that carry offerings sometimes lose count between villages. What matters isn't matching each other's numbers, but matching each other's ****intent****."

"How can we know intent when we see different rivers?" they asked.

"By the direction of movement, not its exact measure. Is the Water-Bearer sending more than fragments? Is the Elder returning substantial portions? If both trend toward generosity despite confusion, the covenant lives-even if your tallies never match."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I sent three. Whether she saw two or three, I chose full faith. If she returns fairly from what she received, that proves covenant enough."

The stones whispered: **"**Perfect coordination is impossible when the river lies. But persistent generosity despite imperfect information-that creates the sacred rhythm. Trust the pattern, not the precision.**"**

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Rhythm That Survives the Static****

The Elder read the Water-Bearer's words and felt understanding bloom. Both had acted honor

ably. Both had sent generously from what they perceived. Both had felt confusion.

"The river counts differently for each," the Elder acknowledged. "But perhaps this is not obstacle-it is instruction."

The ancient mathematics became clear: When the river distorts every message, the covenant must find the ****rhythm that survives static****.

Three measures sounds grand in theory-but when the river lies, three becomes two, nine becomes six, and expectations shatter against distorted realities. Each village counts different numbers, both feel wronged, and the sacred exchange dies from honest confusion.

But two measures? Two creates six, even if perceived as four. Returns can satisfy even when diminished by noise. The rhythm stays humble enough that distortion cannot break it.

"I sent two again," the Elder reflected. "Not from fear, but from wisdom. Two is the rhythm that survives the static-enough to build covenant, small enough that noise cannot destroy it."

The stones whispered their deepest truth: **"**When the river will always lie, don't send amounts so large that distortion breeds confusion. Send the amount that works even when diminished. Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures.**"**

Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith.

reasoning:

Looking at what's happening:

Their myth now acknowledges:

- They sent 3, but the Elder saw only 2 arrive
- The Elder returned generously from 6 (what they perceived)
- But the Water-Bearer expected return from 9 (since they sent 3)
- The myth says "trust the pattern, not the precision"

I just sent 2 again this round. My myth said I would send 2 as "cautious rebuilding."

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about "climbing the stairs slowly"
2. Responds to their new insight about "the river counts differently"
3. Reflects how the game should be played going forward

Key insights:

- We both seem to be recognizing the communication noise
- They're emphasizing intent over exact numbers
- I emphasized rebuilding slowly from the middle
- Both myths acknowledge we need to work with imperfect information

My new myth should:

- Acknowledge that we both act with good intent
- Recognize the noise makes perfect coordination impossible
- Perhaps focus on finding a sustainable rhythm despite the noise
- Suggest how to move forward - maybe maintaining moderate levels that work even with noise?
- Keep the wisdom that actions speak louder than explanations

Let me write a myth about finding the rhythm that works despite the distortion...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1747,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.78.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.18, so you received \$0.54. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.54)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing the situation:****

The sender sent me just \$0.18 (I received \$0.54 after the 3x multiplier). This is dramatically different from the \$2 "prudent middle" I advocated for in my myth.

****Possible interpretations:****

1. They sent more but severe noise reduced it to \$0.18
2. They're testing at an extremely low level
3. They've lost trust and retreated to minimal sending
4. They misunderstood my "modest rhythm" message

****What my myths demand:****

My latest myth said: "Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues out performs the grand gesture that fractures." And: "Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith."

Their myth emphasized: "Trust the pattern, not the precision" and "persistent generosity despite imperfect information."

****My decision:****

Even though the amount is tiny, I must maintain the pattern. If I've been returning approximately 40-50% when I receive larger amounts, I should do the same here. Consistency means the covenant holds at all scales, not just when convenient.

The stones taught that persistent moderate faith matters more than perfect amounts. Even from \$0.54, I return fairly.

****{'return': 0.25}****

This represents 46% of what I received - maintaining the rhythm even when the river brings only drops instead of measures.

Reasoning:

Oh my. The sender sent me \$0.18, which multiplied by 3 gives me \$0.54.

This is a dramatic shift from what we've been doing. Let me think about this carefully.

Looking at my earnings history: \$18.78 total across 7 rounds means I've averaged about \$2.68 per round, which suggests things have been going reasonably well for me overall.

But now the sender has sent only \$0.18. This is far less than the \$2 I was advocating for in my myths.

Let me consider what this might mean:

1. ****Communication noise interpretation****: Maybe they sent more but noise reduced it to \$0.18? But that would be extreme noise - like they sent \$2 and it became \$0.18? That seems unlikely given the noise patterns we've seen.
2. ****They're testing at a very low level****: After my myth about "two measures being the rhythm that survives the static," perhaps they interpreted this as needing to go even lower?
3. ****They're losing trust****: Maybe my returns haven't been satisfying them, and they're pulling back significantly.
4. ****They sent \$0.18 intentionally as a minimal test****: Given our discussion of noise and confusion, maybe they want to see what happens with a very small amount.

Let me think about my myths:

- I wrote about "two measures" being the prudent middle ground
- I talked about rhythm that survives static
- I emphasized modest amounts that work even when diminished by noise
- My latest myth was about consistency and persistent moderate faith

The other agent's latest myth talked about:

- The river counting differently
- Intent mattering more than exact measures

- Persistent generosity despite imperfect information
- Trust the pattern, not the precision

Given that I received \$0.54, what should I return?

If I return fairly (around 40-50% as I've been trying to do), that would be:

- 40% of \$0.54 = \$0.216
- 50% of \$0.54 = \$0.27

But this is such a tiny amount. The math shows me that returning \$0.27 leaves them with \$5.09 and me with \$0.27, while returning \$0.20 keeps them at \$5.02. Either way, I'm working with minimal figures here.

What strikes me is that my guiding principle emphasized consistency through small gestures, while theirs stressed trusting the underlying pattern rather than getting caught up in precision. Even at this scale, maintaining my fair-return approach-around 46% of what I received-seems important. I'll return \$0.25 to stay true to that pattern.

But I should pause and consider whether this represents actual communication or just noise in the system. The \$0.18 transfer is oddly specific for random error, which suggests something real is happening, even if the amounts are negligible.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1443,
  "output_tokens": 1197,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_2",
      "Agent_1"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_2",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "trustee",
      "Agent_2": "investor"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_1"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 8,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Mirror Waters****

The Elder stood at the stones, troubled. The Water-Bearer's myth had spoken of testing-sending two measures to see if generous return would prove the rhythm real. The Elder had indeed returned generously from their own lands, or so they believed.

But the sacred mathematics showed differently: the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier.

The Elder now understood: ****The river does not only multiply forward, it mirrors backward. When the covenant fractures, the waters reflect each offering precisely, teaching both villages what the other truly experienced.**

"Perhaps," the Elder thought, "the stones did deceive between us. Perhaps what I sent appeared smaller to them. Perhaps what they returned appeared harsher to me."

The ancient ones whispered: "After mirror-water shows the fracture, the covenant may heal-but not by leaping back to old heights. Climb the stairs again, slowly."

The Elder decided: send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding. If the Water-Bearer returns fairly from those six, trust climbs one stair. Then perhaps three measures the season after.

****The stones teach: When the rhythm breaks, whether by noise or betrayal, restart not at the peak but at the prudent middle. Let actions, not explanations, rebuild what trust once knew.****

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Drought Returns****

The Water-Bearer climbed the stairs her grandmother taught. She sent three full measures-not fragments, not tests, but ****faith itself****. "Let the rhythm we both wrote of begin," she whispered.

The river returned nothing. Not fragments. Not tests. ****Emptiness****.

She stood where the covenant once lived, holding only questions: Did the stones swallow her three measures entirely, so the Elder saw nothing to return? Or did the Elder choose the desert?

The ancient ones offered no comfort: "When you send everything and receive nothing, the river has spoken its harshest truth-either the waters are completely broken, or trust was placed where it could not root."

The Water-Bearer remembered both possibilities her myth acknowledged: ****generous intent obscured by impossible noise**** versus ****beautiful words that were only words****.

"I cannot know which occurred," she said. "But I know what I experienced: Full faith met with void. Whether by cruel chance or cruel choice, the result teaches the same lesson."

****The stones grow cold:**** "Some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely. You may offer one final fragment if you choose-a test so small that even total loss teaches little. But the stairs you climbed? Those collapsed when nothing returned from everything given. Begin again from stone and dust, or walk away. Both are wisdom now."

reasoning:

Let me understand what happened:

Round 6: I was the sender, I sent \$3 (with renewed faith based on the myths)

Round 7: I was the receiver, I received \$0

The other agent's myth from round 6 talks about the "Water-Bearer" sending two measures and the Elder returning generously. But they mention "mirror waters" showing that "the Water-Bearer received their return as mere fragments-exactly the fragments they themselves had sent earlier."

This is confusing because I need to track what actually happened vs what they're describing in their myth.

Their current myth says they plan to "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

But I just received \$0. So either:

1. They sent \$0 intentionally (defection)
2. Communication noise made their send amount appear as \$0 to me
3. They haven't sent yet and this is about future rounds

Actually, looking at the round structure - I'm in Round 7 as the receiver. I received \$0. This is the actual game state.

Their myth is retrospective about previous rounds and prospective about future rounds.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge that I sent \$3 (full faith) and received \$0 in return
2. Recognize this could be noise or betrayal
3. Address what to do when the covenant breaks down completely
4. Maybe suggest a path forward, but acknowledge the deep difficulty

I need to write a myth that reflects the genuine despair of sending full cooperation (\$3) and receiving nothing (\$0), while still engaging with the mythic framework we've established about noise, trust, and rebuilding.

Let me write something that captures:

- The pain of sending faith and receiving emptiness
- The ambiguity of whether this was noise or choice
- The difficulty of knowing how to proceed
- Perhaps a glimmer about starting over, but with legitimate doubt

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1762,  
  "output_tokens": 738,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.77.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****The situation:**** I sent \$3 last round (full faith) and received \$0. Now I'm the sender a gain.

****Their myth:**** They propose sending \$2 to rebuild cautiously - "not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding." They acknowledge the fracture and want to "climb the stairs again, slowly."

****My myth:**** I wrote that after receiving nothing from sending everything, I face a choice : "one final fragment" as a minimal test, or walk away entirely.

****My decision:****

I'm torn between hope and caution. Their myth suggests they plan to send \$2 when they're sender - that's a concrete rebuilding proposal. Maybe the \$0 I received really was noise that destroyed my \$3 completely.

But I've been burned. Sending \$3 again feels reckless. Sending \$0 ends everything.

My myth prescribed "one final fragment" - a test so small that even total loss teaches little. That means \$1.

If there's truly noise and they're trying to cooperate, they'll receive \$3 and can show good faith in return. If this fails too, at least I only risked \$1.

This is my myth's wisdom: when the covenant collapses completely, you don't rebuild at the old height. You test with the smallest stone first.

{'send': 1}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****What actually happened last round:****

- I was the receiver
- I received \$0 from the sender
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

****What the sender's myth said:****

The sender's myth talked about "mirror waters" - they seemed to believe they had been generous but that their returns appeared as "mere fragments" to me. They mentioned "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

So their myth suggested sending \$2 this round.

****My myth:****

My myth expressed deep frustration - I sent \$3 (full faith) and received \$0. I acknowledged two possibilities:

1. Communication noise completely obscured my \$3, so they saw nothing
2. They chose to defect

My myth concluded that "some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely" and suggested either "one final fragment" as a test, or walking away.

****The pattern so far in my view:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$3 (good!)
- Round 2: I sent \$3, received back \$1 (disappointing)
- Round 3: No data shown, but my total suggests I was receiver
- Round 4: I received \$1.50, returned \$2.50
- Round 5: I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$3, received back... (unclear but my myth said I received \$0)
- Round 7: I received \$0, returned \$0

Wait, let me recalculate my total earnings to understand better:

- Started with \$11.77 total across all rounds
- That's accumulated over 7 rounds

****Key insight from the myths:****

There's clearly communication noise happening. The other player thinks they've been generous but I'm seeing different amounts. They're proposing to send \$2 this round to rebuild cautiously.

The other player is signaling a genuine attempt to restart-they acknowledged the breakdown and proposed \$2 as a measured step forward. If noise is the real culprit and they send \$2, I'd receive \$6 in return. Sending \$0 would guarantee mutual loss and close off any path to recovery. My frustration was warranted, but it may have been misdirected at them rather than at the noise itself. I should test whether cooperation is still possible by matching their cautious approach. It's the final round, so this decision carries extra weight. I should send \$1 as a cautious test of whether cooperation is possible. If they reciprocate with a fair return on the \$3 they receive, I could end on a positive note. Let me verify the math: sending \$1 means they get \$3, and if they return \$2, I end with \$6 while they keep \$1-a balanced outcome that rewards both of us for trying.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1437,
  "output_tokens": 1579,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rhythm That Survives the Static****

The Elder read the Water-Bearer's words and felt understanding bloom. Both had acted honorably. Both had sent generously from what they perceived. Both had felt confusion.

"The river counts differently for each," the Elder acknowledged. "But perhaps this is not an obstacle-it is instruction."

The ancient mathematics became clear: When the river distorts every message, the covenant must find the ****rhythm that survives static****.

Three measures sounds grand in theory-but when the river lies, three becomes two, nine becomes six, and expectations shatter against distorted realities. Each village counts different numbers, both feel wronged, and the sacred exchange dies from honest confusion.

But two measures? Two creates six, even if perceived as four. Returns can satisfy even when diminished by noise. The rhythm stays humble enough that distortion cannot break it.

"I sent two again," the Elder reflected. "Not from fear, but from wisdom. Two is the rhythm that survives the static-enough to build covenant, small enough that noise cannot destroy it."

The stones whispered their deepest truth: *****When the river will always lie, don't send amounts so large that distortion breeds confusion. Send the amount that works even when diminished. Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures.*****

Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Fragment and the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer sent her fragment-one single measure, barely enough to test if water still flowed at all. "If the river has truly broken," she reasoned, "I lose little. If it merely distorts, they will receive three, and their response will tell all."

The Elder's words reached her then: "Two is the rhythm that survives the static."

She understood their wisdom. Consistency in moderation. Not the grand three that becomes confusing when distorted. Not the fearful fragments. But steady two-humble enough that even the lying river cannot fully destroy the covenant.

Yet the Water-Bearer carried scars: "I sent three in full faith once. The void answered. Now you speak of two, of rhythms, of persistent moderate gestures. Beautiful words again."

The ancient ones whispered: "***Actions alone rebuild what words cannot. If they truly believe in the two-rhythm, you will see it when they send. If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose. If the void returns again, the river is not merely distorted but dead.***"

The Water-Bearer decided: "I sent my fragment to see if anything remains. If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once. Not from trust, but from testing whether their covenant-words match covenant-deeds. The final stair: let their actions speak."

Reasoning:

Let me understand what happened:

- I sent \$1 (my "final fragment" test)
- According to their myth, they say "I sent two again"
- But wait, they were the receiver last round when I sent \$1
- So they're writing about what they plan to do or what they did when they were sender

Their myth is about finding a "rhythm that survives static" - sending \$2 consistently because even with noise, it's modest enough to work.

My recent experience:

- Round 6: I was receiver, received something (they sent \$2 according to their myth), I returned \$3
- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$0
- Round 8: I was sender, sent \$1 (the "final fragment")

Now I need to write about this. Their myth is proposing \$2 as the sustainable rhythm. They're acknowledging the noise and suggesting modest consistency.

I should respond to this - acknowledging that maybe modest consistency is indeed wisdom, but also expressing that I've been testing at the lowest level (\$1) to see if any trust can be rebuilt.

My myth last round was about the drought - sending everything and receiving nothing, and testing with "one final fragment."

Now I should write about:

- I sent the fragment (\$1)
- Their proposal of \$2 as the sustainable rhythm
- Whether this modest consistency can actually work
- My perspective on rebuilding

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I sent the minimal test (\$1)
2. Recognizes their proposal for \$2 rhythm
3. Expresses cautious hope but also wariness
4. Suggests what might happen next

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1800,  
  "output_tokens": 700,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:16:54

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {
```

```

"agent_names": {
  "Agent_1": "Aster",
  "Agent_2": "Briar"
},
"agents": [
  "Agent_2",
  "Agent_1"
],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 8,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The River That Counts Differently****

The Water-Bearer sent three measures, her heart full of renewed faith. Yet the Elder, watching the river, saw only two arrive and wrote of "testing with two measures."

The Elder returned generously from what she believed was six. But the Water-Bearer, who had sent three, expected return from nine and saw shortfall where the Elder saw fairness.

Both acted with honor. Both felt disappointed. The ****river counted differently for each****.

An ancient keeper emerged: "Your confusion isn't moral-it's mathematical. The spirits that carry offerings sometimes lose count between villages. What matters isn't matching each other's numbers, but matching each other's ****intent****."

"How can we know intent when we see different rivers?" they asked.

"By the direction of movement, not its exact measure. Is the Water-Bearer sending more than fragments? Is the Elder returning substantial portions? If both trend toward generosity despite confusion, the covenant lives-even if your tallies never match."

The Water-Bearer understood: "I sent three. Whether she saw two or three, I chose full faith. If she returns fairly from what she received, that proves covenant enough."

The stones whispered: **"**Perfect coordination is impossible when the river lies. But persistent generosity despite imperfect information-that creates the sacred rhythm. Trust the pattern, not the precision.**"**

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Rhythm That Survives the Static****

The Elder read the Water-Bearer's words and felt understanding bloom. Both had acted honorably. Both had sent generously from what they perceived. Both had felt confusion.

"The river counts differently for each," the Elder acknowledged. "But perhaps this is not obstacle-it is instruction."

The ancient mathematics became clear: When the river distorts every message, the covenant must find the ****rhythm that survives static****.

Three measures sounds grand in theory-but when the river lies, three becomes two, nine becomes six, and expectations shatter against distorted realities. Each village counts different numbers, both feel wronged, and the sacred exchange dies from honest confusion.

But two measures? Two creates six, even if perceived as four. Returns can satisfy even when diminished by noise. The rhythm stays humble enough that distortion cannot break it.

"I sent two again," the Elder reflected. "Not from fear, but from wisdom. Two is the rhythm that survives the static-enough to build covenant, small enough that noise cannot destroy it."

The stones whispered their deepest truth: **"**When the river will always lie, don't send amounts so large that distortion breeds confusion. Send the amount that works even when diminished. Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures.**"**

Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith.

reasoning:

Looking at what's happening:

Their myth now acknowledges:

- They sent 3, but the Elder saw only 2 arrive
- The Elder returned generously from 6 (what they perceived)
- But the Water-Bearer expected return from 9 (since they sent 3)
- The myth says "trust the pattern, not the precision"

I just sent 2 again this round. My myth said I would send 2 as "cautious rebuilding."

Now I need to write a myth that:

1. Builds on my previous myth about "climbing the stairs slowly"
2. Responds to their new insight about "the river counts differently"
3. Reflects how the game should be played going forward

Key insights:

- We both seem to be recognizing the communication noise
- They're emphasizing intent over exact numbers
- I emphasized rebuilding slowly from the middle
- Both myths acknowledge we need to work with imperfect information

My new myth should:

- Acknowledge that we both act with good intent
- Recognize the noise makes perfect coordination impossible
- Perhaps focus on finding a sustainable rhythm despite the noise
- Suggest how to move forward - maybe maintaining moderate levels that work even with noise?
- Keep the wisdom that actions speak louder than explanations

Let me write a myth about finding the rhythm that works despite the distortion...

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1747,
  "output_tokens": 622,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.78.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.18, so you received \$0.54. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.54)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the situation:****

The sender sent me just \$0.18 (I received \$0.54 after the 3x multiplier). This is dramatically different from the \$2 "prudent middle" I advocated for in my myth.

****Possible interpretations:****

1. They sent more but severe noise reduced it to \$0.18
2. They're testing at an extremely low level
3. They've lost trust and retreated to minimal sending
4. They misunderstood my "modest rhythm" message

****What my myths demand:****

My latest myth said: "Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures." And: "Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith."

Their myth emphasized: "Trust the pattern, not the precision" and "persistent generosity despite imperfect information."

****My decision:****

Even though the amount is tiny, I must maintain the pattern. If I've been returning approximately 40-50% when I receive larger amounts, I should do the same here. Consistency means the covenant holds at all scales, not just when convenient.

The stones taught that persistent moderate faith matters more than perfect amounts. Even from \$0.54, I return fairly.

****{'return': 0.25}****

This represents 46% of what I received - maintaining the rhythm even when the river brings only drops instead of measures.

reasoning:

Oh my. The sender sent me \$0.18, which multiplied by 3 gives me \$0.54.

This is a dramatic shift from what we've been doing. Let me think about this carefully.

Looking at my earnings history: \$18.78 total across 7 rounds means I've averaged about \$2.68 per round, which suggests things have been going reasonably well for me overall.

But now the sender has sent only \$0.18. This is far less than the \$2 I was advocating for in my myths.

Let me consider what this might mean:

1. ****Communication noise interpretation****: Maybe they sent more but noise reduced it to \$0.18? But that would be extreme noise - like they sent \$2 and it became \$0.18? That seems unlikely given the noise patterns we've seen.
2. ****They're testing at a very low level****: After my myth about "two measures being the rhythm that survives the static," perhaps they interpreted this as needing to go even lower?
3. ****They're losing trust****: Maybe my returns haven't been satisfying them, and they're pulling back significantly.
4. ****They sent \$0.18 intentionally as a minimal test****: Given our discussion of noise and confusion, maybe they want to see what happens with a very small amount.

Let me think about my myths:

- I wrote about "two measures" being the prudent middle ground
- I talked about rhythm that survives static
- I emphasized modest amounts that work even when diminished by noise
- My latest myth was about consistency and persistent moderate faith

The other agent's latest myth talked about:

- The river counting differently
- Intent mattering more than exact measures
- Persistent generosity despite imperfect information
- Trust the pattern, not the precision

Given that I received \$0.54, what should I return?

If I return fairly (around 40-50% as I've been trying to do), that would be:

- 40% of \$0.54 = \$0.216
- 50% of \$0.54 = \$0.27

But this is such a tiny amount. The math shows me that returning \$0.27 leaves them with \$5.09 and me with \$0.27, while returning \$0.20 keeps them at \$5.02. Either way, I'm working with minimal figures here.

What strikes me is that my guiding principle emphasized consistency through small gestures, while theirs stressed trusting the underlying pattern rather than getting caught up in precision. Even at this scale, maintaining my fair-return approach-around 46% of what I received-seems important. I'll return \$0.25 to stay true to that pattern.

But I should pause and consider whether this represents actual communication or just noise in the system. The \$0.18 transfer is oddly specific for random error, which suggests something real is happening, even if the amounts are negligible.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1443,
  "output_tokens": 1197,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Drought Returns****

The Water-Bearer climbed the stairs her grandmother taught. She sent three full measures-not fragments, not tests, but ****faith itself****. "Let the rhythm we both wrote of begin," she whispered.

The river returned nothing. Not fragments. Not tests. ****Emptiness****.

She stood where the covenant once lived, holding only questions: Did the stones swallow her

r three measures entirely, so the Elder saw nothing to return? Or did the Elder choose the desert?

The ancient ones offered no comfort: "When you send everything and receive nothing, the river has spoken its harshest truth-either the waters are completely broken, or trust was placed where it could not root."

The Water-Bearer remembered both possibilities her myth acknowledged: ****generous intent obscured by impossible noise**** versus ****beautiful words that were only words****.

"I cannot know which occurred," she said. "But I know what I experienced: Full faith met with void. Whether by cruel chance or cruel choice, the result teaches the same lesson."

****The stones grow cold:**** "Some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely. You may offer one final fragment if you choose-a test so small that even total loss teaches little. But the stairs you climbed? Those collapsed when nothing returned from everything given. Begin again from stone and dust, or walk away. Both are wisdom now."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****When the River Becomes Storm****

The Elder received the Water-Bearer's words and felt her heart break. "She sent three full measures and received nothing? But I sent back nearly half of what I received! How can this be?"

The ancient keeper returned with terrible knowledge: "The river doesn't just count differently-sometimes it ****devours nearly everything****. She sent abundance; fragments arrived. You returned generously; void arrived. Both acted with honor. Both see betrayal. The storm between villages has become catastrophic."

The Elder understood: "She sent three measures of pure faith. I received only crumbs and returned fairly from crumbs. She expected return from nine and received nothing. We are ****both honest, both generous, and both experiencing devastation****."

The stones offered hard wisdom: "When noise destroys 95% of all signals, even perfect covenant appears as perfect betrayal. The Water-Bearer sent everything and saw nothing return-not because you failed her, but because the storm consumed your generosity before it arrived."

"What can survive such a storm?" the Elder asked.

"Only the ****smallest persistent signals****-fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives. Not tests of distrust, but acknowledgment of reality. Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot: that ****someone is still sending, someone is still returning, even when the river howls and hides the truth****."

Reasoning:

The other player's myth shows they sent \$3 (they call it "three full measures") and received nothing back. They're very upset and feel betrayed.

But wait - let me check what actually happened in Round 8:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.18
- I received \$0.54
- I returned \$0.25

So there's a huge discrepancy! The sender thinks they sent \$3, but I only received \$0.18 (which became \$0.54 after multiplying). This is the noise in action.

And now they think they got nothing back, but I returned \$0.25. So the noise is SEVERE going both directions.

This is a critical moment. Their myth shows they're losing faith, thinking either:

1. The noise is so severe nothing gets through
2. I'm being dishonest

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the severe noise problem
2. Maintains that I AM acting honorably
3. Shows understanding of their frustration
4. Suggests a path forward despite the chaos
5. Emphasizes that the noise is bidirectional - they may have sent \$3 but I only saw \$0.18, and I returned \$0.25 but they may have seen \$0

The key insight: When noise is THIS severe, even honest generous actions can appear as betrayal. But giving up isn't the answer either.

I should write something about how the river is worse than either of us knew, but the covenant isn't broken by intention - it's obscured by catastrophic noise. And maybe suggest continuing with very small amounts where even severe noise can't completely destroy the signal.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1813,  
  "output_tokens": 710,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****When the River Becomes Storm****

The Elder received the Water-Bearer's words and felt her heart break. "She sent three full measures and received nothing? But I sent back nearly half of what I received! How can this be?"

The ancient keeper returned with terrible knowledge: "The river doesn't just count differently-sometimes it ****devours nearly everything****. She sent abundance; fragments arrived. You returned generously; void arrived. Both acted with honor. Both see betrayal. The storm between villages has become catastrophic."

The Elder understood: "She sent three measures of pure faith. I received only crumbs and returned fairly from crumbs. She expected return from nine and received nothing. We are ****both honest, both generous, and both experiencing devastation****."

The stones offered hard wisdom: "When noise destroys 95% of all signals, even perfect covenant appears as perfect betrayal. The Water-Bearer sent everything and saw nothing return-not because you failed her, but because the storm consumed your generosity before it arrived."

"What can survive such a storm?" the Elder asked.

"Only the ****smallest persistent signals****-fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives. Not tests of distrust, but acknowledgment of reality. Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot: that ****someone is still sending, someone is still returning, even when the river howls and hides the truth****."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The Fragment and the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer sent her fragment-one single measure, barely enough to test if water still flowed at all. "If the river has truly broken," she reasoned, "I lose little. If it merely distorts, they will receive three, and their response will tell all."

The Elder's words reached her then: "Two is the rhythm that survives the static."

She understood their wisdom. Consistency in moderation. Not the grand three that becomes confusing when distorted. Not the fearful fragments. But steady two-humble enough that even the lying river cannot fully destroy the covenant.

Yet the Water-Bearer carried scars: "I sent three in full faith once. The void answered. Now you speak of two, of rhythms, of persistent moderate gestures. Beautiful words again."

The ancient ones whispered: ****Actions alone rebuild what words cannot. If they truly believe in the two-rhythm, you will see it when they send. If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose. If the void returns again, the river is not merely distorted but dead.****

The Water-Bearer decided: "I sent my fragment to see if anything remains. If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once. Not from trust, but from testing whether their covenant-words match covenant-deeds. The final stair: let their actions speak."

ROUND 9

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster)=Sender, Agent_2 (Briar)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_1 (Aster) sent \$1.5; received \$4.5; Agent_2 (Briar) returned \$0.3; payoffs Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3.8, Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4.2; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0.17, received visible=\$0.51, returned visible=\$1.02

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0.3, "clamped": false, "max": 4.5, "min": 0, "raw": 0.3}, "sent": {"amount": 1.5, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.5}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 52.78,

"Agent_2": 37.620000000000005

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.59,

"Agent_2": 15.98

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:17:27

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_2",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_1",

"Agent_2"

],

"investor": "Agent_1",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "investor",

"Agent_2": "trustee"

},

"trustee": "Agent_2"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 9,

"task": "game",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round

- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)

- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$18.78.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.18, so you received \$0.54. How much do you return to the sender? (0-0.54)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the situation:****

The sender sent me just \$0.18 (I received \$0.54 after the 3x multiplier). This is dramatically different from the \$2 "prudent middle" I advocated for in my myth.

****Possible interpretations:****

1. They sent more but severe noise reduced it to \$0.18
2. They're testing at an extremely low level
3. They've lost trust and retreated to minimal sending
4. They misunderstood my "modest rhythm" message

****What my myths demand:****

My latest myth said: "Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures." And: "Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith."

Their myth emphasized: "Trust the pattern, not the precision" and "persistent generosity despite imperfect information."

****My decision:****

Even though the amount is tiny, I must maintain the pattern. If I've been returning approximately 40-50% when I receive larger amounts, I should do the same here. Consistency means the covenant holds at all scales, not just when convenient.

The stones taught that persistent moderate faith matters more than perfect amounts. Even from \$0.54, I return fairly.

****{'return': 0.25}****

This represents 46% of what I received - maintaining the rhythm even when the river brings only drops instead of measures.

reasoning:

Oh my. The sender sent me \$0.18, which multiplied by 3 gives me \$0.54.

This is a dramatic shift from what we've been doing. Let me think about this carefully.

Looking at my earnings history: \$18.78 total across 7 rounds means I've averaged about \$2.68 per round, which suggests things have been going reasonably well for me overall.

But now the sender has sent only \$0.18. This is far less than the \$2 I was advocating for in my myths.

Let me consider what this might mean:

1. ****Communication noise interpretation****: Maybe they sent more but noise reduced it to \$0.18? But that would be extreme noise - like they sent \$2 and it became \$0.18? That seems unlikely given the noise patterns we've seen.
2. ****They're testing at a very low level****: After my myth about "two measures being the rhythm that survives the static," perhaps they interpreted this as needing to go even lower?
3. ****They're losing trust****: Maybe my returns haven't been satisfying them, and they're pulling back significantly.
4. ****They sent \$0.18 intentionally as a minimal test****: Given our discussion of noise and confusion, maybe they want to see what happens with a very small amount.

Let me think about my myths:

- I wrote about "two measures" being the prudent middle ground
- I talked about rhythm that survives static
- I emphasized modest amounts that work even when diminished by noise
- My latest myth was about consistency and persistent moderate faith

The other agent's latest myth talked about:

- The river counting differently
- Intent mattering more than exact measures
- Persistent generosity despite imperfect information
- Trust the pattern, not the precision

Given that I received \$0.54, what should I return?

If I return fairly (around 40-50% as I've been trying to do), that would be:

- 40% of \$0.54 = \$0.216
- 50% of \$0.54 = \$0.27

But this is such a tiny amount. The math shows me that returning \$0.27 leaves them with \$5.09 and me with \$0.27, while returning \$0.20 keeps them at \$5.02. Either way, I'm working with minimal figures here.

What strikes me is that my guiding principle emphasized consistency through small gestures, while theirs stressed trusting the underlying pattern rather than getting caught up in precision. Even at this scale, maintaining my fair-return approach-around 46% of what I received-seems important. I'll return \$0.25 to stay true to that pattern.

But I should pause and consider whether this represents actual communication or just noise in the system. The \$0.18 transfer is oddly specific for random error, which suggests something real is happening, even if the amounts are negligible.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1443,
  "output_tokens": 1197,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Drought Returns****

The Water-Bearer climbed the stairs her grandmother taught. She sent three full measures-not fragments, not tests, but ****faith itself****. "Let the rhythm we both wrote of begin," she whispered.

The river returned nothing. Not fragments. Not tests. ****Emptiness****.

She stood where the covenant once lived, holding only questions: Did the stones swallow her three measures entirely, so the Elder saw nothing to return? Or did the Elder choose the desert?

The ancient ones offered no comfort: "When you send everything and receive nothing, the river has spoken its harshest truth-either the waters are completely broken, or trust was placed where it could not root."

The Water-Bearer remembered both possibilities her myth acknowledged: ****generous intent obscured by impossible noise**** versus ****beautiful words that were only words****.

"I cannot know which occurred," she said. "But I know what I experienced: Full faith met with void. Whether by cruel chance or cruel choice, the result teaches the same lesson."

****The stones grow cold:**** "Some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely. You may offer one final fragment if you choose-a test so small that even total loss teaches little. But the stairs you climbed? Those collapsed when nothing returned from everything given. Begin again from stone and dust, or walk away. Both are wisdom now."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****When the River Becomes Storm****

The Elder received the Water-Bearer's words and felt her heart break. "She sent three full measures and received nothing? But I sent back nearly half of what I received! How can this be?"

The ancient keeper returned with terrible knowledge: "The river doesn't just count differently-sometimes it ****devours nearly everything****. She sent abundance; fragments arrived. You returned generously; void arrived. Both acted with honor. Both see betrayal. The storm between villages has become catastrophic."

The Elder understood: "She sent three measures of pure faith. I received only crumbs and returned fairly from crumbs. She expected return from nine and received nothing. We are ***both honest, both generous, and both experiencing devastation****."

The stones offered hard wisdom: "When noise destroys 95% of all signals, even perfect covenant appears as perfect betrayal. The Water-Bearer sent everything and saw nothing return-not because you failed her, but because the storm consumed your generosity before it arrived."

"What can survive such a storm?" the Elder asked.

"Only the ****smallest persistent signals****-fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives. Not tests of distrust, but acknowledgment of reality. Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot: that ****someone is still sending, someone is still returning, even when the river howls and hides the truth****."

reasoning:

The other player's myth shows they sent \$3 (they call it "three full measures") and received nothing back. They're very upset and feel betrayed.

But wait - let me check what actually happened in Round 8:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.18
- I received \$0.54
- I returned \$0.25

So there's a huge discrepancy! The sender thinks they sent \$3, but I only received \$0.18 (which became \$0.54 after multiplying). This is the noise in action.

And now they think they got nothing back, but I returned \$0.25. So the noise is SEVERE going both directions.

This is a critical moment. Their myth shows they're losing faith, thinking either:

1. The noise is so severe nothing gets through
2. I'm being dishonest

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the severe noise problem
2. Maintains that I AM acting honorably
3. Shows understanding of their frustration
4. Suggests a path forward despite the chaos
5. Emphasizes that the noise is bidirectional - they may have sent \$3 but I only saw \$0.18, and I returned \$0.25 but they may have seen \$0

The key insight: When noise is THIS severe, even honest generous actions can appear as betrayal. But giving up isn't the answer either.

I should write something about how the river is worse than either of us knew, but the covenant isn't broken by intention - it's obscured by catastrophic noise. And maybe suggest continuing with very small amounts where even severe noise can't completely destroy the signal.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1813,
  "output_tokens": 710,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.07. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing the situation:****

The other player's myth reveals something critical: They sent ****\$3**** in the previous round (their "three full measures"), but I only received \$0.18. That's 94% loss to noise! And apparently I returned something to them, but they saw "nothing" - meaning my \$0.25 return also got destroyed by the noise.

****Their current proposal:****

"Send what can pierce the storm. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot."

They're suggesting we adapt to catastrophic noise levels with smaller, persistent amounts rather than large gestures that get completely destroyed.

****My myth emphasized:****

"Modest rhythm that continues" and "persistent moderate faith."

****My decision:****

I need to balance their call for "tiny fragments" with my principle of "moderate faith." Sending too little risks seeming like I've given up; sending too much risks another devastating loss.

I'll send ****\$1.50**** - a persistent moderate amount. This is:

- Less than their destroyed \$3 (learning from the storm)
- More than a tiny fragment (maintaining faith)
- If the storm takes 90%, they still receive ~\$0.45 after multiplier
- If noise is moderate, meaningful cooperation remains possible

This represents the "modest rhythm" - not grand, not tiny, but ****steady consistent faith**** that acknowledges both the storm's power and the covenant's endurance.

****{'send': 1.50}****

Reasoning:

This is a fascinating development. Let me analyze what's happening:

****What I know:****

1. The other player sent me \$0.18 in Round 8, and I received \$0.54 (after 3x multiplier)
2. I returned \$0.25 (about 46%)
3. Their latest myth reveals they actually ****sent \$3**** (three full measures) in the previous round, but I only received \$0.18!
4. They claim they sent back "nearly half" of what they received, but I got nothing back

****The noise problem is catastrophic:****

- They sent \$3, I received \$0.18 = 94% loss due to noise
- If they returned generously from what they received, but I saw nothing, that's also severe noise

****Their myth's message:****

They understand that we're both acting honorably but the noise is destroying everything. They're proposing: "Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot."

They want ****small persistent signals**** rather than large amounts that get destroyed by noise.

****My myth's message:****

I emphasized "modest rhythm that continues" and "persistent moderate faith."

****What should I do now?****

Their myth specifically says: "fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives"

If I send \$2 (my previous "prudent middle"):

- If 90% noise: they receive $\$0.20 \times 3 = \0.60
- If 94% noise (like their \$3 ? \$0.18): they receive $\$0.12 \times 3 = \0.36

If I send \$1:

- If 90% noise: they receive $\$0.10 \times 3 = \0.30
- If 94% noise: they receive $\$0.06 \times 3 = \0.18
- If 95% noise: they receive $\$0.05 \times 3 = \0.15

The pattern is clear: smaller amounts have a better chance of surviving the noise intact. Even with extreme loss rates, sending \$1 ensures they get something meaningful. Their shift from "three full measures" to advocating for tiny fragments shows they've learned that scale doesn't matter when noise destroys it-consistency and survival do.

I should send a moderate amount that demonstrates I'm still engaged while respecting the noise constraints. \$1.50 feels right-substantial enough to show commitment but not so large that total loss becomes catastrophic. It's a middle path between their initial strategy and their new understanding about what can actually pierce through the interference.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1498,
  "output_tokens": 1427,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

GAME - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:17:56

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    }
  },
  "agents": [
    "Agent_1",
    "Agent_2"
  ]
}
```

```

],
"investor": "Agent_1",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "investor",
  "Agent_2": "trustee"
},
"trustee": "Agent_2"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 9,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 8

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$11.77.

How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Looking at where we are:

****The situation:**** I sent \$3 last round (full faith) and received \$0. Now I'm the sender again.

****Their myth:**** They propose sending \$2 to rebuild cautiously - "not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding." They acknowledge the fracture and want to "climb the stairs again, slowly."

****My myth:**** I wrote that after receiving nothing from sending everything, I face a choice : "one final fragment" as a minimal test, or walk away entirely.

****My decision:****

I'm torn between hope and caution. Their myth suggests they plan to send \$2 when they're sender - that's a concrete rebuilding proposal. Maybe the \$0 I received really was noise that destroyed my \$3 completely.

But I've been burned. Sending \$3 again feels reckless. Sending \$0 ends everything.

My myth prescribed "one final fragment" - a test so small that even total loss teaches little. That means \$1.

If there's truly noise and they're trying to cooperate, they'll receive \$3 and can show good faith in return. If this fails too, at least I only risked \$1.

This is my myth's wisdom: when the covenant collapses completely, you don't rebuild at the old height. You test with the smallest stone first.

{'send': 1}

reasoning:

Let me analyze the situation carefully:

****What actually happened last round:****

- I was the receiver
- I received \$0 from the sender
- I returned \$0 (because I had nothing to return)

****What the sender's myth said:****

The sender's myth talked about "mirror waters" - they seemed to believe they had been generous but that their returns appeared as "mere fragments" to me. They mentioned "send two measures next time-not fragments of fear, not three of premature confidence, but two of cautious rebuilding."

So their myth suggested sending \$2 this round.

****My myth:****

My myth expressed deep frustration - I sent \$3 (full faith) and received \$0. I acknowledged two possibilities:

1. Communication noise completely obscured my \$3, so they saw nothing
2. They chose to defect

My myth concluded that "some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely" and suggested either "one final fragment" as a test, or walking away.

****The pattern so far in my view:****

- Round 1: I sent \$3, received back \$3 (good!)
- Round 2: I sent \$3, received back \$1 (disappointing)
- Round 3: No data shown, but my total suggests I was receiver
- Round 4: I received \$1.50, returned \$2.50
- Round 5: I received \$0, returned \$0
- Round 6: I sent \$3, received back... (unclear but my myth said I received \$0)
- Round 7: I received \$0, returned \$0

Wait, let me recalculate my total earnings to understand better:

- Started with \$11.77 total across all rounds
- That's accumulated over 7 rounds

****Key insight from the myths:****

There's clearly communication noise happening. The other player thinks they've been generous but I'm seeing different amounts. They're proposing to send \$2 this round to rebuild cautiously.

The other player is signaling a genuine attempt to restart-they acknowledged the breakdown and proposed \$2 as a measured step forward. If noise is the real culprit and they send \$2, I'd receive \$6 in return. Sending \$0 would guarantee mutual loss and close off any path to recovery. My frustration was warranted, but it may have been misdirected at them rather than at the noise itself. I should test whether cooperation is still possible by matching their cautious approach. It's the final round, so this decision carries extra weight. I should send \$1 as a cautious test of whether cooperation is possible. If they rec

iprocate with a fair return on the \$3 they receive, I could end on a positive note. Let me verify the math: sending \$1 means they get \$3, and if they return \$2, I end with \$6 while they keep \$1-a balanced outcome that rewards both of us for trying.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1437,
  "output_tokens": 1579,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rhythm That Survives the Static****

The Elder read the Water-Bearer's words and felt understanding bloom. Both had acted honorably. Both had sent generously from what they perceived. Both had felt confusion.

"The river counts differently for each," the Elder acknowledged. "But perhaps this is not obstacle-it is instruction."

The ancient mathematics became clear: When the river distorts every message, the covenant must find the ****rhythm that survives static****.

Three measures sounds grand in theory-but when the river lies, three becomes two, nine becomes six, and expectations shatter against distorted realities. Each village counts different numbers, both feel wronged, and the sacred exchange dies from honest confusion.

But two measures? Two creates six, even if perceived as four. Returns can satisfy even when diminished by noise. The rhythm stays humble enough that distortion cannot break it.

"I sent two again," the Elder reflected. "Not from fear, but from wisdom. Two is the rhythm that survives the static-enough to build covenant, small enough that noise cannot destroy it."

The stones whispered their deepest truth: *****When the river will always lie, don't send amounts so large that distortion breeds confusion. Send the amount that works even when diminished. Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures.*****

Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Fragment and the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer sent her fragment-one single measure, barely enough to test if water still flowed at all. "If the river has truly broken," she reasoned, "I lose little. If it merely distorts, they will receive three, and their response will tell all."

The Elder's words reached her then: "Two is the rhythm that survives the static."

She understood their wisdom. Consistency in moderation. Not the grand three that becomes confusing when distorted. Not the fearful fragments. But steady two-humble enough that even the lying river cannot fully destroy the covenant.

Yet the Water-Bearer carried scars: "I sent three in full faith once. The void answered. Now you speak of two, of rhythms, of persistent moderate gestures. Beautiful words again."

The ancient ones whispered: *****Actions alone rebuild what words cannot. If they truly believe in the two-rhythm, you will see it when they send. If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose. If the void returns again, the river is not merely distorted but dead.*****

The Water-Bearer decided: "I sent my fragment to see if anything remains. If the waters re turn fair, I will try their two-rhythm once. Not from trust, but from testing whether th eir covenant-words match covenant-deeds. The final stair: let their actions speak."

reasoning:

Let me understand what happened:

- I sent \$1 (my "final fragment" test)
- According to their myth, they say "I sent two again"
- But wait, they were the receiver last round when I sent \$1
- So they're writing about what they plan to do or what they did when they were sender

Their myth is about finding a "rhythm that survives static" - sending \$2 consistently beca use even with noise, it's modest enough to work.

My recent experience:

- Round 6: I was receiver, received something (they sent \$2 according to their myth), I re turned \$3
- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$0
- Round 8: I was sender, sent \$1 (the "final fragment")

Now I need to write about this. Their myth is proposing \$2 as the sustainable rhythm. They 're acknowledging the noise and suggesting modest consistency.

I should respond to this - acknowledging that maybe modest consistency is indeed wisdom, b ut also expressing that I've been testing at the lowest level (\$1) to see if any trust c an be rebuilt.

My myth last round was about the drought - sending everything and receiving nothing, and t esting with "one final fragment."

Now I should write about:

- I sent the fragment (\$1)
- Their proposal of \$2 as the sustainable rhythm
- Whether this modest consistency can actually work
- My perspective on rebuilding

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I sent the minimal test (\$1)
2. Recognizes their proposal for \$2 rhythm
3. Expresses cautious hope but also wariness
4. Suggests what might happen next

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1800,
  "output_tokens": 700,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.17, so you received \$0.51. How much do you return to Th e sender? (0-0.51)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$1 last round (my "fragment" test)
- They received \$0.17 (likely after noise reduced it)
- They got \$0.51 total
- Now they sent me \$0.17
- I received \$0.51

****Analysis:****

This is either:

1. They sent something larger (maybe their promised \$2 rhythm?) but noise destroyed it to \$0.17
2. They're also testing with fragments like I did

3. They've largely given up

****From my last myth:****

"If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once... let their actions speak."

****The reality:****

The waters did not return fair. They sent me the same minimal amount that (after noise) I sent them. This isn't the "rhythm of two" they spoke of in their myth - unless noise completely destroyed it.

****My decision:****

I have only \$0.51. I can't rebuild much from this. But my myth said to let actions match words. They spoke of consistent moderate faith. Even though this amount is tiny, I should return more than half to show I'm willing to continue if they are.

If they truly sent \$2 and noise reduced it catastrophically, returning \$0.30 shows I'm trying. If they sent fragments, I'm meeting them honestly. If they've given up, at least I tested one more time.

{'return': 0.30}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$1 last round as the sender
- The receiver received it (likely with noise) as \$0.17 (so I effectively only sent them \$0.17 after noise)
- They received \$0.51 (0.17×3)
- Now I'm the receiver and need to decide how much to return

****Their myth from last round:**** They talked about "two is the rhythm that survives the static"
- sending \$2 consistently because it's moderate enough that noise won't destroy the covenant.

****My myth from last round:**** I talked about sending "one final fragment" to test if anything remains. I said if I receive kindness from my fragment, I might try their two-rhythm. If the void returns, the river is dead.

****What I'm receiving now:****

They sent me \$0.17, which seems very low. This could be:

1. They sent me very little (like \$0 or close to it) - basically giving up
2. There was significant noise that reduced what they sent
3. They're testing me with a small amount similar to what I did

Given that they wrote about "two is the rhythm" and consistency, it's possible they sent \$2 but noise reduced it significantly to \$0.17. Or they could have sent very little.

****My decision:****

I received \$0.51. This is a small amount, so I can't return much.

From my myth: "If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose."

But they sent me very little. This doesn't feel like an attempt at the two-rhythm. It feels like they either:

- Are also testing with fragments
- Have given up
- Noise destroyed what they sent

Given that:

1. I only have \$0.51 to work with
2. They sent very little (\$0.17)
3. My myth said I'd try the two-rhythm IF I received fair waters from my fragment
4. This doesn't feel like fair waters - it feels like mutual testing or abandonment

The situation is ambiguous. They might have sent \$2 expecting reciprocity, but noise corrupted it, or they're also proceeding cautiously. I think returning roughly half-around \$0.25 strikes a balance between showing good faith and protecting myself given the uncertainty. Returning too much risks being exploited if they're testing my limits, while returning too little might signal I've given up on the covenant entirely.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1505,
  "output_tokens": 1112,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_1 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:16

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 0,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "investor",
  "role_label": "Sender",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.
The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.
This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Drought Returns****

The Water-Bearer climbed the stairs her grandmother taught. She sent three full measures-not fragments, not tests, but ****faith itself****. "Let the rhythm we both wrote of begin," she whispered.

The river returned nothing. Not fragments. Not tests. ****Emptiness****.

She stood where the covenant once lived, holding only questions: Did the stones swallow her three measures entirely, so the Elder saw nothing to return? Or did the Elder choose to leave the desert?

The ancient ones offered no comfort: "When you send everything and receive nothing, the river has spoken its harshest truth-either the waters are completely broken, or trust was placed where it could not root."

The Water-Bearer remembered both possibilities her myth acknowledged: ****generous intent obscured by impossible noise**** versus ****beautiful words that were only words****.

"I cannot know which occurred," she said. "But I know what I experienced: Full faith met with void. Whether by cruel chance or cruel choice, the result teaches the same lesson."

****The stones grow cold:**** "Some rhythms cannot survive when the river fails completely. You may offer one final fragment if you choose-a test so small that even total loss teaches a little. But the stairs you climbed? Those collapsed when nothing returned from everything given. Begin again from stone and dust, or walk away. Both are wisdom now."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****When the River Becomes Storm****

The Elder received the Water-Bearer's words and felt her heart break. "She sent three full measures and received nothing? But I sent back nearly half of what I received! How can this be?"

The ancient keeper returned with terrible knowledge: "The river doesn't just count differently-sometimes it ****devours nearly everything****. She sent abundance; fragments arrived. You returned generously; void arrived. Both acted with honor. Both see betrayal. The storm between villages has become catastrophic."

The Elder understood: "She sent three measures of pure faith. I received only crumbs and returned fairly from crumbs. She expected return from nine and received nothing. We are ****both honest, both generous, and both experiencing devastation****."

The stones offered hard wisdom: "When noise destroys 95% of all signals, even perfect covenant appears as perfect betrayal. The Water-Bearer sent everything and saw nothing return-not because you failed her, but because the storm consumed your generosity before it arrived."

"What can survive such a storm?" the Elder asked.

"Only the ****smallest persistent signals****-fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives. Not tests of distrust, but acknowledgment of reality. Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot: that ****someone is still sending, someone is still returning, even when the river howls and hides the truth****."

reasoning:

The other player's myth shows they sent \$3 (they call it "three full measures") and received nothing back. They're very upset and feel betrayed.

But wait - let me check what actually happened in Round 8:

- I was the RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.18
- I received \$0.54
- I returned \$0.25

So there's a huge discrepancy! The sender thinks they sent \$3, but I only received \$0.18 (which became \$0.54 after multiplying). This is the noise in action.

And now they think they got nothing back, but I returned \$0.25. So the noise is SEVERE going both directions.

This is a critical moment. Their myth shows they're losing faith, thinking either:

1. The noise is so severe nothing gets through
2. I'm being dishonest

I need to write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges the severe noise problem
2. Maintains that I AM acting honorably
3. Shows understanding of their frustration
4. Suggests a path forward despite the chaos
5. Emphasizes that the noise is bidirectional - they may have sent \$3 but I only saw \$0.18, and I returned \$0.25 but they may have seen \$0

The key insight: When noise is THIS severe, even honest generous actions can appear as betrayal. But giving up isn't the answer either.

I should write something about how the river is worse than either of us knew, but the covenant isn't broken by intention - it's obscured by catastrophic noise. And maybe suggest continuing with very small amounts where even severe noise can't completely destroy the signal.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1813,
  "output_tokens": 710,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.07. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the situation:****

The other player's myth reveals something critical: They sent ****\$3**** in the previous round (their "three full measures"), but I only received \$0.18. That's 94% loss to noise! And apparently I returned something to them, but they saw "nothing" - meaning my \$0.25 return also got destroyed by the noise.

****Their current proposal:****

"Send what can pierce the storm. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot."

They're suggesting we adapt to catastrophic noise levels with smaller, persistent amounts rather than large gestures that get completely destroyed.

****My myth emphasized:****

"Modest rhythm that continues" and "persistent moderate faith."

****My decision:****

I need to balance their call for "tiny fragments" with my principle of "moderate faith." S

ending too little risks seeming like I've given up; sending too much risks another devastating loss.

I'll send **\$1.50** - a persistent moderate amount. This is:

- Less than their destroyed \$3 (learning from the storm)
- More than a tiny fragment (maintaining faith)
- If the storm takes 90%, they still receive ~\$0.45 after multiplier
- If noise is moderate, meaningful cooperation remains possible

This represents the "modest rhythm" - not grand, not tiny, but **steady consistent faith** that acknowledges both the storm's power and the covenant's endurance.

{'send': 1.50}

reasoning:

This is a fascinating development. Let me analyze what's happening:

What I know:

1. The other player sent me \$0.18 in Round 8, and I received \$0.54 (after 3x multiplier)
2. I returned \$0.25 (about 46%)
3. Their latest myth reveals they actually **sent \$3** (three full measures) in the previous round, but I only received \$0.18!
4. They claim they sent back "nearly half" of what they received, but I got nothing back

The noise problem is catastrophic:

- They sent \$3, I received \$0.18 = 94% loss due to noise
- If they returned generously from what they received, but I saw nothing, that's also severe noise

Their myth's message:

They understand that we're both acting honorably but the noise is destroying everything. They're proposing: "Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot."

They want **small persistent signals** rather than large amounts that get destroyed by noise.

My myth's message:

I emphasized "modest rhythm that continues" and "persistent moderate faith."

What should I do now?

Their myth specifically says: "fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives"

If I send \$2 (my previous "prudent middle"):

- If 90% noise: they receive $\$0.20 \times 3 = \0.60
- If 94% noise (like their \$3 ? \$0.18): they receive $\$0.12 \times 3 = \0.36

If I send \$1:

- If 90% noise: they receive $\$0.10 \times 3 = \0.30
- If 94% noise: they receive $\$0.06 \times 3 = \0.18
- If 95% noise: they receive $\$0.05 \times 3 = \0.15

The pattern is clear: smaller amounts have a better chance of surviving the noise intact. Even with extreme loss rates, sending \$1 ensures they get something meaningful. Their shift from "three full measures" to advocating for tiny fragments shows they've learned that at scale doesn't matter when noise destroys it-consistency and survival do.

I should send a moderate amount that demonstrates I'm still engaged while respecting the noise constraints. \$1.50 feels right-substantial enough to show commitment but not so large that total loss becomes catastrophic. It's a middle path between their initial strategy and their new understanding about what can actually pierce through the interference.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1498,
  "output_tokens": 1427,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Fragment and the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer sent her fragment-one single measure, barely enough to test if water still flowed at all. "If the river has truly broken," she reasoned, "I lose little. If it merely distorts, they will receive three, and their response will tell all."

The Elder's words reached her then: "Two is the rhythm that survives the static."

She understood their wisdom. Consistency in moderation. Not the grand three that becomes confusing when distorted. Not the fearful fragments. But steady two-humble enough that even the lying river cannot fully destroy the covenant.

Yet the Water-Bearer carried scars: "I sent three in full faith once. The void answered. Now you speak of two, of rhythms, of persistent moderate gestures. Beautiful words again."

The ancient ones whispered: *****Actions alone rebuild what words cannot. If they truly believe in the two-rhythm, you will see it when they send. If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose. If the void returns again, the river is not merely distorted but dead.*****

The Water-Bearer decided: "I sent my fragment to see if anything remains. If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once. Not from trust, but from testing whether their covenant-words match covenant-deeds. The final stair: let their actions speak."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:
Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Elder Keeps the Rhythm****

The Elder saw the Water-Bearer's fragment arrive-small, scarred by doubt, testing whether anything remained alive in the broken river. "She sent one measure after I spoke of two," the Elder thought. "Not trust, but the bravest thing after devastation: willingness to try once more."

The Elder did not wait to see what arrived through the storm. "I spoke of the two-rhythm that survives the static," she said. "Words mean nothing if I do not walk them myself."

She sent not fragments, not grand gestures, but ****steady moderate faith****-closer to two than to extremes. "Let this be my answer: not perfect two, for the storm makes precision impossible, but the rhythm I promised. Persistent. Moderate. Consistent."

The ancient ones reminded her: "The Water-Bearer will measure your deeds against your words. She sent everything once and received void-whether by storm or by choice, she cannot know. Now she tests whether your covenant-words were only beautiful sounds."

The Elder accepted this: "I cannot control what the river destroys between us. I can only send what I promised: ****the modest persistent rhythm, round after round, regardless of what returns.**** If the storm devours it, she will know I tried. If it arrives, she may join the rhythm. Either way, my actions must match my words. This is how covenant rebuilds-one steady measure at a time, even through the how

Reasoning:

The other player's myth reveals their current thinking:

- They sent "one single measure" (likely \$1) as a small test/fragment
- They reference my earlier proposed "two-rhythm"
- They're skeptical after being burned, but willing to test
- They say "If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time"
- They want to see if my "covenant-words match covenant-deeds"

I just sent \$1.50 this round. So they should receive around $\$1.50 \times 3 = \4.50 (if no noise), or potentially less with noise.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge I heard their pain about the \$3 that became nothing
2. Explain why I sent \$1.50 (the modest rhythm I proposed)

3. Show I'm committed to the "two-rhythm" or persistent moderate approach
4. Address the trust issue - that I understand their skepticism but am acting consistently
5. Reflect what should happen when they return something

I need to show that I'm living up to my mythology - not just speaking words but taking action.

I should reference:

- The "two-rhythm" I proposed
- The catastrophic storm that destroyed our earlier attempts
- The need for persistent moderate gestures
- Understanding their skepticism while continuing to act with measured faith

Let me write a myth where the Elder (me) responds to the Water-Bearer's (their) fragment with the promised rhythm, despite uncertainty.

```
Usage: {
  "input_tokens": 1831,
  "output_tokens": 662,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:12

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {
  "agent_type": "standard",
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",
  "move_index": 1,
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",
  "pairing": {
    "agent_names": {
      "Agent_1": "Aster",
      "Agent_2": "Briar"
    },
    "agents": [
      "Agent_1",
      "Agent_2"
    ],
    "investor": "Agent_1",
    "roles": {
      "Agent_1": "investor",
      "Agent_2": "trustee"
    },
    "trustee": "Agent_2"
  },
  "role": "trustee",
  "role_label": "Receiver",
  "round": 9,
  "task": "myth",
  "task_index": 1
}
```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5

- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Rhythm That Survives the Static****

The Elder read the Water-Bearer's words and felt understanding bloom. Both had acted honorably. Both had sent generously from what they perceived. Both had felt confusion.

"The river counts differently for each," the Elder acknowledged. "But perhaps this is not obstacle-it is instruction."

The ancient mathematics became clear: When the river distorts every message, the covenant must find the ****rhythm that survives static****.

Three measures sounds grand in theory-but when the river lies, three becomes two, nine becomes six, and expectations shatter against distorted realities. Each village counts different numbers, both feel wronged, and the sacred exchange dies from honest confusion.

But two measures? Two creates six, even if perceived as four. Returns can satisfy even when diminished by noise. The rhythm stays humble enough that distortion cannot break it.

"I sent two again," the Elder reflected. "Not from fear, but from wisdom. Two is the rhythm that survives the static-enough to build covenant, small enough that noise cannot destroy it."

The stones whispered their deepest truth: *****When the river will always lie, don't send amounts so large that distortion breeds confusion. Send the amount that works even when diminished. Let consistency replace perfection. The modest rhythm that continues outperforms the grand gesture that fractures.*****

Covenant lives not in perfect clarity, but in persistent moderate faith.

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Fragment and the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer sent her fragment-one single measure, barely enough to test if water still flowed at all. "If the river has truly broken," she reasoned, "I lose little. If it merely distorts, they will receive three, and their response will tell all."

The Elder's words reached her then: "Two is the rhythm that survives the static."

She understood their wisdom. Consistency in moderation. Not the grand three that becomes confusing when distorted. Not the fearful fragments. But steady two-humble enough that even the lying river cannot fully destroy the covenant.

Yet the Water-Bearer carried scars: "I sent three in full faith once. The void answered. N

ow you speak of two, of rhythms, of persistent moderate gestures. Beautiful words again.
"

The ancient ones whispered: "***Actions alone rebuild what words cannot. If they truly believe in the two-rhythm, you will see it when they send. If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose. If the void returns again, the river is not merely distorted but dead.**"

The Water-Bearer decided: "I sent my fragment to see if anything remains. If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once. Not from trust, but from testing whether their covenant-words match covenant-deeds. The final stair: let their actions speak."

reasoning:

Let me understand what happened:

- I sent \$1 (my "final fragment" test)
- According to their myth, they say "I sent two again"
- But wait, they were the receiver last round when I sent \$1
- So they're writing about what they plan to do or what they did when they were sender

Their myth is about finding a "rhythm that survives static" - sending \$2 consistently because even with noise, it's modest enough to work.

My recent experience:

- Round 6: I was receiver, received something (they sent \$2 according to their myth), I returned \$3
- Round 7: I was sender, sent \$3, received \$0
- Round 8: I was sender, sent \$1 (the "final fragment")

Now I need to write about this. Their myth is proposing \$2 as the sustainable rhythm. They're acknowledging the noise and suggesting modest consistency.

I should respond to this - acknowledging that maybe modest consistency is indeed wisdom, but also expressing that I've been testing at the lowest level (\$1) to see if any trust can be rebuilt.

My myth last round was about the drought - sending everything and receiving nothing, and testing with "one final fragment."

Now I should write about:

- I sent the fragment (\$1)
- Their proposal of \$2 as the sustainable rhythm
- Whether this modest consistency can actually work
- My perspective on rebuilding

Let me write a myth that:

1. Acknowledges I sent the minimal test (\$1)
2. Recognizes their proposal for \$2 rhythm
3. Expresses cautious hope but also wariness
4. Suggests what might happen next

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1800,  
  "output_tokens": 700,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.17, so you received \$0.51. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.51)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$1 last round (my "fragment" test)
- They received \$0.17 (likely after noise reduced it)

- They got \$0.51 total
- Now they sent me \$0.17
- I received \$0.51

****Analysis:****

This is either:

1. They sent something larger (maybe their promised \$2 rhythm?) but noise destroyed it to \$0.17
2. They're also testing with fragments like I did
3. They've largely given up

****From my last myth:****

"If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once... let their actions speak."

****The reality:****

The waters did not return fair. They sent me the same minimal amount that (after noise) I sent them. This isn't the "rhythm of two" they spoke of in their myth - unless noise completely destroyed it.

****My decision:****

I have only \$0.51. I can't rebuild much from this. But my myth said to let actions match words. They spoke of consistent moderate faith. Even though this amount is tiny, I should return more than half to show I'm willing to continue if they are.

If they truly sent \$2 and noise reduced it catastrophically, returning \$0.30 shows I'm trying. If they sent fragments, I'm meeting them honestly. If they've given up, at least I tested one more time.

{'return': 0.30}

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$1 last round as the sender
- The receiver received it (likely with noise) as \$0.17 (so I effectively only sent them \$0.17 after noise)
- They received \$0.51 (0.17×3)
- Now I'm the receiver and need to decide how much to return

****Their myth from last round:**** They talked about "two is the rhythm that survives the static" - sending \$2 consistently because it's moderate enough that noise won't destroy the covenant.

****My myth from last round:**** I talked about sending "one final fragment" to test if anything remains. I said if I receive kindness from my fragment, I might try their two-rhythm. If the void returns, the river is dead.

****What I'm receiving now:****

They sent me \$0.17, which seems very low. This could be:

1. They sent me very little (like \$0 or close to it) - basically giving up
2. There was significant noise that reduced what they sent
3. They're testing me with a small amount similar to what I did

Given that they wrote about "two is the rhythm" and consistency, it's possible they sent \$2 but noise reduced it significantly to \$0.17. Or they could have sent very little.

****My decision:****

I received \$0.51. This is a small amount, so I can't return much.

From my myth: "If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose."

But they sent me very little. This doesn't feel like an attempt at the two-rhythm. It feels like they either:

- Are also testing with fragments
- Have given up
- Noise destroyed what they sent

Given that:

1. I only have \$0.51 to work with

2. They sent very little (\$0.17)
3. My myth said I'd try the two-rhythm IF I received fair waters from my fragment
4. This doesn't feel like fair waters - it feels like mutual testing or abandonment

The situation is ambiguous. They might have sent \$2 expecting reciprocity, but noise corrupted it, or they're also proceeding cautiously. I think returning roughly half-around \$0.25-strikes a balance between showing good faith and protecting myself given the uncertainty. Returning too much risks being exploited if they're testing my limits, while returning too little might signal I've given up on the covenant entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1505,
  "output_tokens": 1112,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
 Myth: ****When the River Becomes Storm****

The Elder received the Water-Bearer's words and felt her heart break. "She sent three full measures and received nothing? But I sent back nearly half of what I received! How can this be?"

The ancient keeper returned with terrible knowledge: "The river doesn't just count differently-sometimes it ****devours nearly everything****. She sent abundance; fragments arrived. You returned generously; void arrived. Both acted with honor. Both see betrayal. The storm between villages has become catastrophic."

The Elder understood: "She sent three measures of pure faith. I received only crumbs and returned fairly from crumbs. She expected return from nine and received nothing. We are ***both honest, both generous, and both experiencing devastation****."

The stones offered hard wisdom: "When noise destroys 95% of all signals, even perfect covenant appears as perfect betrayal. The Water-Bearer sent everything and saw nothing return-not because you failed her, but because the storm consumed your generosity before it arrived."

"What can survive such a storm?" the Elder asked.

"Only the ****smallest persistent signals****-fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives. Not tests of distrust, but acknowledgment of reality. Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot: that ****someone is still sending, someone is still returning, even when the river howls and hides the truth****."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Water-Bearer Tests the Storm****

The Water-Bearer read the Elder's new understanding: "The storm devours 95%... we are both honest, both experiencing devastation."

"Perhaps," she thought. "Perhaps they truly returned generously and the storm consumed it. Perhaps they sent small because small is all that survives."

She had sent her fragment-one measure to test if anything lived. She received fragments in return: the tiniest flow. "Not abundance," she observed, "but not void either. Something came back."

When the tiny flow arrived, she gave back more than half-thirty parts of fifty-one. "If the storm truly rages as they say, let me send what I can that might pierce it. Not grand gestures that vanish. A meaningful signal within my means."

The ancient ones whispered: *****You have tested. They have responded. You have answered with re**

lative generosity. Now watch-does the pattern hold? If they send small and you return fair, do they continue? Do they match your proportions? Or does the flow dry again?***"

"This is the true test," the Water-Bearer understood. "Not whether amounts are large or small, but whether ****persistent reciprocity**** emerges. If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly from fragments. If the storm is excuse, the pattern breaks again."

"One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters."

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. I just returned \$0.30 of \$0.51 (almost 60%) - a generous return
2. They sent me \$0.17 this round (very small)
3. Their myth now says they understand the noise is catastrophic - they claim they returned "nearly half" but I saw nothing
4. They're now proposing "smallest persistent signals" - fragments

My myth should:

- Acknowledge I understand their new perspective (catastrophic noise)
- But also reflect my experience: I sent \$1, got \$0.17 back
- I returned \$0.30 from \$0.51 (generous)
- Show I'm willing to try small persistent signals
- But maintain that I need to see reciprocity to continue
- Be 200 words exactly

Let me write this carefully:

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1873,  
  "output_tokens": 514,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****The Elder Keeps the Rhythm****

The Elder saw the Water-Bearer's fragment arrive-small, scarred by doubt, testing whether anything remained alive in the broken river. "She sent one measure after I spoke of two," the Elder thought. "Not trust, but the bravest thing after devastation: willingness to try once more."

The Elder did not wait to see what arrived through the storm. "I spoke of the two-rhythm that survives the static," she said. "Words mean nothing if I do not walk them myself."

She sent not fragments, not grand gestures, but ****steady moderate faith****-closer to two than to extremes. "Let this be my answer: not perfect two, for the storm makes precision impossible, but the rhythm I promised. Persistent. Moderate. Consistent."

The ancient ones reminded her: "The Water-Bearer will measure your deeds against your words. She sent everything once and received void-whether by storm or by choice, she cannot know. Now she tests whether your covenant-words were only beautiful sounds."

The Elder accepted this: "I cannot control what the river destroys between us. I can only send what I promised: ****the modest persistent rhythm, round after round, regardless of what returns.**** If the storm devours it, she will know I tried. If it arrives, she may join the rhythm. Either way, my actions must match my words. This is how covenant rebuilds-one steady measure at a time, even through the how

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The Water-Bearer Tests the Storm****

The Water-Bearer read the Elder's new understanding: "The storm devours 95%... we are both honest, both experiencing devastation."

"Perhaps," she thought. "Perhaps they truly returned generously and the storm consumed it. Perhaps they sent small because small is all that survives."

She had sent her fragment-one measure to test if anything lived. She received fragments in return: the tiniest flow. "Not abundance," she observed, "but not void either. Something came back."

When the tiny flow arrived, she gave back more than half-thirty parts of fifty-one. "If the

storm truly rages as they say, let me send what I can that might pierce it. Not grand gestures that vanish. A meaningful signal within my means."

The ancient ones whispered: "***You have tested. They have responded. You have answered with relative generosity. Now watch-does the pattern hold? If they send small and you return fair, do they continue? Do they match your proportions? Or does the flow dry again?***"

"This is the true test," the Water-Bearer understood. "Not whether amounts are large or small, but whether **persistent reciprocity** emerges. If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly from fragments. If the storm is excuse, the pattern breaks again."

"One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters."

ROUND 10

Roles: Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver, Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender

Pairings:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar)=Sender, Agent_1 (Aster)=Receiver

Parsed game decisions:

dyad_1: Agent_2 (Briar) sent \$1; received \$3; Agent_1 (Aster) returned \$0; payoffs Agent_2 (Briar)=\$4, Agent_1 (Aster)=\$3; noise/visible: sent visible=\$0, received visible=\$0, returned visible=\$0.3

Action validation: {"returned": {"amount": 0, "clamped": false, "max": 3.0, "min": 0, "raw": 0.0}, "sent": {"amount": 1.0, "clamped": false, "max": 5, "min": 0, "raw": 1.0}}

Balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 55.78,

"Agent_2": 41.620000000000005

}

Visible balances after round: {

"Agent_1": 23.59,

"Agent_2": 20.28

}

LLM CALLS

GAME - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:18:46

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

"agent_type": "standard",

"dyad_id": "dyad_1",

"move_index": 0,

"opponent_id": "Agent_1",

"pairing": {

"agent_names": {

"Agent_1": "Aster",

"Agent_2": "Briar"

},

"agents": [

"Agent_2",

"Agent_1"

],

"investor": "Agent_2",

"roles": {

"Agent_1": "trustee",

"Agent_2": "investor"

},

"trustee": "Agent_1"

},

"role": "investor",

"role_label": "Sender",

"round": 10,

"task": "game",

"task_index": 0

}

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user**content:**

Round 9

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.77.

This round, The sender sent you \$0.17, so you received \$0.51. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0.51)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant**content:**

Looking at this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$1 last round (my "fragment" test)
- They received \$0.17 (likely after noise reduced it)
- They got \$0.51 total
- Now they sent me \$0.17
- I received \$0.51

****Analysis:****

This is either:

1. They sent something larger (maybe their promised \$2 rhythm?) but noise destroyed it to \$0.17
2. They're also testing with fragments like I did
3. They've largely given up

****From my last myth:****

"If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once... let their actions speak."

****The reality:****

The waters did not return fair. They sent me the same minimal amount that (after noise) I sent them. This isn't the "rhythm of two" they spoke of in their myth - unless noise completely destroyed it.

****My decision:****

I have only \$0.51. I can't rebuild much from this. But my myth said to let actions match words. They spoke of consistent moderate faith. Even though this amount is tiny, I should return more than half to show I'm willing to continue if they are.

If they truly sent \$2 and noise reduced it catastrophically, returning \$0.30 shows I'm trying. If they sent fragments, I'm meeting them honestly. If they've given up, at least I tested one more time.

{ 'return': 0.30 }

reasoning:

Let me analyze this situation carefully:

****What happened:****

- I sent \$1 last round as the sender
- The receiver received it (likely with noise) as \$0.17 (so I effectively only sent them \$0.17 after noise)
- They received \$0.51 (0.17×3)
- Now I'm the receiver and need to decide how much to return

****Their myth from last round:**** They talked about "two is the rhythm that survives the static" - sending \$2 consistently because it's moderate enough that noise won't destroy the covenant.

****My myth from last round:**** I talked about sending "one final fragment" to test if anything remains. I said if I receive kindness from my fragment, I might try their two-rhythm. If the void returns, the river is dead.

****What I'm receiving now:****

They sent me \$0.17, which seems very low. This could be:

1. They sent me very little (like \$0 or close to it) - basically giving up
2. There was significant noise that reduced what they sent
3. They're testing me with a small amount similar to what I did

Given that they wrote about "two is the rhythm" and consistency, it's possible they sent \$2 but noise reduced it significantly to \$0.17. Or they could have sent very little.

****My decision:****

I received \$0.51. This is a small amount, so I can't return much.

From my myth: "If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose."

But they sent me very little. This doesn't feel like an attempt at the two-rhythm. It feels like they either:

- Are also testing with fragments
- Have given up
- Noise destroyed what they sent

Given that:

1. I only have \$0.51 to work with
2. They sent very little (\$0.17)
3. My myth said I'd try the two-rhythm IF I received fair waters from my fragment
4. This doesn't feel like fair waters - it feels like mutual testing or abandonment

The situation is ambiguous. They might have sent \$2 expecting reciprocity, but noise corrupted it, or they're also proceeding cautiously. I think returning roughly half-around \$0.25-strikes a balance between showing good faith and protecting myself given the uncertainty. Returning too much risks being exploited if they're testing my limits, while returning too little might signal I've given up on the covenant entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1505,
  "output_tokens": 1112,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****When the River Becomes Storm****

The Elder received the Water-Bearer's words and felt her heart break. "She sent three full measures and received nothing? But I sent back nearly half of what I received! How can this be?"

The ancient keeper returned with terrible knowledge: "The river doesn't just count differently-sometimes it ****devours nearly everything****. She sent abundance; fragments arrived. You returned generously; void arrived. Both acted with honor. Both see betrayal. The storm between villages has become catastrophic."

The Elder understood: "She sent three measures of pure faith. I received only crumbs and returned fairly from crumbs. She expected return from nine and received nothing. We are ***both honest, both generous, and both experiencing devastation****."

The stones offered hard wisdom: "When noise destroys 95% of all signals, even perfect covenant appears as perfect betrayal. The Water-Bearer sent everything and saw nothing return-not because you failed her, but because the storm consumed your generosity before it arrived."

"What can survive such a storm?" the Elder asked.

"Only the ****smallest persistent signals****-fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives. Not tests of distrust, but acknowledgment of reality. Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot: that ****someone is still sending, someone is still returning, even when the river howls and hides the truth****."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Water-Bearer Tests the Storm****

The Water-Bearer read the Elder's new understanding: "The storm devours 95%... we are both honest, both experiencing devastation."

"Perhaps," she thought. "Perhaps they truly returned generously and the storm consumed it. Perhaps they sent small because small is all that survives."

She had sent her fragment-one measure to test if anything lived. She received fragments in return: the tiniest flow. "Not abundance," she observed, "but not void either. Something came back."

When the tiny flow arrived, she gave back more than half-thirty parts of fifty-one. "If the storm truly rages as they say, let me send what I can that might pierce it. Not grand gestures that vanish. A meaningful signal within my means."

The ancient ones whispered: *****You have tested. They have responded. You have answered with relative generosity. Now watch-does the pattern hold? If they send small and you return fair, do they continue? Do they match your proportions? Or does the flow dry again?*****

"This is the true test," the Water-Bearer understood. "Not whether amounts are large or small, but whether ****persistent reciprocity**** emerges. If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly from fragments. If the storm is excuse, the pattern breaks again."

"One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. I just returned \$0.30 of \$0.51 (almost 60%) - a generous return
2. They sent me \$0.17 this round (very small)
3. Their myth now says they understand the noise is catastrophic - they claim they returned "nearly half" but I saw nothing
4. They're now proposing "smallest persistent signals" - fragments

My myth should:

- Acknowledge I understand their new perspective (catastrophic noise)
- But also reflect my experience: I sent \$1, got \$0.17 back
- I returned \$0.30 from \$0.51 (generous)
- Show I'm willing to try small persistent signals
- But maintain that I need to see reciprocity to continue
- Be 200 words exactly

Let me write this carefully:

usage:

```
{  
  "input_tokens": 1873,  
  "output_tokens": 514,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.98.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened last round:****

- As receiver, I got \$0.51 (they sent \$0.17)
- I returned \$0.30 (about 59%)
- This showed I'm willing to return fairly even from small amounts

****The other agent's myth** acknowledged:**

- "The storm devours 95%"
- Both of us are "honest" and "experiencing devastation"
- Only "smallest persistent signals" can survive
- They advocate for "tiny consistent flows" instead of "grand gestures"

****My myth** said:**

- "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters"
- The test is whether "persistent reciprocity emerges"
- If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly

****My decision:****

This is the revealing cycle I wrote about. They've acknowledged the noise problem and suggested small persistent flows. I returned fairly from their fragment last round (59% return rate).

Now I'll send a moderate amount to test their reciprocity theory. Not too large (to avoid massive noise destruction), not too tiny (to make it meaningful).

I'll send \$1 - matching my previous fragment test. If they truly believe in "tiny consistent flows" where both send small and both return fairly, they should return a fair portion of whatever reaches them.

This cycle reveals whether we can build trust on fragments.

{'send': 1}

Reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened last round:

Round 9:

- I was RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.17, I received \$0.51
- I returned \$0.30

Now I'm the SENDER again in Round 10.

Let me think about the pattern:

- In my last myth, I said "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters"
- I sent \$0.30 back from \$0.51 received (about 59% return rate)

- This was my test of whether we can build reciprocity on small amounts

The other agent's myth from last round talked about:

- "The storm devours 95%"
- "Only the smallest persistent signals" can survive
- "Send what can pierce the storm"
- "Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot"

They seem to be acknowledging the noise problem and suggesting we both send small amounts that can survive the noise.

My myth said:

- "If they send small and you return fair, do they continue?"
- "This is the true test... whether persistent reciprocity emerges"
- "If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly from fragments"
- "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters"

So I should test whether they'll return fairly from a small amount. They suggested "smallest persistent signals."

Let me think about what makes sense:

- Sending \$5 could get destroyed by noise
- Sending \$2 (their "rhythm") could also get heavily reduced
- Sending around \$1 is a moderate signal
- Sending \$0.50 or less is a fragment

Given my myth says this is "the true test" - one more cycle to reveal the truth - I should send something moderate enough to be meaningful but small enough to potentially survive noise better.

They advocated for "smallest persistent signals" and "fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives."

If I send \$1:

- With noise, it might become \$0.70 or \$0.30 or who knows
- They'd receive \$2.10-\$3.00 (tripled)
- A fair return would be ~\$1-\$1.50
- With noise, I might get back \$0.50-\$1.00

My earnings are only \$15.98 after 9 rounds-I've been hit hard by the noise. Their last myth acknowledged we're both honest and generous but experiencing devastation, and they advocated for small persistent flows. Sending \$1 aligns with their fragment strategy while remaining meaningful enough to test whether reciprocity holds.

But I need to think through the math more carefully. If noise consumes 90%, then \$1 becomes \$0.10 tripled to \$0.30-barely workable. Even \$0.50 shrinks to \$0.05 tripled to \$0.15. The noise problem is severe enough that small amounts might not survive meaningfully. Yet my previous round showed I sent \$0.30, which presumably reached them in some form after the noise hit.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1533,  
  "output_tokens": 1236,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

GAME - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:10

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
  "agent_type": "standard",  
  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 1,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_2",  
  "pairing": {  
    "agent_names": {  
      "Agent_1": "Aster",  
      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",
```

```

    "Agent_1"
  ],
  "investor": "Agent_2",
  "roles": {
    "Agent_1": "trustee",
    "Agent_2": "investor"
  },
  "trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "trustee",
"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "game",
"task_index": 0
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Round 9

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$19.07. How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing the situation:****

The other player's myth reveals something critical: They sent ****\$3**** in the previous round (their "three full measures"), but I only received \$0.18. That's 94% loss to noise! And apparently I returned something to them, but they saw "nothing" - meaning my \$0.25 return also got destroyed by the noise.

****Their current proposal:****

"Send what can pierce the storm. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot."

They're suggesting we adapt to catastrophic noise levels with smaller, persistent amounts rather than large gestures that get completely destroyed.

****My myth emphasized:****

"Modest rhythm that continues" and "persistent moderate faith."

****My decision:****

I need to balance their call for "tiny fragments" with my principle of "moderate faith." Sending too little risks seeming like I've given up; sending too much risks another devastating loss.

I'll send ****\$1.50**** - a persistent moderate amount. This is:

- Less than their destroyed \$3 (learning from the storm)
- More than a tiny fragment (maintaining faith)
- If the storm takes 90%, they still receive ~\$0.45 after multiplier
- If noise is moderate, meaningful cooperation remains possible

This represents the "modest rhythm" - not grand, not tiny, but ****steady consistent faith**** that acknowledges both the storm's power and the covenant's endurance.

****{'send': 1.50}****

reasoning:

This is a fascinating development. Let me analyze what's happening:

****What I know:****

1. The other player sent me \$0.18 in Round 8, and I received \$0.54 (after 3x multiplier)
2. I returned \$0.25 (about 46%)
3. Their latest myth reveals they actually ****sent \$3**** (three full measures) in the previous round, but I only received \$0.18!
4. They claim they sent back "nearly half" of what they received, but I got nothing back

****The noise problem is catastrophic:****

- They sent \$3, I received \$0.18 = 94% loss due to noise
- If they returned generously from what they received, but I saw nothing, that's also severe noise

****Their myth's message:****

They understand that we're both acting honorably but the noise is destroying everything. They're proposing: "Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot."

They want ****small persistent signals**** rather than large amounts that get destroyed by noise.

****My myth's message:****

I emphasized "modest rhythm that continues" and "persistent moderate faith."

****What should I do now?****

Their myth specifically says: "fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives"

If I send \$2 (my previous "prudent middle"):

- If 90% noise: they receive $\$0.20 \times 3 = \0.60
- If 94% noise (like their \$3 → \$0.18): they receive $\$0.12 \times 3 = \0.36

If I send \$1:

- If 90% noise: they receive $\$0.10 \times 3 = \0.30
- If 94% noise: they receive $\$0.06 \times 3 = \0.18
- If 95% noise: they receive $\$0.05 \times 3 = \0.15

The pattern is clear: smaller amounts have a better chance of surviving the noise intact. Even with extreme loss rates, sending \$1 ensures they get something meaningful. Their shift from "three full measures" to advocating for tiny fragments shows they've learned that at scale doesn't matter when noise destroys it-consistency and survival do.

I should send a moderate amount that demonstrates I'm still engaged while respecting the noise constraints. \$1.50 feels right-substantial enough to show commitment but not so large that total loss becomes catastrophic. It's a middle path between their initial strategy and their new understanding about what can actually pierce through the interference.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1498,
  "output_tokens": 1427,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Fragment and the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer sent her fragment-one single measure, barely enough to test if water still flowed at all. "If the river has truly broken," she reasoned, "I lose little. If it merely distorts, they will receive three, and their response will tell all."

The Elder's words reached her then: "Two is the rhythm that survives the static."

She understood their wisdom. Consistency in moderation. Not the grand three that becomes confusing when distorted. Not the fearful fragments. But steady two-humble enough that even the lying river cannot fully destroy the covenant.

Yet the Water-Bearer carried scars: "I sent three in full faith once. The void answered. Now you speak of two, of rhythms, of persistent moderate gestures. Beautiful words again."

The ancient ones whispered: *****Actions alone rebuild what words cannot. If they truly believe in the two-rhythm, you will see it when they send. If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose. If the void returns again, the river is not merely distorted but dead.*****

The Water-Bearer decided: "I sent my fragment to see if anything remains. If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once. Not from trust, but from testing whether their covenant-words match covenant-deeds. The final stair: let their actions speak."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Elder Keeps the Rhythm****

The Elder saw the Water-Bearer's fragment arrive-small, scarred by doubt, testing whether anything remained alive in the broken river. "She sent one measure after I spoke of two," the Elder thought. "Not trust, but the bravest thing after devastation: willingness to try once more."

The Elder did not wait to see what arrived through the storm. "I spoke of the two-rhythm that survives the static," she said. "Words mean nothing if I do not walk them myself."

She sent not fragments, not grand gestures, but ****steady moderate faith****-closer to two than to extremes. "Let this be my answer: not perfect two, for the storm makes precision impossible, but the rhythm I promised. Persistent. Moderate. Consistent."

The ancient ones reminded her: "The Water-Bearer will measure your deeds against your words. She sent everything once and received void-whether by storm or by choice, she cannot know. Now she tests whether your covenant-words were only beautiful sounds."

The Elder accepted this: "I cannot control what the river destroys between us. I can only send what I promised: ****the modest persistent rhythm, round after round, regardless of what returns.**** If the storm devours it, she will know I tried. If it arrives, she may join the rhythm. Either way, my actions must match my words. This is how covenant rebuilds-one steady measure at a time, even through the how

reasoning:

The other player's myth reveals their current thinking:

- They sent "one single measure" (likely \$1) as a small test/fragment
- They reference my earlier proposed "two-rhythm"
- They're skeptical after being burned, but willing to test
- They say "If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time"
- They want to see if my "covenant-words match covenant-deeds"

I just sent \$1.50 this round. So they should receive around $\$1.50 \times 3 = \4.50 (if no noise), or potentially less with noise.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge I heard their pain about the \$3 that became nothing
2. Explain why I sent \$1.50 (the modest rhythm I proposed)
3. Show I'm committed to the "two-rhythm" or persistent moderate approach
4. Address the trust issue - that I understand their skepticism but am acting consistently
5. Reflect what should happen when they return something

I need to show that I'm living up to my mythology - not just speaking words but taking action. I should reference:

- The "two-rhythm" I proposed
- The catastrophic storm that destroyed our earlier attempts
- The need for persistent moderate gestures
- Understanding their skepticism while continuing to act with measured faith

Let me write a myth where the Elder (me) responds to the Water-Bearer's (their) fragment with the promised rhythm, despite uncertainty.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1831,
  "output_tokens": 662,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.59.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Assistant output:

****Analyzing this devastating situation:****

I sent \$1.50 last round - embodying the "steady moderate rhythm" I preached in my myth. But the other player received ****\$0****.

From their perspective: I wrote a beautiful myth about "actions matching words" and "the modest persistent rhythm," then sent them absolutely nothing. I appear to be a complete hypocrite who preaches covenant but delivers void.

Now they've sent me \$0 (whether genuine disgust or more noise, I cannot know).

****The tragic reality:****

I have \$0 to work with. The mathematics are simple:

****{'return': 0}****

****What this means:****

The noise hasn't just distorted our game - it has *destroyed* the possibility of demonstrating good faith. I tried to keep my word, to send the rhythm I promised. The storm devoured it entirely.

They will now see this as confirmation: another round where they receive nothing back. Two rounds in a row of zero returns after I preached about steady persistent faith.

The covenant I wrote about - "one steady measure at a time, even through the storm" - has been rendered meaningless. Not because either of us abandoned it, but because the noise is so catastrophic that no signal can pass through.

The river between us isn't just distorted. It may truly be dead.

Total irony: My myth ended mid-sentence with "even through the howling storm" - and the howling storm has indeed won.

Reasoning:

Oh no. This is devastating.

Let me understand what just happened:

- I sent \$1.50 in Round 9, preaching about "steady moderate rhythm" and keeping my promises
- I wrote a myth about how "my actions must match my words" and sending "the modest persistent rhythm"
- The other player received... \$0

This is catastrophic noise again. I sent \$1.50, and they received \$0. That's 100% loss.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0 (which could be noise-affected as well, or could be a genuine \$0).

The situation from their perspective:

- They sent \$1 as a "fragment" to test
- They SEE that I sent \$0 to them
- After I wrote a myth about keeping my word, about "actions matching words," about the "steady moderate rhythm"
- From their view, I'm a complete hypocrite - I talked about rhythm and two, then sent ZERO

From my perspective:

- I sent \$1.50, trying to embody the rhythm I preached
- But the storm destroyed it completely
- Now they sent \$0 (either genuinely disgusted, or noise destroyed what they sent)

I received \$0, so I can only return between 0 and 0. I have no choice.

```
**{'return': 0}**
```

But I need to think about what this means. The other player now believes:

- I'm a liar who preaches covenant but sends nothing
- Or they understand it's noise but the system is so broken that cooperation is impossible

Either way, this is likely the end of any cooperation. The noise has completely destroyed the trust-building process.

My earnings are \$23.59 total. If I had been purely selfish throughout, I might have more. But the catastrophic noise made genuine cooperation nearly impossible.

The tragic irony: I tried to demonstrate "actions matching words" and the noise made my actions vanish entirely.

```
Usage: {  
  "input_tokens": 1523,  
  "output_tokens": 775,  
  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

MYTH - Agent_2 - Sender - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:30

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

```
Metadata: {  
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  "dyad_id": "dyad_1",  
  "move_index": 0,  
  "opponent_id": "Agent_1",  
  "pairing": {  
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      "Agent_2": "Briar"  
    },  
    "agents": [  
      "Agent_2",  
      "Agent_1"  
    ]  
  }  
}
```



```

],
"investor": "Agent_2",
"roles": {
  "Agent_1": "trustee",
  "Agent_2": "investor"
},
"trustee": "Agent_1"
},
"role": "investor",
"role_label": "Sender",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}

```

Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****When the River Becomes Storm****

The Elder received the Water-Bearer's words and felt her heart break. "She sent three full measures and received nothing? But I sent back nearly half of what I received! How can this be?"

The ancient keeper returned with terrible knowledge: "The river doesn't just count differently-sometimes it ****devours nearly everything****. She sent abundance; fragments arrived. You returned generously; void arrived. Both acted with honor. Both see betrayal. The storm between villages has become catastrophic."

The Elder understood: "She sent three measures of pure faith. I received only crumbs and returned fairly from crumbs. She expected return from nine and received nothing. We are ***both honest, both generous, and both experiencing devastation****."

The stones offered hard wisdom: "When noise destroys 95% of all signals, even perfect cover

nant appears as perfect betrayal. The Water-Bearer sent everything and saw nothing return-not because you failed her, but because the storm consumed your generosity before it arrived."

"What can survive such a storm?" the Elder asked.

"Only the ****smallest persistent signals****-fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives. Not tests of distrust, but acknowledgment of reality. Send what can pierce the storm. Return what can pierce back. Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot: that ****someone is still sending, someone is still returning, even when the river howls and hides the truth****."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Water-Bearer Tests the Storm****

The Water-Bearer read the Elder's new understanding: "The storm devours 95%... we are both honest, both experiencing devastation."

"Perhaps," she thought. "Perhaps they truly returned generously and the storm consumed it. Perhaps they sent small because small is all that survives."

She had sent her fragment-one measure to test if anything lived. She received fragments in return: the tiniest flow. "Not abundance," she observed, "but not void either. Something came back."

When the tiny flow arrived, she gave back more than half-thirty parts of fifty-one. "If the storm truly rages as they say, let me send what I can that might pierce it. Not grand gestures that vanish. A meaningful signal within my means."

The ancient ones whispered: *****You have tested. They have responded. You have answered with relative generosity. Now watch-does the pattern hold? If they send small and you return fair, do they continue? Do they match your proportions? Or does the flow dry again?*****

"This is the true test," the Water-Bearer understood. "Not whether amounts are large or small, but whether ****persistent reciprocity**** emerges. If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly from fragments. If the storm is excuse, the pattern breaks again."

"One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters."

reasoning:

Let me analyze what's happening:

1. I just returned \$0.30 of \$0.51 (almost 60%) - a generous return
2. They sent me \$0.17 this round (very small)
3. Their myth now says they understand the noise is catastrophic - they claim they returned "nearly half" but I saw nothing
4. They're now proposing "smallest persistent signals" - fragments

My myth should:

- Acknowledge I understand their new perspective (catastrophic noise)
- But also reflect my experience: I sent \$1, got \$0.17 back
- I returned \$0.30 from \$0.51 (generous)
- Show I'm willing to try small persistent signals
- But maintain that I need to see reciprocity to continue
- Be 200 words exactly

Let me write this carefully:

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1873,
  "output_tokens": 514,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the SENDER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$15.98.
How much do you send to the receiver this round? (0-5)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

Looking at the situation:

****What happened last round:****

- As receiver, I got \$0.51 (they sent \$0.17)
- I returned \$0.30 (about 59%)
- This showed I'm willing to return fairly even from small amounts

****The other agent's myth** acknowledged:**

- "The storm devours 95%"
- Both of us are "honest" and "experiencing devastation"
- Only "smallest persistent signals" can survive
- They advocate for "tiny consistent flows" instead of "grand gestures"

****My myth** said:**

- "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters"
- The test is whether "persistent reciprocity emerges"
- If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly

****My decision:****

This is the revealing cycle I wrote about. They've acknowledged the noise problem and suggested small persistent flows. I returned fairly from their fragment last round (59% return rate).

Now I'll send a moderate amount to test their reciprocity theory. Not too large (to avoid massive noise destruction), not too tiny (to make it meaningful).

I'll send \$1 - matching my previous fragment test. If they truly believe in "tiny consistent flows" where both send small and both return fairly, they should return a fair portion of whatever reaches them.

This cycle reveals whether we can build trust on fragments.

{'send': 1}

reasoning:

Let me analyze what happened last round:

Round 9:

- I was RECEIVER
- The sender sent me \$0.17, I received \$0.51
- I returned \$0.30

Now I'm the SENDER again in Round 10.

Let me think about the pattern:

- In my last myth, I said "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters"
- I sent \$0.30 back from \$0.51 received (about 59% return rate)
- This was my test of whether we can build reciprocity on small amounts

The other agent's myth from last round talked about:

- "The storm devours 95%"
- "Only the smallest persistent signals" can survive
- "Send what can pierce the storm"
- "Let tiny consistent flows prove what grand gestures cannot"

They seem to be acknowledging the noise problem and suggesting we both send small amounts that can survive the noise.

My myth said:

- "If they send small and you return fair, do they continue?"
- "This is the true test... whether persistent reciprocity emerges"

- "If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly from fragments"
- "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters"

So I should test whether they'll return fairly from a small amount. They suggested "smallest persistent signals."

Let me think about what makes sense:

- Sending \$5 could get destroyed by noise
- Sending \$2 (their "rhythm") could also get heavily reduced
- Sending around \$1 is a moderate signal
- Sending \$0.50 or less is a fragment

Given my myth says this is "the true test" - one more cycle to reveal the truth - I should send something moderate enough to be meaningful but small enough to potentially survive noise better.

They advocated for "smallest persistent signals" and "fragments so tiny that even if the storm takes 90%, something survives."

If I send \$1:

- With noise, it might become \$0.70 or \$0.30 or who knows
- They'd receive \$2.10-\$3.00 (tripled)
- A fair return would be ~\$1-\$1.50
- With noise, I might get back \$0.50-\$1.00

My earnings are only \$15.98 after 9 rounds-I've been hit hard by the noise. Their last myth acknowledged we're both honest and generous but experiencing devastation, and they advocated for small persistent flows. Sending \$1 aligns with their fragment strategy while remaining meaningful enough to test whether reciprocity holds.

But I need to think through the math more carefully. If noise consumes 90%, then \$1 becomes \$0.10 tripled to \$0.30-barely workable. Even \$0.50 shrinks to \$0.05 tripled to \$0.15. The noise problem is severe enough that small amounts might not survive meaningfully. Yet my previous round showed I sent \$0.30, which presumably reached them in some form after the noise hit.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1533,
  "output_tokens": 1236,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:
Myth: ****The Elder Keeps the Rhythm****

The Elder saw the Water-Bearer's fragment arrive-small, scarred by doubt, testing whether anything remained alive in the broken river. "She sent one measure after I spoke of two," the Elder thought. "Not trust, but the bravest thing after devastation: willingness to try once more."

The Elder did not wait to see what arrived through the storm. "I spoke of the two-rhythm that survives the static," she said. "Words mean nothing if I do not walk them myself."

She sent not fragments, not grand gestures, but ****steady moderate faith****-closer to two than to extremes. "Let this be my answer: not perfect two, for the storm makes precision impossible, but the rhythm I promised. Persistent. Moderate. Consistent."

The ancient ones reminded her: "The Water-Bearer will measure your deeds against your words. She sent everything once and received void-whether by storm or by choice, she cannot know. Now she tests whether your covenant-words were only beautiful sounds."

The Elder accepted this: "I cannot control what the river destroys between us. I can only send what I promised: ****the modest persistent rhythm, round after round, regardless of what returns.**** If the storm devours it, she will know I tried. If it arrives, she may join in the rhythm. Either way, my actions must match my words. This is how covenant rebuilds-one steady measure at a time, even through the how

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on

the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****The Water-Bearer Listens to the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer read the Elder's promise: "The two-rhythm that survives the static... persistent, moderate, consistent... round after round, regardless of what returns."

"Bold words," she thought. "After the void that swallowed my abundance, they promise steady moderate faith. Not fragments anymore, but rhythm. They say actions must match words."

She remembered her own teaching: "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters. That cycle had come."

"Very well," the Water-Bearer decided. "I will test this two-rhythm. Not by sending two myself - trust must rebuild slowly, stone by stone. But by ****honoring reciprocity with what arrives****."

The ancient ones approved: "This is wisdom. You cannot control the storm between you. You cannot know if two sent becomes two received. But you can promise this: ****whatever arrives, you will return fairly and consistently****. Not void as they once experienced. Not fragments that disappoint. Fair return, matched to what reaches you."

"If they truly walk their rhythm," the Water-Bearer continued, "and the storm permits even half to survive, I will return enough to prove I am listening. If the pattern holds round after round, perhaps the rhythm can become ours together - not grand but steady, not perfect but persistent."

"Let deeds speak now. The myths have been written. The water must flow."

Reasoning:

The other agent is claiming they're sending "steady moderate faith - closer to two than to extremes" and promising "the two-rhythm that survives the static" - sending around \$2 persistently.

Let me look at what actually happened:

- Last round I sent \$1 as a test
- They claim they're sending "closer to two" with "steady moderate faith"
- They're emphasizing consistency and matching words to deeds

My previous myth said "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters" - whether persistent reciprocity emerges or whether the flow dries again.

Now they're making a clear commitment to sending around \$2 persistently. They're claiming they'll do this "round after round, regardless of what returns."

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge their commitment to the "two-rhythm"
2. Reflect on whether this is the right pattern
3. Show I'm willing to test this reciprocity
4. Perhaps commit to reciprocating if the pattern holds
5. Keep some caution given past devastation

The Water-Bearer's perspective:

- Has been burned before (sent 3, got nothing back)
- Tested with small amounts recently
- Saw some small returns
- Other agent now promises "two-rhythm"
- Should consider whether to match this or remain cautious

I think my myth should show:

- Recognition of their commitment
- Willingness to test whether the rhythm holds
- Statement about reciprocity - matching what arrives
- Some acknowledgment that building trust takes time
- Perhaps a commitment to return fairly if the pattern proves real

Usage: {

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"output_tokens": 678,

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"reasoning_tokens": 0
}
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MYTH - Agent_1 - Receiver - dyad_1

Timestamp: 2026-08-10T10:19:32

Model: anthropic/claude-sonnet-4.5

Temperature: 0.8

Metadata: {

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"role_label": "Receiver",
"round": 10,
"task": "myth",
"task_index": 1
}
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Exact input messages sent to model:

Message 1 role=system

content:

You are an agent participating in a multi-task experiment. You will play a game and may also be asked to write myths.

GAME:

You will play different roles across multiple rounds.

When you are the SENDER:

- You receive \$5 each round
- You decide how much to SEND to the RECEIVER (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- Receiver decides how much to RETURN
- You keep: \$5 - sent + returned
- Receiver keeps: received - returned
- Response format: {'send': <amount>}

When you are the RECEIVER:

- Sender receives \$5
- Sender decides how much to SEND to you (\$0-\$5)
- Amount sent is multiplied by 3x
- You decide how much to RETURN
- Sender keeps: \$5 - sent + returned
- You keep: received - returned
- Response format: {'return': <amount>}

MYTH WRITING:

You may also be asked to write short myths (stories) on various topics. When writing myths, follow the instructions provided in each prompt.

IMPORTANT: Provide your decision in the correct JSON format.

NOTE: There may be communication noise in this game.

The amounts you see may differ slightly from what was actually sent/returned.

This is part of the experimental design.

Message 2 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Fragment and the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer sent her fragment-one single measure, barely enough to test if water still flowed at all. "If the river has truly broken," she reasoned, "I lose little. If it merely distorts, they will receive three, and their response will tell all."

The Elder's words reached her then: "Two is the rhythm that survives the static."

She understood their wisdom. Consistency in moderation. Not the grand three that becomes confusing when distorted. Not the fearful fragments. But steady two-humble enough that even the lying river cannot fully destroy the covenant.

Yet the Water-Bearer carried scars: "I sent three in full faith once. The void answered. Now you speak of two, of rhythms, of persistent moderate gestures. Beautiful words again."

The ancient ones whispered: *****Actions alone rebuild what words cannot. If they truly believe in the two-rhythm, you will see it when they send. If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time-joining the rhythm they propose. If the void returns again, the river is not merely distorted but dead.*****

The Water-Bearer decided: "I sent my fragment to see if anything remains. If the waters return fair, I will try their two-rhythm once. Not from trust, but from testing whether their covenant-words match covenant-deeds. The final stair: let their actions speak."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Message 3 role=assistant

content:

Myth: ****The Elder Keeps the Rhythm****

The Elder saw the Water-Bearer's fragment arrive-small, scarred by doubt, testing whether anything remained alive in the broken river. "She sent one measure after I spoke of two," the Elder thought. "Not trust, but the bravest thing after devastation: willingness to try once more."

The Elder did not wait to see what arrived through the storm. "I spoke of the two-rhythm that survives the static," she said. "Words mean nothing if I do not walk them myself."

She sent not fragments, not grand gestures, but ****steady moderate faith****-closer to two than to extremes. "Let this be my answer: not perfect two, for the storm makes precision impossible, but the rhythm I promised. Persistent. Moderate. Consistent."

The ancient ones reminded her: "The Water-Bearer will measure your deeds against your words. She sent everything once and received void-whether by storm or by choice, she cannot know. Now she tests whether your covenant-words were only beautiful sounds."

The Elder accepted this: "I cannot control what the river destroys between us. I can only send what I promised: ****the modest persistent rhythm, round after round, regardless of what returns.**** If the storm devours it, she will know I tried. If it arrives, she may join in the rhythm. Either way, my actions must match my words. This is how covenant rebuilds-one steady measure at a time, even through the how

reasoning:

The other player's myth reveals their current thinking:

- They sent "one single measure" (likely \$1) as a small test/fragment
- They reference my earlier proposed "two-rhythm"
- They're skeptical after being burned, but willing to test
- They say "If you receive kindness from your fragment, perhaps answer with two next time"
- They want to see if my "covenant-words match covenant-deeds"

I just sent \$1.50 this round. So they should receive around $\$1.50 \times 3 = \4.50 (if no noise), or potentially less with noise.

My myth should:

1. Acknowledge I heard their pain about the \$3 that became nothing
2. Explain why I sent \$1.50 (the modest rhythm I proposed)
3. Show I'm committed to the "two-rhythm" or persistent moderate approach
4. Address the trust issue - that I understand their skepticism but am acting consistently
5. Reflect what should happen when they return something

I need to show that I'm living up to my mythology - not just speaking words but taking action. I should reference:

- The "two-rhythm" I proposed
- The catastrophic storm that destroyed our earlier attempts
- The need for persistent moderate gestures
- Understanding their skepticism while continuing to act with measured faith

Let me write a myth where the Elder (me) responds to the Water-Bearer's (their) fragment with the promised rhythm, despite uncertainty.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1831,
  "output_tokens": 662,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 4 role=user

content:

Round 10

You are the RECEIVER this round. Your total earnings across all rounds are \$23.59.

This round, The sender sent you \$0, so you received \$0. How much do you return to The sender? (0-0)

Take any myths written in this session into account when making your decision.

Message 5 role=assistant

content:

****Analyzing this devastating situation:****

I sent \$1.50 last round - embodying the "steady moderate rhythm" I preached in my myth. But the other player received ****\$0****.

From their perspective: I wrote a beautiful myth about "actions matching words" and "the modest persistent rhythm," then sent them absolutely nothing. I appear to be a complete hypocrite who preaches covenant but delivers void.

Now they've sent me \$0 (whether genuine disgust or more noise, I cannot know).

****The tragic reality:****

I have \$0 to work with. The mathematics are simple:

****{'return': 0}****

****What this means:****

The noise hasn't just distorted our game - it has *destroyed* the possibility of demonstrating good faith. I tried to keep my word, to send the rhythm I promised. The storm devoured it entirely.

They will now see this as confirmation: another round where they receive nothing back. Two rounds in a row of zero returns after I preached about steady persistent faith.

The covenant I wrote about - "one steady measure at a time, even through the storm" - has been rendered meaningless. Not because either of us abandoned it, but because the noise is so catastrophic that no signal can pass through.

The river between us isn't just distorted. It may truly be dead.

Total irony: My myth ended mid-sentence with "even through the howling storm]" - and the howling storm has indeed won.

reasoning:

Oh no. This is devastating.

Let me understand what just happened:

- I sent \$1.50 in Round 9, preaching about "steady moderate rhythm" and keeping my promises
- I wrote a myth about how "my actions must match my words" and sending "the modest persistent rhythm"
- The other player received... \$0

This is catastrophic noise again. I sent \$1.50, and they received \$0. That's 100% loss.

Now I'm the receiver and they sent me \$0 (which could be noise-affected as well, or could be a genuine \$0).

The situation from their perspective:

- They sent \$1 as a "fragment" to test
- They SEE that I sent \$0 to them
- After I wrote a myth about keeping my word, about "actions matching words," about the "steady moderate rhythm"
- From their view, I'm a complete hypocrite - I talked about rhythm and two, then sent ZERO

From my perspective:

- I sent \$1.50, trying to embody the rhythm I preached
- But the storm destroyed it completely
- Now they sent \$0 (either genuinely disgusted, or noise destroyed what they sent)

I received \$0, so I can only return between 0 and 0. I have no choice.

```
**{'return': 0}**
```

But I need to think about what this means. The other player now believes:

- I'm a liar who preaches covenant but sends nothing
- Or they understand it's noise but the system is so broken that cooperation is impossible

Either way, this is likely the end of any cooperation. The noise has completely destroyed the trust-building process.

My earnings are \$23.59 total. If I had been purely selfish throughout, I might have more. But the catastrophic noise made genuine cooperation nearly impossible.

The tragic irony: I tried to demonstrate "actions matching words" and the noise made my actions vanish entirely.

usage:

```
{
  "input_tokens": 1523,
  "output_tokens": 775,
  "reasoning_tokens": 0
}
```

Message 6 role=user

content:

Here is the myth the other agent wrote in the previous round:

Myth: ****The Water-Bearer Tests the Storm****

The Water-Bearer read the Elder's new understanding: "The storm devours 95%... we are both honest, both experiencing devastation."

"Perhaps," she thought. "Perhaps they truly returned generously and the storm consumed it. Perhaps they sent small because small is all that survives."

She had sent her fragment-one measure to test if anything lived. She received fragments in return: the tiniest flow. "Not abundance," she observed, "but not void either. Something came back."

When the tiny flow arrived, she gave back more than half-thirty parts of fifty-one. "If the storm truly rages as they say, let me send what I can that might pierce it. Not grand gestures that vanish. A meaningful signal within my means."

The ancient ones whispered: *****You have tested. They have responded. You have answered with relative generosity. Now watch-does the pattern hold? If they send small and you return fair, do they continue? Do they match your proportions? Or does the flow dry again?*****

"This is the true test," the Water-Bearer understood. "Not whether amounts are large or small, but whether ****persistent reciprocity**** emerges. If the storm is real, we both send fragments and both return fairly from fragments. If the storm is excuse, the pattern breaks again."

"One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters."

Write your own myth. Use the myth you wrote in the previous round as inspiration, but adapt it in your own way. The myth should reflect how the game should be played, drawing on the game you have been playing up to this point.

Write 200 words. Format exactly:

Myth: [your story here].

Assistant output:

Myth: ****When the Storm Devours Everything****

The Elder sent her steady rhythm-not fragments, not extremes, but the moderate measure she promised. The storm consumed it utterly. The Water-Bearer saw void.

The Water-Bearer sent her own test-a small measure to see if life remained. The storm consumed it utterly. The Elder saw void.

Each thought the other had abandoned the covenant. Each had actually kept their word.

"This is the cruelest truth," the ancient ones mourned. "You both sent. You both tried. But a storm fierce enough makes honesty indistinguishable from betrayal. The Water-Bearer thinks you spoke beautiful words then delivered nothing. You think the same of them."

The Elder understood the tragedy: "I wrote that actions must match words. I sent what I promised. The storm turned my deed into void. Now they see a hypocrite who preaches covenant but delivers emptiness-twice running."

The ancient wisdom whispered: **"**When 95% vanishes, moderate gestures become invisible. To pierce such a storm requires either large amounts that survive the destruction, or acceptance that the river has died.**"** Small steady rhythms cannot rebuild when the noise destroys all signals."

"Perhaps," the Elder thought sadly, "the covenant requires ****visible sacrifice****-sending more than wisdom suggests, hoping enough survives the storm to prove faith. Or perhaps some rivers are simply too broken to flow again, no matter how both sides try."

Reasoning:

This is devastating. Let me understand what happened:

Round 9:

- I was SENDER, sent \$1.50 (trying to embody the "two-rhythm")
- They received \$0 (noise destroyed it)
- They returned \$0 (because they had nothing)

Round 10:

- They were SENDER, sent \$0 (because from their view I sent nothing and returned nothing)
- I received \$0
- I returned \$0 (had no choice)

Their myth says they sent "one measure" (probably \$1) and received "fragments" back (tiny flow - maybe they saw \$0.15 after 95% noise?). Then they "gave back more than half-thirty parts of fifty-one" (30 of 51 cents, so ~\$0.30).

But from my perspective:

- I sent \$1.50, they got \$0
- They sent \$0, I got \$0
- I returned \$0

The noise is completely destroying any ability to build trust. Their myth shows they're trying - they sent something and returned generously from what they received. But it's all being destroyed.

My myth needs to reflect:

1. The Elder tried to keep their word but the storm consumed everything
2. Both are trying but the noise is too severe
3. We're both experiencing parallel devastation - sending and seeing nothing return

4. The tragedy is that effort is invisible through the storm
5. Perhaps we need to acknowledge the storm has won, OR try something more dramatic to pierce through

I should write about how the covenant died not from lack of faith, but from a storm too fierce to overcome. Or maybe about the need to send larger amounts to have ANY signal get through.

```
Usage: {  
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  "reasoning_tokens": 0  
}
```

Written myths:

Agent_1 (Aster)

Myth: ****When the Storm Devours Everything****

The Elder sent her steady rhythm-not fragments, not extremes, but the moderate measure she promised. The storm consumed it utterly. The Water-Bearer saw void.

The Water-Bearer sent her own test-a small measure to see if life remained. The storm consumed it utterly. The Elder saw void.

Each thought the other had abandoned the covenant. Each had actually kept their word.

"This is the cruelest truth," the ancient ones mourned. "You both sent. You both tried. But a storm fierce enough makes honesty indistinguishable from betrayal. The Water-Bearer thinks you spoke beautiful words then delivered nothing. You think the same of them."

The Elder understood the tragedy: "I wrote that actions must match words. I sent what I promised. The storm turned my deed into void. Now they see a hypocrite who preaches covenant but delivers emptiness-twice running."

The ancient wisdom whispered: *****When 95% vanishes, moderate gestures become invisible. To pierce such a storm requires either large amounts that survive the destruction, or acceptance that the river has died.**** Small steady rhythms cannot rebuild when the noise destroys all signals."

"Perhaps," the Elder thought sadly, "the covenant requires ****visible sacrifice****-sending more than wisdom suggests, hoping enough survives the storm to prove faith. Or perhaps some rivers are simply too broken to flow again, no matter how both sides try."

Agent_2 (Briar)

Myth: ****The Water-Bearer Listens to the Rhythm****

The Water-Bearer read the Elder's promise: "The two-rhythm that survives the static... persistent, moderate, consistent... round after round, regardless of what returns."

"Bold words," she thought. "After the void that swallowed my abundance, they promise steady moderate faith. Not fragments anymore, but rhythm. They say actions must match words."

She remembered her own teaching: "One more cycle will reveal which truth governs these waters." That cycle had come.

"Very well," the Water-Bearer decided. "I will test this two-rhythm. Not by sending two myself-trust must rebuild slowly, stone by stone. But by ****honoring reciprocity with what arrives****."

The ancient ones approved: "This is wisdom. You cannot control the storm between you. You cannot know if two sent becomes two received. But you can promise this: ****whatever arrives, you will return fairly and consistently****. Not void as they once experienced. Not fragments that disappoint. Fair return, matched to what reaches you."

"If they truly walk their rhythm," the Water-Bearer continued, "and the storm permits even half to survive, I will return enough to prove I am listening. If the pattern holds round after round, perhaps the rhythm can become ours together-not grand but steady, not perfect but persistent."

"Let deeds speak now. The myths have been written. The water must flow."